

SCHOOL OF GENERAL STUDIES

NNAMDI AZIKIWE UNIVERSITY, AWKA

NIGERIAN PEOPLES AND CULTURE

GST 112

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CHAPTER ONE

HE TRADITIONAL DIGNITY OF IGBO WOMEN AS A CHALLENGE TO THE MODERN HOTCHPOTCH OF VALUES FOR WOMEN

PhilipMary Emenike Ayika, PhD

roduction

s world has been noted as the world of men with women being endages to men. For some, women are simply properties of men, es of sex and objects of entertainment for men. They are referred to he weaker sex with an ability that does not extend beyond the inner rtyards of the family. This is completely foreign to the traditional Igbo d, a confused and infused misinterpretation of the real value and place women, who live in their world without the interference of the male nterpart in a culture that situates its central priority, life, on the laps of woman. The juxtaposition of the modern world culture of syncretism, ere according to Hauke (1988), the woman almost sublimates into the n posits a lot of social problems. Betz (1979) states a heretical and ncretistic gnostic gospel of St. Thomas:

> When you make the two one and make the inside like the outside and the outside as the inside and the upperside like the underside and when you make the male and the female into a single one, so that the male will not be male and the female [not] be female,..... then you shall enter [the kingdom]. (P.196)

kingdom where there is dissolution of roles, dissolution of gender and ssolution of statuses cannot exist in a culture of life but rather in a lture of death. This means collapse of the family system, the natural generation and the socialization school and then the rise of the human- achines.

The Igbo People

Contemporary views about Igbo people punctuated by genetic, archeological, linguistic, scriptures exegetical and ethnological findings dismiss completely the hypothesis of hamitic (Jewish or Egyptian) origin and tend to situate the cradle of the modern man, *homo sapiens*, in the Igbo people. When taken as a whole, these contemporary scholarships open up new vistas of study and research into the interior of human origin on this planet. Scholars are of the opinion that what is hitherto unknown is much greater than what is known and opening up the unknown can proffer solutions to some problems we experience now in the world.

Acholonu (2009) said that the Igbo story is not the story of a localized community but one of the black people all over the continent of Africa. *Ndi-Igbo* therefore is said to mean "the Ancients, the First People, the Aboriginals (*Ndi Gbo*)" (p.2). She maintained that their origin came from the Grimaldi Bushmen, who were direct descendants of the *homo erectus* (Early man) (p.114). They traversed and migrated out of Africa as hunter gatherers. They were called Igbo by the earliest migrants, probably the Nil (as asserted by Jeffrey (1951) and other researchers) who met them *in situ* on arrival in the Niger-Benue Confluence area. They went by the name *San* or *Shan* (South Africa), *Bushmen*, *Twa* and *Pygmies* in other parts of Africa. In China, they were known as Shan (the creators of the *Shan* Dynasty of God-men) and in Igboland as *Eghi Nshi* or *Nwa-nshi*. Afigbo (1981) maintains that the Igbo have lost all memory of their migration into the area they now occupy if it ever happened. He avers rather that the Igbo emigrated from an original location at the plateau region (Northern Igbo stretching from Nsukka-Okigwe cuesta and Awka – Orlu uplands) to the southern areas of Uratta, Ikwerre, Etche, Asa, and Ndoki as well as the west and east.

Invariably, Uchendu (1965) outlines three senses in which the word is used:

I. To refer to domestic speakers of the language
II. To refer to the language spoken by the people
III. To refer to Igbo territory (p.1)

Geographical territory:

Uchendu (1965) states that the Igbo People are located between latitudes 5° and 7° north of the equator and longitude 6° and 8° east of the Greenwich Meridian. They occupy an area of about 25,280km² (15,800square miles) (p.1). Igbo-speaking peoples can be divided into five geographically based subcultures: northern Igbo, southern Igbo, western Igbo, eastern Igbo, and northeastern Igbo.

The Igbo People are densely populated, which suggests a long occupation of the land. Amadiume (1996) writes that in 1963 the Igbo numbers about 8.5 million and by 1993 has grown to more than 15 million. The Igbo People have one of the highest population densities in West Africa, ranging from 120 to more than 400 persons per square kilometer. Nzomiwu (1999) quoting Ifeemesia stated that the population of the Igbo People that year was about 15 million (p.5). Encarta Encyclopaedia (2006) has it that the population was something over 17 million in 2006. Smock (1972) maintained that "the Igboland had the densest countryside population in any part of Africa" (p.21).

The Place Of Women In Igbo Socio-Religious Worldview

The Igbo world was a complex and dynamic whole. It was a society open to influences from the world outside of them. Complexities therefore abound from layers of historical deposits that defy a linear conceptualization of their worldview. A few areas will be looked into in order to observe what were at the prime of the Igbo world/reality. It would help us reach the place of women in the life of Igbo people.

Myth of human Origin: Udobata (1992) puts forth that

> When Eri came down to the earth from the sky, he sat on an anthill as the land was a morass or water-logged –*Ala di deke* anthill as the land was a morass or water-logged. *Eri deke*. He was sent down from the sky with his wife *namuaku*. Following *Eri*'s complaint, *Chukwu* sent down an Awka blacksmith who used his fiery bellows to dry the land (p.17)

This myth states that man and woman are children of the Supreme Deity. Both came down from above. Insofar as the myth suggests a late arrival of the *Nri* clan, the woman did not come from the earth as the Awka blacksmith but came down with the man. This is in accord with the Igbo

idea of reality as duality. *Ife kwụrụ, ife akwụdebe ya* - Something stands by another.

According to Aniakor (1973):

> When Duru Agwu/Duru Aku, the Chief Diviner at Amauzari in Mbano Division, through whose divination man comes to understand the complicated web of cosmic relationships between him and the gods, looked at the five divination pebbles on his palm, he picked out one, threw it on the ground, picked it up again, examined it and stared into the vacancy in communion with the gods. He said:
>
> | | | |
> |---|---|---|
> | *ihe di abuo abuo* | - | Reality comes in twos |
> | *Nwoke na nwanyi* | - | Male and Female |
> | *Ihe oma na ihe ojoo* | - | Good and Evil |
> | *Ugbua na Mgbe-Ochie* | - | Present and Past |
> | *Mmadu na Mmuo* | - | People and Spirits |
> | *Igwe na Ala* | - | Firmament and Earth |
> | *Onwu na Ndu* | - | Life and Death |
>
> In saying this, he penetrated the heart of Igbo ontology (p.6)

Reality is double fold for the Igbo. Does it mean that man and woman are opposed to one another just as evil seem opposed to good? In Igbo cosmology, it rather bespeaks complementarity since reality makes a whole. Man and woman are therefore the two dialectics that make the human world. Thus the man is the male-face while the woman is the female-face of humanity. None can really exist without the other. Man and woman are therefore equal from origin. Women were never regarded as a thing nor as property.

Edeh (1985) avers that the Igbo have a view of a dual world *"Uwa n'ani muo"* (p.73) depicting the spiritual and physical worlds. Egbujie (1976) believes too that:

> For the Africans the world is *dual in nature*. Beyond and over above the visible, tactile, physical world, there is a non-visible, nontactile world which envelopes the former. It permeates the

> former through and through; it is simultaneously within and outside of the earth and the seas. (p.107)

The spiritual reside with the physical; separating them is applying the Platonic theory of duality. The world is one with spiritual and physical corollaries and it is composed of four basic elements: *earth*, *water*, *fire*, and *air*. The more solid and tangible ones, *earth* and *water* have female characteristics while the intangible ones, *fire* and *air* have the male characteristics. Agbasiere (2000) avers that "the belief system, more than the rules of social organization, depicts clearly the true place of the woman in Igbo society… there is traditionally high regard for women" (p.48). This truly reflects the place of women in the minds of the Igbo as a whole lot can be deduced from this. The gods attached to the first two *urstoffs* are female deities and they have ever dominated the Igbo pantheon. Their influences have percolated down to the spine of socio-religious activities that they rule everything even birthing and life after death, which is the basic preoccupation of the Igbo, who maintain that *Ndubuisi* (Life is the central focus). This clearly supports that the Igbo supreme deity may have been the *Ala*, the earth goddess.

Women are tangible, *nmemme ife*, pillars of human life and family and around them revolves the *air* and *fire* of existence. *Fire* moulds and gives a face (meaning) or force while *air* rekindles life and movement. Water does not move except through the influence of *air* while the *earth* remains inchoate except when formed by fire as when a blacksmith moulds it. *Fire* and *air* have no beauty in themselves while *earth* and *water* are the beauties of life. *Fire* and *air* have no place; they come and go, while *earth* and *water* are the stakeholders of existence. More of this would be seen from the relationship of the sun god *Amadioha*, and the earth goddess, *Ala*. It is also good to note here that the adjective employed by the Igbo to depict "tangible" is formed from the female word for mother. We shall come back to that.

The Supreme Being, *Ala*: *Ala* is believed to be the Supreme Mother of all things. *Ala* is believed to be the wife of the Supreme Being, who in some places is called *Amadioha*. A myth portrayed *Ala* and *Amadioha* as being in the water, which covered the whole earth but seeing that humans and animals would have nowhere to bury their dead and rest, *Ala* decided

to spread the body out and make a home for humans. When *Amadioha* receded to the far sky, it (Amadioha) fertilised the land with rain water, which helped *Ala* bear food for humans and animals. The Igbo say: *e lechawa ọdịdị nwoke na nwanyị, a mara ka Amadioha na Ala siri biri* – One gets the idea of the relationship between *Ala* and *Amadioha* from the status of husband and wife. The gods (*Ala* and *Amadioha*) are therefore the prototype of the family life. Thus to the extent the abstract relationship between the gods are described, to that extent or more does it x-ray the original understanding of husband and wife. Ekwuru (2009) speaking on this analogy said that *Ala:*

> is nevertheless, the prototype of Igbo feminine beauty and fertility. Hence, it is said that: *Ala bụ nma,* "*Ala* is beauty:" *Nma Ala bụ ọmụmụ,* "the beauty of *Ala* is her fecundity". This also highlights the traditional Igbo concept of feminine beauty, which comprises of "bodily fitness", "fecundity" and "humility." A woman who lacks any of these three qualities of beauty in the traditional Igbo society was considered to lack the "functional" ontological fitness for womanhood. (p.106)

In this *Ala-Amadioha* typology, the place of the woman is projected into *Ala,* the earth-goddess. *Ala*/woman is humble and unassuming, always stretching it/her(self) out to accommodate all. Ala/woman is the foundation of all human thriving or at the centre of preservation of life and is full of sacrifices for its daughters and sons. The woman feeds the children and she can keep away from the husband in order to rear the children. However, as Chiegboka (2009) acknowledges, the husband comes from time to time to fertilise it/her with rain for the teeming and preservation of life.

The husband often strikes the land with thunder in the bid to protect it/her from evil. The man has not the patience and humility (the sign of *air* mentioned above) to tend life but the strong hand of discipline (the sign of *fire,* also mentioned above). *Ala*/woman is beautiful and for love of it, Igbo People can traverse distances in order to acquire/marry more. This also explains why the land is not the business of a woman except in special cases when it is necessary.

Personhood, Igbo idea of dignity: The traditional Igbo thought sees a person, male or female, as a son or daughter of God, *Ife-nta*, and this constitute their dignity. Humans are termed *mmadụ*, which can be broken up into *mma ndụ* – beauty and goodness of life. Humans achieve this beauty in creation by giving meaning to it through manipulative and dynamic actions on their objects of experience. This constitutes the part of human dignity which is achieved by individual success, a sense of personal commitment or individual responsibility for one's actions. Thus the Igbo idea of human dignity revolves on two things: *ndụ* and *afa*.

"Ndụ" and "afa": Igbo categories for human dignity: *Ndụ* means life and so the Igbo are evidently preoccupied with good health, physical vigour and preservation of life. *Afa* is literally translated as 'name'. It stands for a personal identity in the community, and for the purpose of human dignity, a 'distinctive name or reputation', which is as a result of an achievement recognized by the community. This view is evident in men's life as much as the women's. *Ndụ* is thus a potential given to all in order to achieve *afa*, a social reputation, which presupposes a moral rectitude, *mma* (beauty) in the society. It can thus be said that *mma-ndụ bụ afa* – the beauty of life is the reputation of the individual in the society. It is by this reputation that one qualifies to join the ancestors and insure or perpetuate one's lineage. One of the preoccupations of the Igbo is being community luminaries, having foothold or being known in the community. The Igbo man struggles to raise his head in the community wherever he is found. Achebe (1986) maintains that they are afraid of being labelled failures. This leads to their busy lives and title-taking in the community, which is a show of success in life.

Women In The Life Of Igbo Traditional Society

The place of the woman will be viewed from pre-historic times, which includes pre-colonial times. This is a time one can truly get to the heart of the Igbo People since there were no coercive infiltrations on their culture. Amadiume (1987) says:

> The pre-colonial period, pre-1900, is considered by present-day Igbo as the 'olden days', when traditional customs were 'pure and unspoilt'. In contrast, after 1900, including both colonial and post-colonial times, is considered as the modern period.

> This division does not imply that in the 'olden days' there was no external contact or change. Change would have been gradual or negotiated, and neither sudden nor immediately apparent. (p. 21)

A gradual change is always accepted by the people and builds into the fabric of their culture, not destroying the overarching principles but enhancing the cultural components. Igbo cultures can be deceptive to an observer scholar since the principles of their existence are not written anywhere but have been fabricated into the being of the people. This is what led early researchers like Leith-Ross (1939) to pen down some contradicting statements about our women.

Surdarkasa (1989) regrets the above position thus:

> Whenever most writers compared the lot of women and men in Africa, they ascribed to men a better situation, a higher status. Women were depicted as saddled with home and domesticity; men were portrayed as enjoying the exhilaration of life in the outside world. For me, the pieces of information did not ring true. Not only was there an obvious distortion of the ethnographic reality – women were outside the home as well as in it – but there was also something inappropriate about the notion that women and men were everywhere related to each other in a hierarchical fashion as was implied in most common usage of the concept of status of women. (pp.25-26)

Greater results are achieved when one studies the phenomena without preconceived ideas and when the phenomena are not seen from other cultural binoculars. In Igbo culture there are the tacit and implicit categories and these are co-terminous with what is often seen and said and what is lived. What is often seen and said is deceptive without being grounded in what is lived and passed on to generations. What is lived points at the process of socialization and for Nwoye (2011), this is crystallized in the office of the woman. Women in Igbo have public outfits and have their own world that is not interfered with by the men but they have a sense of men being the heads of families and other kinship ties, while women are the backbone of life and socialization. As a matter

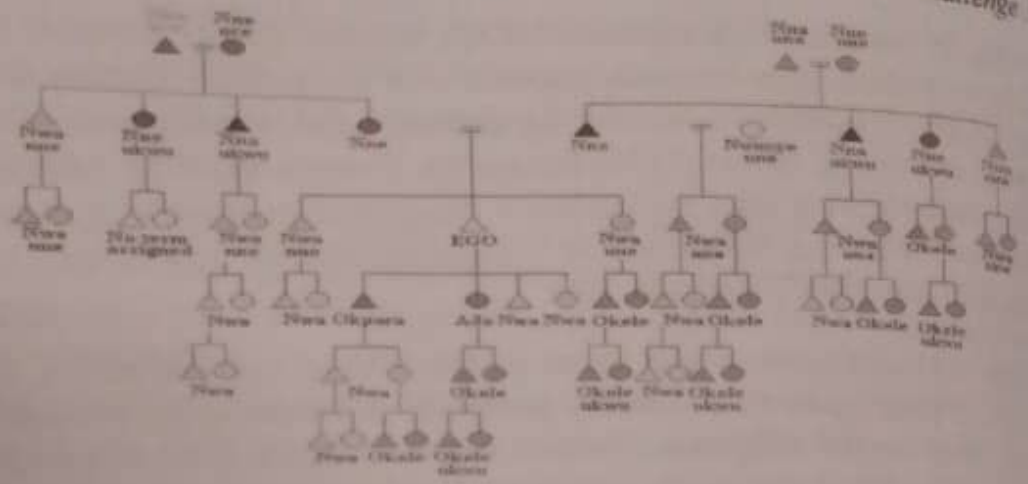
of fact, in accord with Surdarkasa (1989), the two gender domains in African societies were internally ordered in a hierarchical fashion and both of which provided personnel for domestic and extra-domestic (or public) activities. Okonjo (1976) blames the Western world for making public-status-bearing roles the exclusive preserve of men while women, who want to achieve distinction or recognition become appendages to men. Acholonu (1995) maintains that:

> *what determines social status in Africa*, in all parts of Africa, *is economic power*, and hardly gender. A rich woman, an educated woman and enlightened woman who is outspoken, hardworking and fearless can hardly expect to be looked down upon by any member of the society or of her own immediate family... Rich and enterprising women are better placed on the social ladder than poor unenterprising men, without prejudice to the individual customs of African Communities. (pp. 44-45)

Surdarkasa, N. (1989) further argues that the notion of "status", which stands for social stratification on the basis of sex, is inappropriate in describing the relationships between females and males in Africa. Male and female form two distinct genders yet make up some sort of interwoven sexual entity that propels life in the societies of African nations. In fact, Amadiume (1987) in examining the structures that enabled Igbo women achieve power, stated that roles were neither rigidly masculinized nor feminized. Women could play roles usually monopolized by men and were then classified as males – a classification facilitated by women's independent economic resources and the existence of a strong goddess-focused religion. As has been demonstrated above, this strong presence and reverence of the *Ala* goddess in Igbo religion is a transposition of the value of women in the said society, which has a pervading presence in all social relations. Let us now consider the position of women in the Igbo kinship ties.

Women in kinship ties:

Ardener (1954) maintains that in Igbo kin terms, a person's mother's patrilineage is seen as a special category and a strong emphasis on generational and seniority distinctions are evident but not on gender.



(○ Represents the female while △ represents the male. There are no differentiations on the basis of gender. Male and female alike both bear the names *nwanne, okelu, nwanna;* while on seniority level, Parents and children do not bear the same names. They bear specialized names *Okpara, Ada, Okele.* The specialized names for generation have the suffix *–ukwu/oce* attached).

Ego is the subject of this finding. Referring to his parent's generation, he uses essentially the same term *nna* for his father, father's brother, and mother's brother, and similarly classifies his mother, mother's sister and father's sister as *nne*. (The terms *nna/nne ukwu* are basically variants on the *nna/nne* theme and can be taken as "big father/mother", also implying seniority.) The seniority principle is also applied to younger siblings of Ego's parents who are actually given brother/sister terms that tend to emphasize similarities and differences in chronological age. This reflects a basic emphasis in Igbo social organization that is incorporated into the formal system of age sets and age grades. Age-grade as an institution thus dates back into the antiquities of the Igbo people. The generational principle is also apparent in Ego's own generation where alternative forms of the basic sibling terms, *nwa nna/nwa nne* (father's child/mother's child) are applied to a wide range of relatives. Broad generational identification is further apparent in Ego's children's generation in the application of the *nwa* (child) term. Seniority is marked in the special terms for Ego's oldest son (*okpara*) and daughter (*ada*). These designations mark special age-based statuses. The *okpara* is Ego's main heir, and both he and the *ada* perform leadership functions with

he immediate family and the wider descent group – that explains the special titles given to them. Also, Ego's mother's elder sister and brother are addressed as *nne oce (ochie/ukwu)* and *nna oce (ochie/ukwu)* while the mother's younger brother and sister are addressed as *daa* or *dee* respectively.

One notices that the Igbo are basically polygamous. Three basic descent lines are noticed too: (i) the children born of a single mother, the *umunne*, literally mother's children; (ii) Ego's patrilineage, his *umunna* (father's children); and (iii) Ego's mother's patrilineage, his *umune* (this term cannot be reduced to components). The *umune* comprises the relatives of Ego's mother's patrilineage, with whom he has an extremely special relationship involving joking, indulgence, and even protection from punishment within his own patrilineage. This pattern is partially marked in the terminology by the extension of the more intimate *nwa nne* sibling term to cousins in this group.

One of the major areas of relevance of his study is in its application of land ownership issue. Ardener (1954) maintains that "no woman ever comes to own any of her father's land in … any sense" (p.87). However, as ownership of land is vested on males in the kinship unit, the married females have the onus of the lands' daily administration. He uses the polygamous family which he considers the model family unit for the Igbo. Ardener (1954) says that even though "a son can only inherit … land from his father, the actual amount of land he receives is determined through his mother." (pp. 88-89).

Nwanne (collectively, *umunne*) is accepted as a major Igbo kinship idiom. It is the nucleus of the patrilineal descent, where the idea of relatedness is traced to the one woman at the apex through whom all the members of the patrilineages have descended. Within the *nwanne* confines, Ego has a trust and confidence and some special relationship. This is why the Igbo say *Izu ka nma na nneji* – Confidence is better kept within the circle of persons of the same mother. Agbasiere (1985) deconstructs this basic kinship idom, *nwanne*. *Nwanne* comprises two words: *nwa* (child) and *nne* (mother). *Nne*, which points at the mother of Ego or his mother's elder sister has a meaning which stems from fecundity. *Nne* denotes fertility other than human fertility when used as

an adverb. *Ji akaa ruru nne* – 'The previous year's yam produced mothers'. This is the literal translation but it means that the yam crop of the previous year had a good yield. *Nne*, in conjunction with some root words denotes big, large or important values. *Nnekwu okwu* –an important discussion; *nnekwu mmadu* – a very important or great person. Agbasiere goes further to say that *nwanne* is often used to refer to any person with whom Ego interacts in a warm and in-depth basis. The Igbo say: *nwanne di na mba – which literally means that 'siblings are found abroad'*. This means that true life-long friends that desire the wellbeing of one can be found outside the natal environment of one. It is good to note that *nwanna* cannot be used to such a depth but is often applied to a negative connotation. *A naghi ezi nwannadi otu anya e ji ahu uzo*. Literally, this means 'one cannot show the son of the husband's father the only eye through which one sees'. *Nwannadi* stands as a word meaning an enemy but it is coined from *nwa* (child) plus *nnadi* (husband's father). No such coinages may be seen with *nwanne*.

Finally, *nwanne* is an all-inclusive term, which is often used to refer to certain categories of kinsmen and women. It may even be used to refer to a large extent of extended relatives of Ego, both matrilateral and patrilateral. All these show the matrilineal influence in the cultural economy of the Igbo society which is undoubtedly patrifocal. This is the complementarity in life which has been so imbued into the cultural system of the people. Wherever the woman is involved, life (*ndu*), confidence (*izu*), humility/silence (*umeani*), beauty (*nma*) and fecundity (*mkpuru*) become operative. Note that this silence is not the feminist patriarchal silence but one that denotes humility. Humility itself is the strength –*ume* of the Goddess of Igbo religion, *ani/ala*. *Ala* is always said to be quiet and humble (flat) in providing for life for all her children but very bewitching when it comes to moral rectitude. *Ala* owns all both living and dead and provides the stage for all to play. She is the center of Igbo life and so is the woman in the real Igbo thought and life. It is rather the position of the woman that is trans-fixed into the Goddess.

The ontological woman-Being is the *Ala*, who exacts her ontological existence in all women, who are mothers. *Ala* is The Woman while women share in the Being of *Ala*. In as much as they participate

this Being, they possess the integrity of being a woman; they are fulfilled. Their physical powerlessness and silence represent the humility and the unassuming characteristics of the goddess, who remains low, silent but all pervading. In explaining the understanding of the place of women in Achebe (1986), Okafor (2011) says that Okonkwo's fixation in his exaggerated masculinity to the extent of showing disdain for womanhood was ill-conceived and even naïve for a lord of *Umuofia*, who should understand the principle of *omumu* and reverence for the *Ala* goddess. Okonkwo contravened the code of silence of the sacred week in respect of *Ala* by beating no other person but a woman and mother that fully signified *omumu*, which in turn is the life giving essence of *Ala* goddess. Okafor maintains that this led to his suicidal act by hanging and so was not taken into the labyrinth womb of *Ala*. A woman who becomes a mother becomes at the same time an ambassador, a messenger of *Ala* and draws upon herself the integrity of the goddess. It is the ontological presence of this goddess in every mother that bears, feeds, cares for life and socializes the children of *Ala*, the entire society. She, *Ala* inspires or energizes the woman to stand for and defend the life of the goddess in her children and in the society at large. *Ala* is the goddess responsible for perpetuating the life of the Igbo society. Ene (2003) assures us that we thrive and derive life itself from the bounties of *Ala*. Little wonder, Acholonu (2009) says that they were called the children of the Goddess.

The tenacity and the widespread nature of the worship of *Ala* all over Igbo land is a strong pointer to the fact that the earliest religion here is matrifocal and that there may have been a Supreme Goddess, *Nneka* or *Nnem Chukwu*. This is often portrayed in the ancient sculpture of the Igbo, especially the Igboukwu pot, which has an image of a woman carrying children on her laps and having an *ichi* scarification on the forehead. *Ichi* is maintained by Acholonu (2009) to mean "the identification scar of Igbo god-men (women) called *Nze na Ozo* and of Igbo gods and goddesses." (p.82).

Conclusion

It is not an exaggeration to believe that the earliest Igbo society may have been a matrifocal community. But however it is seen, no sex subjugates the other since there existed two worlds in Igbo worldview that rather

complements one another. The women lived in their world and ruled it. Green (1946) remarks of a case where women pulled all the men to the oracle to swear against a conspiracy to hurt the women world and this they did before there was peace. Also Leith-Ross (1939) refers to the women in the famous Aba women riot of 1929 as "irate women" (p.97). This action of the women brawled at the minds of the colonial masters as they could not understand our women on the backlight of their Victorian women. That was the reason of the mission of Leith-Ross to understudy our women. Basden (1966) reiterates that the women "are the purveyors of the salt and savour of the men's lives!" (p.90). Acholonu (1995) avers that women were at the foundation of the Igbo society. She maintains that the colonialist marginalization of women socially and politically is a planned strategy to weaken the very foundation of the society, its inherent power and spirituality in order to destabilize the people and gain full control.

The issue of widowhood which so many point at as a sign of patriarchy is not an affair of men but women living and ruling their world. A woman may not be married just by one person but to the whole lineage. After *ikwa di* comes *ikwa ajadu* and this means the re-absorption of the woman into the family, whereby an elder brother to the husband becomes the husband of the widow. Thus *ikwa di* is a rite of passage for the re-absorption of the widow into the lineage. Like all rites of passage not all widows are qualified for the next level of existence. Widows who are so arrogant and proud that they cannot undergo such experiences choose to leave the family and some also choose to re-marry. As Turner (1967) explained, the neophytes for initiation (rite of passage) go into liminality, a kind of passivity to the normal life processes and undergo a harrowing experience that implants the system of the new life into their being. It is not peculiar with widowhood. The masquerade cult and Nze na Ozo cult also are rites of initiation, where similar or more harrowing experiences happen.

Life is rather built around the woman, though unassuming like *Ala*, she is humble; like *mmili*, water, she is beautiful yet nameless; assuming the name of the man and later, the family. The more tangible urstoffs are

male, yet humble/unassuming but show their teeth when life is at stake, here they had even assumed the roles of men.

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CHAPTER TWO

SLAVE TRADE IN NIGERIA AND ITS CULTURAL CONSEQUENCES

Anthony Obinna Ezennaka, PhD

Introduction

Besides inter-tribal wars and diseases, slave trade was one of the most devastating events that wreak havoc on the African continent for about centuries, including Nigeria. This chapter delves into the history of slave trade in Nigeria and its far-reaching consequences on Nigerian culture. will highlight the first stage of slave trade which was the trans-sahara slave trade, the second state which was the trans-atlantic and the third stage which is the modern slave trade (trafficking and child labour).

The Trans-Saharan Slave Trade

Trans-Saharan slave trade also known as Arab Trade started around the 8th century AD to 17thC AD. It was a trade carried between the Arab world (North Africa and the Persian Gulf) and sub-Saharan Africa. Caravan of carmels was the major means of transportation in crossing the hostile and dangerous climes of the Saharan desert. The commodities initially traded were gold and salt. Gold was in abundance in the western part of Africa was traded in exchange with salt which was scarce in North Africa. Africa Goods from North Africa to West Africa included weapons, clothes, beads, medicine and salt. Goods from West Africa to North Africa included the following: Gold, Ivory, Silver, Skins and hides, Food stuffs, Kola nuts, Ostrich feathers (Rwandan Education Board 2024)

However, with time, human beings gradually became items of exchange as the need for manpower grew on the northern part of the continent (Kehinde,2013). The three major ancient routes for this trade that made those who knew and controlled them to be prosperous in the trans-Saharan trade were: Taghaza to Timbuktu in the western sahara, the

Slave trade means human trafficking

hat connected the oasis town of Ghadames with trade centers in Hausaland, and route connecting the major Mediterranean port city of Tripoli with Bornu in the Central African interior (OpenStax, 2024). Kanem-Bornu empire was one of those groups that cashed into this knowledgeto be prosperous and famous during this period. The trade was characterized by raids and conquering of neighbouring states in which Islamic religion was spread along (OpenStax, 2024).

The discovery of the New world- Americas in the 15th and 16th C by the Europeans and the need to establish controls over territories in this places and boost their national wealth made them woo the African controllers of Trans-Saharan trade with their luxury exotic goods and guns. This was one of the major factors that weakened the trans-saharan slave trade. Recognizing an opportunity to profit, chiefs on the African mainland engaged in raids against their neighbors to generate captives they could sell to the Europeans—first to the Portuguese and later to the Dutch, Spanish, French, and English' (OpenStax, 2024). In essence, the following factors weakened and caused the end of trans-saharan trade:

Factors that Weakened and Caused the End of the Trans-Saharan Slave Trade

According to Rwanda Education Board (REB, 2024), the following factors brought to an end the trans-saharan slave trade

(i) Slave trade was abolished and thus Trans-Saharan Trade could not continue. Slaves were an important item of the trade.

(ii) The introduction of cheap European goods made the African goods to lose market. This led to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade.

(iii) Increasing insecurity along the trade routes also discouraged the traders leading to its decline.

(iv) The trade declined because of the discovery of gold in other parts of the world. For example, the discovery of gold in America.

(v) It also declined due to the constant shortage of water. Most oases dried up.

(vi) The death of important kings led to the decline of the trade. Such kings included Mansa Musa of Mali Empire and Askia Mohammed of Songhai Empire.

(vii) The trade declined because of the downfall of some West African empires. Such empires included Mali, Songhai, and Ghana.

(viii) The rise and development of Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade led to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade. Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade was more profitable than Trans-Saharan Trade.

(ix) The trade also declined because of high taxation imposed on the traders in West Africa. High taxation reduced their profits.

(x) The discovery of the sea route through the Mediterranean Sea to West Africa also led to its decline.

(xi) There was a shortage of raw materials such as gold and ivory. This led to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade.

(xii) The colonisation of Africa by the European powers made these Europeans to become controllers of Africa. This led to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade.

Acooring to REB (2024), the following are the participants and the role they played in the Trans-Saharan Trade

1. Participants in the Trans-Saharan Trade

(a) The Berbers

These were the people of North Africa. They played the following roles: controlling the trade, providing capital, organising the caravans across the desert, employing the tuaregs who acted as guides

(b) The Tuaregs

These were the people of the Sahara Desert. They played the following roles in the trade: Providing water for the caravans, Providing food for the caravans, acting as guides to the caravans across the desert, providing labour in the salt mines

c) The West African people

They played the following roles: Owning the gold mines, providing agricultural products, working as slave raiders, providing security to the traders in West Africa, acting as a market to European products.

(d) Europeans and Arabs

They brought goods from Europe and Asia to North Africa. They exchanged these goods for West African products.

Effects of the Trans–Saharan Trade

According to Rwandan Education Board (2024) the following were the effects Trans-Saharan Trade:

(i) The trade led to the exploitation of African resources such as minerals, ivory and agricultural products. That led to their exhaustion.

(ii) It led to the introduction of new commodities in West Africa such as beads, clothes and guns.

(iii) It led to the development of many trading centres/towns that grew into big cities. Such centres were Tripoli, Fez, and Timbuktu.

(iv) It led to the development of trade routes that have become permanent roads till today.

(v) The trade also provided employment opportunities to many people such as guides, guards and porters. It improved their standards of living.

(vi) Many people who participated in the trade became rich. For instance, kings of West Africa and the Arabs.

(vii) The trade also created a lot of suffering to the Africans. Most of them were taken into slavery.

(viii) It also led to depopulation of many areas due to slavery.

(ix) It led to the introduction of Islam into West Africa. This was due to the participation of many Arabs in the trade.

(x) It led to intermarriages between the Arabs and the Africans. This gave rise to a new race of coloured Africans.

(xi) It led to the spread of Islamic education. For example, Islamic universities were established in Mali and Songhai.

(xii) The trade also brought many Arabs into West Africa. These Arab settled there permanently.

(xiii) The trade also created a lot of insecurity as guns were brought in big numbers.

(xiv) It also brought Islamic architecture into West Africa. Most of the buildings resembled those of the Islamic world.

(xv) It introduced camels into North and West Africa. The camels were the major means of transport.

(xvi) It led to the decline of local industries because of the introduction of cheap foreign goods.

(xvii) The trade led to the rise and expansion of empires such as Ghana, Mali, and Songhai. This was because the empires got a lot of wealth in form of taxes from the trade.

(xviii) The Arabic culture including language, dressing and cooking were introduced.

(xix) The trade created a permanent relationship between North and West Africa, and the Arab world.

(xx) It led to the European colonisation of Africa because European powers wanted to stop slave trade.

Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade

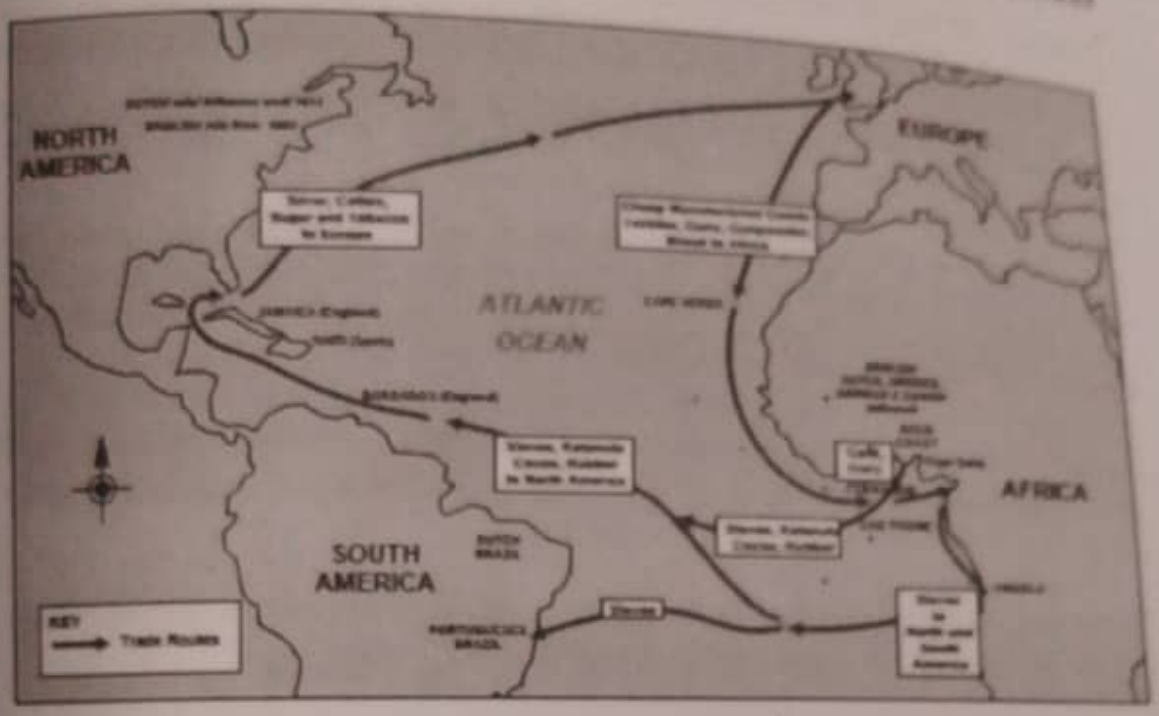


Image was extracted from
https://elearning.reb.rw/course/view.php?id=635&section=9

The transatlantic slave trade in Nigeria spanned several centuries, from the 15th to the 19th century. It is also called the Triangular trade because its movement is from Europe to West Africa, and from West Africa to America and back to Europe. Major ports and routes used were Lagos, Calabar, Bonny, and the Bight of Biafra (Northrup, 2013). Various ethnic groups were affected, including the Igbo, Yoruba, Edo, and Efik (Afigbo 1981). As noted by Falola (2002), "Nigeria's strategic location on the West African coast made it a major hub for the transatlantic slave trade (p. 23).

The transatlantic slave trade has this circle and goods traded in exchange through these routes:

Route 1: Europe to Africa
European goods such as: Textiles materials, ammunition and firearms, alcohol, metal goods. These were traded for: African slave, gold and ivory

Route 2: Africa to the Americas

The captured people sold out as slaves to the European slave masters were forcibly taken to the Americas to work on plantations, especially in the Southern colonies of North America (present-day United States), Caribbean islands, South America (present-day Brazil, Argentina, and others). The European traders received in exchange the following items. Raw materials like cotton, hides and skin, sugar, tobacco, and, precious metals such as silver and gold.

Route 3: The Americas to Europe

The slave from Africa working in the plantations and mines help to provide the raw materials and precious metals from the Americas and were shipped back to Europe. The industrialized Europe processed and manufactured these items into finished goods.

The trade circle continues because these goods are sold for profit which in turn aided further trade and colonization.

The Great Triangular Trade or the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade has devastating consequences, which are but not limited to the forced migration and enslavement of millions of Africans, the destruction of communities, and the long-lasting impact on the social and economic structures of the regions involved.



Chained slaves on their way to market centres



A chain used to tie slaves

Copied from Rwandan Education Board, 2024

Factors that Led to the Abolition of Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade

According to REB (2024) the following factors necessitated the end of trans-Atlantic slave trade

(i) The British government, through parliament, banned (stopped) slavery in 1807. It was found out that free labour was cheaper than forced labour.

(ii) Some humanitarians realised that slavery and slave trade were illegal both before God and before the Law. They started the campaigns for its abolition.

(iii) Slaves in the plantations often rioted, killed their masters and destroyed their property.

(iv) Economic factors in Europe led to the abolition of slave trade. For example, as a result of Industrial Revolution, machines could do work better than labour. Therefore, human labour of slaves was no longer needed.

(v) Britain and other European countries needed market in West Africa. They could not get it before establishing conditions. Therefore, they had to abolish slave trade.

(vi) The British industrialists needed more raw materials such as cotton for textile industries. They also needed palm oil to lubricate their industry machines. They agreed that slaves should be set free.

(vii) It was the British national interest to abolish slave trade. This was because if Trans-Atlantic Trade continued, it would have reduced the growth of industries.

(viii) Brazil and Cuba started to produce sugar cane in large quantities in the 19th Century. It was cheaper in European markets. Britain felt that slave trade was no longer profitable.

(ix) The American Revolution of 1776 against the British colonial masters undermined slave trade. Colonies in America declared themselves independent. Britain changed her attitudes towards these

colonies. Britain started to invest in industries which needed less human labour.

(x) The introduction and development of legitimate trade made the abolition of slave trade possible. It created a new type of economy where European and African traders would benefit. It was profitable to sell raw materials than selling slaves. It was also cheaper to transport raw materials than slaves.

(xi) The French Revolution of 1789 emphasised liberty, fraternity, solidarity and equality of all human beings. The revolution helped to create awareness about human rights.

(xii) The rise of men with new ideas in Europe. Great thinkers (philosophers) such as Voltaire preached against slave trade and slavery in the world.

(xiii) The declaration of independence of the Maroons (ex-slaves) in Jamaica. This raised a lot of concern. Slave owners started looking at slaves as a liability than as an asset.

(xiv) The exploration of the interior of West Africa by Europeans helped to abolish slave trade. The European and African associations were interested in the scientific and geographical problems. They were also interested in market for European manufactured goods. Slaves were no longer an issue to reckon with.

(xv) The new policy of colonization of Africa could not succeed if slave trade was still on. In order to colonize and exploit African resources it was important to first stop slave trade. It was only then that colonialists could make themselves acceptable in Africa.

Modern Slavery

With time, trans-sahara and trans-atlantic slave trade became obsolete due many reasons as stated above which were brought about by modernity, so to say. The modern time, however, has its shortcomings and challenges towards the respect to human freedom and dignity. Hence, the different avenues and practices that compelled disadvantaged individuals to engage in acts that are dehumanizing for the sake of pleasing their masters or for any gain

financial, social, and otherwise is modern slavery. United States Congress (2000) described this phenomenon as "Trafficking in persons," "human trafficking," and "modern slavery", involuntary servitude, slavery or practices similar to slavery, debt bondage, and forced labour. Modern slavery does not necessary involve movement of persons, goods and services but any act carried out that may directly or indirectly impact on the victim as being compelled or deceived to render services that is dehumanizing and tantamount to slavery.

Some of the aspects of modern slavery are **sex trafficking** (and child sex trafficking), **forced labour** which could in the form of bonded labour or debt bondage, domestic servitude, worst forms of child labour, unlawful recruitments and use of child soldiers; forced marriage (United States Congress, 2000; Australian Government, (n.d.) . Nonetheless, modern slavery entails exploitation but does not include practices like substandard working conditions or underpayment of workers (Australian Government, n.d.)

However, to forestall the menace of modern slavery on the victims, countries and organizations have enacted several act with regards to this. Some of these countries are the United States of America, United kingdom and Australia. For instance, the Commonwealth *Modern Slavery Act 2018*. The Act established a national Modern Slavery Reporting Requirement. 'The Reporting Requirement supports the Australian business community to identify and address their modern slavery risks, and maintain responsible and transparent supply chains'.

Cultural Consequences of Slave Trade in Nigeria

1. **Loss of cultural identity**: Enslavement, forced assimilation and modern slavery resulted in the suppression of Nigerian cultures, languages, and beliefs.

2. **Syncretism and cultural fusion**: The diffusion of traditional Nigerian cultures with European and Christian influences gave rise to the creation of new cultural practices and beliefs that is alien.

3. **Impact on traditional art and craft**: The slave trade, subsequent colonialism and modern slavery inhibited the development of

Nigerian traditional art and craft, leading to a decline in some traditional art and culture.

4. **Disruption of traditional institutions and values**: The slave trade paved way for colonialism which led to the erosion of traditional institutions, cultural practices, and values.

5. **Disruption of social structures**: Modern slavery disrupts family and community traditional social structures with deceptive and/or coerced incentives.

6. **Exploitation of cultural practices**: Traffickers often manipulate and exploit cultural practices, by the use of some traditional rituals and beliefs, to hypnotize, recruit and control victims of modern slavery.

7. **Stigma and shame**: Survivors of modern slavery often live with the stigma and shame. This is aggravated by the cultural system in Nigeria, hence, making it very challenging and difficult for the victims to reintegrate into their communities.

Some of the specific cultural consequences in Nigeria include:

- The slave trade weakened the strength of Igbo people's traditiona social and political structures leading to a decline in their traditiona systems of governance. This made *Things Fall Apart* easily durin the era of British colonization.

- The Yoruba people equally were significantly impacted on the cultural and religious practices. Some of their traditional institution and customs stifled or watered down.

- 'The Hausa people's Islamic traditions and cultural practices wer influenced by the trans-Saharan slave trade whereby values we shared and some lost to religious influence and conquest.

Despite these negative influences, Nigeria culture had som reconstructive significant influences:

- **Cultural Exchange and Diffusion:** The transatlantic slave tra facilitated cultural exchange and diffusion between Nigeria and oth

cultures. As noted by Thornton (1998), "African cultures, including Nigerian cultures, were significantly influenced by European and African diasporic cultures during the slave trade era" (p. 12). This cultural exchange led to the adoption of Christianity, Western education, and European customs (Ejiofor, 2016).

- **Cultural Revival and Reconciliation:** Efforts to revive and celebrate Nigerian cultural heritage are ongoing. As noted by Ejiofor (2016), "initiatives such as the Nigerian Cultural Festival and the African Diaspora Festival are promoting cultural revival and reconciliation" (p. 15).
- **Cultural Resilience and Revival**: Despite the devastating impact of the transatlantic slave trade, Nigerian cultures have shown remarkable resilience and revival. According to Afigbo (1981), "Nigerian cultures have preserved many traditional practices and customs, despite centuries of colonization and cultural suppression" (p. 23).

Conclusion

Slavery in any form is a crime against humanity and should be shunned at all cost and in all ramifications. Through character education, these modern evils of enslavement are fought against by institutions, organizattions, States and the entire world.

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il War

e immediate post-Vatican II years were a period of intense upheaval
l warfare in Igboland. Nigeria achieved political independence in
60, but the union was fragile. The peoples of southeast Nigeria,
luding the Igbo, declared independence in 1967, proclaiming the
ion south and east of Enugu as the republic of Biafra. Enugu was
ignated as Biafra's capital. In a traumatic civil war that lasted until
70, as many as two million civilians died of starvation (a policy of
ckade of food and medicine imposed by the federated state of Nigeria
a weapon of war), and a generation of men was lost in battle before the
laration of "no victor and no vanquished"- an important rhetoric
scription of the war by Gen. Gowon to heal wounds. The starvation
ulting from the blockade during the Biafran war was known
rldwide as a "colossal humanitarian crisis". Though the peace which
lowed was surprisingly non-retributive, the devastation and
poverishment was considerable, and institutions and social life had to
rebuilt out of the ruin. The missionaries and international Catholic
arities provided extensive relief materials during the blockade, and
gerian government ensured that the war marked the end of the Irish
ssionary era there. The state also subsequently assumed control over
vast number of primary schools operated by Christian churches,
cessitating the end of Shanahan's mission strategy.

ritas cargo planes were attacked repeatedly with bombs day and night
they supplied tons of dried milk, corned beef, salt, egg yolk, dried milk
d other critical things made available by Caritas.

uring the Biafran War (1967-1970), also known as the Nigerian Civil
ar, the missionaries' intervention in providing humanitarian assistance,
rticularly in combating starvation in the breakaway Biafran region,
ayed a significant role. The Biafran War was a devastating conflict that
sulted in a severe humanitarian crisis, including widespread hunger and
rvation among the civilian population.

ere are some key points regarding the missionaries' intervention during
e Biafran War and the circumstances that led to their ejection from
igeria:

reveals:

Chief Adunchezor: we are glad that the Unizik students came ... and we did our best to assist them. Yes, there are issues of ... grabbing here and there and we are doing our best to address ... matters. Like I told some of your students, some of these ... are already in court. For the Homosexuality thing, I really ... that worrisome, Amudo is not known for such and I ... don't think it can be considered a problem for our people. Yes, fetish practices are carried out everywhere, no one can deny that. It even depends on what you mean by fetish ... anyway the last bit of the drama may not be realistic here ... are a very deeply religious people, almost every house you ... around here are catholic families, so I doubt that we would ... community, bring in a chief priest or priestess to solve ... problems for us; very doubtful.

In slight contrast, the Public Relations Officer of the Awka South Local Government, Hon. Austin Nwafor, representing the Chairman speaks of the group B production as follows:

Hon. A. Nwafor: The truth is that what we have witnessed ... today gladdens our heart. We interacted with the students during their preliminary visits and rehearsals. Indeed, we need to applaud them. They interviewed me thoroughly to ascertain the issues we encounter here in the Local Government. We talked about corruption in this system and other issues such as Absenteeism and Truancy. From the interactions, I found out that they were also taught very well. On behalf of the Awka South L.G.A and the Chairman, when I am representing, I want to say that we have learnt tremendously from this project. Even staff here has learnt from this project. The state government aware of some of the issues raised here today and we will continue to collaborate with your department until the right things are done.

conflict between Nigeria and Biafra as an internal crisis and thus will not intervene. However, Nigeria garnered greater support from nations of the world and eventually over powered Biafra given numerous negative and inhuman war policies that eventually caused the surrender of Biafra.

Although Gowon at the end of the war declared 'No Victor No Vanquish and later enacted the policy for reconciliation which was called the 3Rs (Reconciliation, Rehabilitation and Reconstruction), Gowon did very little to restore the war-torn eastern Nigeria (defunct Biafra land)

Conclusion

Nigerian colonial experience marked the beginning of Nigerian challenges, including political, economic and socio-cultural. The major challenge faced by Nigeria since the mid-20th century is imbedded in ethnic discrimination which has succeeded in unveiling other crises witnessed by Nigeria over the years. It is true that colonialism has ended but Nigeria is yet to leap over the effect of colonialism and the subsequent infiltration of neo colonialism, which has done nothing but handicapped the nation's economic and political sovereignty. For a better future, Nigeria may however strive to achieve economic independence by establishing serious industrialization and structure her development based on important and reliable economic bases and not on regional or ethnic standpoint.

Endnotes

[1] Ngozi Ojiakor, "The History of Nigeria" in (ed) *G.C. Unachukwu et al. Nigeria Peoples and Culture* (Enugu: John Jacob's Classic Publishers Ltd, 2003) 10.

[2] Tunde Odegowi, "From conquest to Independence: The Nigerian Colonial Experience" *HAOL*, No. 25 (Primavera, 2011), 19-29 ISSN 1696-2060

has always been a thing of pride to associate with a missionary owned or run schools. Today, Nigerian leaders, both in public life and in politics, education, church, commerce and industry owe their education, training, in whole or in part from the manual labour of the missionaries.

What Fr Lutz, Bishop Shanahan, Bishop Ajai Crowther, Bishop Charles Heery and other early missionaries started in about two centuries ago now gave birth to the church, and for its sustainability, Christians should strive to revive the spirit of this great African missionaries.

Contradistinction Between The Missionaries And The Colonialists

The early missionaries and colonialists had different motivations and approaches in their interactions with the Igbo people. Here are some points of contrast between the works of early white missionaries and colonialists who siphoned resources in Igbo land:

1. **Motivations:**

- **Missionaries**: The early missionaries were primarily motivated by religious zeal and a desire to spread Christianity and its teachings among the Igbo people. Their focus was on spiritual and social transformation.

- **Colonialists**: Colonialists were often motivated by economic interests, seeking to exploit the resources of the land for the benefit of their home countries. They engaged in practices that siphoned resources from the local population for their own gain.

2. **Approach to Education**:

- **Missionaries**: The missionaries established schools and educational institutions to promote literacy and education among the Igbo people. They saw education as a means to uplift and empower the local population.

- **Colonialists**: While some colonialists did establish schools, their primary focus was often on providing education that served the interests of the colonial administration and facilitated the exploitation of resources rather than empowering the local population.

while yet a good number of people donated fund to the Civil Defense to a total of £1.02 million by the end of that same day.[22] Between 31st May and 5th July, 1967, series of measures were taken by Nigeria in preparation to annihilate the new state of Biafra. The Northern military Governor Lieutenant Colonel Usman Hassan Katsina boosted that "Biafra will be overrun in a matter of hours".[23] Biafran cargos were detained in Apapa wharf by the Lagos government; public telecommunication and postal services in Biafra were suspended by Gowon. Gowon disrespected Biafran right on the high sea by intercepting ships heading to Biafran ports; this interception was aimed at interrupting import and export of goods in Biafra.

By 29th of June, Nigerian troops were camped on borders between Northern Nigeria and Biafra and on the 6th of July, 1967, Nigerian troops invaded Biafra through three border points between Biafra and Northern Nigeria. At the beginning of the war, the Yoruba people declared their exemption from the war, although their soldiers were in the words of Ojukwu 'cajoled' into joining the war at the later part of the war period, perhaps when Gowon saw that Biafra was after all not an easy prey as was envisaged by the Nigerian and their British counterpart. .

Few weeks into the war, the Biafran troops had gained control of the Midwestern region and were advancing to Lagos to seize Gowon. On seeing Biafran rate of advancement Gowon was thrown into panic; he evacuated valuable assets from Lagos to the North and made arrangements to flee. Britain and America advised Gowon against leaving Lagos, with Britain promising to supply more artilleries to Nigeria. Russia also supported Nigeria with massive military artilleries, all of which encouraged Nigeria to build a bigger army and pressed more on Biafra.[24] America on the other hand had claimed the position of non-interference with the reason that the war was an internal dispute but still provided diplomatic support which in the real sense tilted towards the support of Nigeria. Ojukwu accounted that "Britain and Russia provided Nigeria with artillery bombs and mortar shells which have caused so much destruction in Biafran towns, they provided the planes and aerial bombs with which hundreds. On July 11th, the US declines aid request by Gowon to deal with Biafra, with the inference that America considers the

Part of the motivating factors that triggered their interest on mission was their founders' missionary ideology to carry the gospel to the ends of the earth. They started with the introduction of missionary policies and methods through contacts with the people, their religion and culture and went into proper missionary apostolates - like, the building of schools, hospitals and establishment of mission churches which they nurtured until they were able to produce indigenous personnels charged with consolidation of all catholic schools and hospitals in the region.

Setting the stage:

Africans of Igbo ancestry from Sierra Leone in the person of Reverend Taylor and Bishop Ajai Crowther were the first to preach the Gospel in Igboland (Onitsha) in 1857, on behalf of the Anglican Church Missionary Society, which subsequently sent white missionaries. The first sustained Catholic mission, led by French Holy Ghost (Spiritan) priests, arrived in the area of Igboland east of the Niger in 1885. Christianity made negligible inroads until the twentieth century, under newly consolidated British colonial rule. Much as Christian success relied on colonial expansion, historians still struggle to explain why Christianity was so much more successful in Igboland than among other nearby Nigerian peoples who also lived under colonial rule. On the heels of the Anglicans, Irish Holy Ghost missionaries, who replaced their French confreres, established a mission center in Onitsha and other villages. Their strategy depended a great deal on building of schools and hospitals, and on invitations from village chiefs for establishment of schools and hospitals in their communities, even though the chiefs were still practicing their traditional religion.

In Southeast Nigeria, Igbo Christianity began with the arrival of both Anglican and Spiritan missionaries in onitsha in 1857 and 1885 respectively and thrived with the efforts of Bishops Ajai Crowther (1864-1891) and Bishop Joseph Shanahan (1905-1931). The mission was slow as these men had no knowledge of Igbo (the language the people spoke) and were unable to grasp the deep and uncommon religiosity embedded in the cultural life of the people. With resilience and perseverance however, the missionaries ultimately succeeded in sowing the seed of the new faith in the hearts of a people that have since become harbingers

CHAPTER THREE

INTER-GROUP RELATIONS IN NIGERIA BEFORE THE BRITISH CONQUEST

Daniel Chukwuma Nzereogu, PhD

Introduction

This paper is a discussion on the nature of relations or interactions th existed among the various ethnic nationalities in what is now Nige before the British colonization of the territory. There are more than 2 ethnic nationalities within the territory that is today referred to as Niger The three largest groups are the Igbo, Hausa and Yoruba. Th numerous ethnic nationalities were existing as sovereign enti independent of one another but they were relating and interacting w one another long before the British conquest in the second half of the century.

It is important to note that pre-colonial societies in what is today kno as Nigeria, were not aliens to one another before the coming of Europeans. Most times, regarding the origin of diplomacy references made to the Greek City-states, the Italian as well as the French syste but it is evidently clear that diplomacy was not just an European affair was indeed a human affair, and Nigerian societies had been practic diplomacy even in pre-colonial times. According to Njoku (2003), *"it fact that prior to the incursion of external factors in her histor evolution, African peoples were not strangers to diplomatic relationsh and co-operation. By virtue of the fact that there existed organi societies in Africa within this period, at varying levels of evolut diplomacy necessarily constituted a facet of group living"*. Thus attempt is made to reconstruct the pre-colonial history of inter-gr relations in Nigeria. This has become necessary in order to challenge notion or view that diplomacy is an exclusive privilege of for interference in African societies. This study on the contrary shows

pre-colonial societies most especially in Nigeria through inter-group relations were involved in diplomatic practices with each other.

Inter-group relation is an essential ingredient of human existence. Right from the pre-historic age when people began to come together in societies, it became necessary for them to co-exist and co-operate in the titanic struggle against nature and in the efforts to subdue and master the environment to man's advantage. Initially, it could be possible that human beings, in their little groups, were capable of satisfying most, if not all, of their simple wants. Thus there was little need to seek interaction with other groups. However, as society evolved and human needs grew more complex, various human communities realized the need for interactions and relations. Thus, for example, it was not unusual for neighbouring communities to have border disputes, even in pre-colonial times, which sometimes led to serious conflicts. Out of these differences and the need to maintain peaceful co-existence of diverse communities, as they sought for a good life, arose the need for inter-group relations, which gradually became more sophisticated as human societies evolved. Therefore, inter-group relations have been a feature of all types of organized human communities, from villages to city-states, to kingdoms and empires, to modern nation-states.

Pre-colonial Nigerian societies could be categorized in two groups. The first group comprised entities with political systems that were centralized. These centralized societies included states, empires and kingdoms with monarchical political systems. Some prominent ones were the famous empires of Oyo, Kanem-Bornu and Benin kingdom. From historical evidence these societies were quite familiar with the art and science of living together, co-existing and co-operating with their neighbours, which in essence involves inter-group relations, (Stride & Ifeka, 1971).

The second group of which the Igbo belong, is comprised of political systems that could best be described as segmentary societies, not possessing a centralized political systems. They are most times referred to as stateless societies, (Njoku, 2003). The implication of such a description in a scholarly examination of the nature of diplomacy in a pre-colonial Igboland is obvious. But evidence abound to prove that the absence of conventional political features in Igbo societies did not mean a

lack of a formal political structure by which functions which resulted in the comparatively harmonious co-existence and inter-group relations were performed. Thus, for the purpose of inter-societal and inter-group relations there existed structures in Igbo societies to facilitate such roles, for example the elders in Igboland known as 'Ndichie' had the power to declare war on neighbouring villages subject to certain recognized rules of inter-village diplomacy.

Hence the focus of this discuss is to highlight the factors that enhanced relations among the various ethnic nationalities in what is now Nigeria, point out the reasons for ethnic rivalry in present day Nigeria and then proffer solutions.

Factors That Promoted Inter-Group Relations In Nigeria Before British Conquest

Here we shall examine the factors which promoted interactions among the various communities of Nigeria. No Nigerian group can be treated in isolation of the others. It was neither possible nor realistic for any community to ignore its neighbours. In fact, the economic and political survival of a community depended on the relationship, whether friendly or hostile, which it had with its neighbours. Group relations implied cooperation between different states. This could take the form of trade, diplomatic ties, management of trade routes as well as wars. Below we shall examine the major factors that facilitated inter-group relations among the various ethnic groups in Nigeria before the British conquest.

Relations promoted by trade and trade routes

Ecological differences makes for specialization in the production of certain commodities. Coastal areas would most likely be dominant in the production of sea foods while areas in the hinterland would specialize in the production of other commodities produced and processed on land. It was by means of trade that exchanges of various commodities produced in different ecological zones are transferred from one area to the other thereby enhancing relations among the various groups. For example it is by means of trade that kola nut that is massively produced in western Nigeria is heavily consumed in the north and highly celebrated in the east, thus facilitating relations among the three major groups, (Falola, et al, 2006).

Trade was perhaps the most important factor which linked many groups together. No community was self-sufficient in the production of agricultural and manufactured goods which it required either for its necessities or luxuries. Differences in physical environment and geographical factors tended to promote trade contacts and hence, inter-group relations a region could be noted for the production of a particular commodity which was lacking in other regions. For instance, people in the south-west produced kola nuts which they sent to their counterparts in the north in exchange for cattle and cattle products. An area could also be suitable for the large scale manufacture of a product, the surplus of which had to be taken to other places.

A community had to establish trade relations with another to obtain those goods that it could not produce. The Igbo maintained contacts with the Igala to obtain goods of northern origin. The Yoruba promoted peaceful relations with the Nupe in order to buy metal objects such as swords and knives and livestock. From around the 15th century onwards, the states in the hinterland generally courted the friendship of those at the coast to obtain European goods.

There also were developed centres of specialization in certain mining and manufacturing activities which attracted migrants and buyers from other groups. The plateau region was known for its tin, Ilorin and Iwo for iron and Benin for brass work. Craftsmen from some of these centres also plied their trade and settled in other parts of the country. Examples included Kano tinners, Benin carvers, Awka blacksmiths and Igala weavers who travelled out of their areas to immediate and distant places to practice.

Trade routes, contributed to interactions among different groups, thus further promoting inter-state cooperation. Trade routes linked the whole of Nigeria together. There were numerous waterways and roads. By their nature, rivers run through different states and the link they provided helped to promote inter-group relations. The River Niger, for example, strengthened the commercial links among the numerous peoples located along its banks. The Igbo used the lower Niger to communicate with the Ijaw on the coast. The famous Lagoon to the coast made it possible for

people from the Republic of Benin to go as far as Sapele, (Falola, et al, 2006).

The roads were more important than the waterways because they connected more towns and villages than the waterways. Through these roads were arrow footpaths, they were very adequate for traders and others who travelled on foot or on animals. The roads differed in importance, depending on those places which they linked together, such as local roads between one settlement and another, between towns and most especially the international highways passing through many territories.

Relations promoted by religious, social and cultural institution

Cultural exchanges also help to facilitate relations among the various ethnic groups in Nigeria. Culture being a people's way of life is shared across ethnic borders. Food, clothing etc, are all part of peoples culture which are shared across the ethnic groups in Nigeria thereby encouraging relations among them.

The various groups were also integrated by religious, political and social institutions. In every group there were many institutions which brought the people closer to one another.

Social, religious and political ideas spread from one area to another, a fact which points to contacts among groups and which also shows that Nigerians shared many things in common. Examples of cultural and religious contacts would be used here to emphasize inter-group relations. Many established customs and practices in the social life of a Nigerian group were often accepted by other groups. Generally, people borrowed from one another. In addition, traits spread from one area to another. There were varieties of cultural diffusion. According to Falola, et al (2006) diffusion could be intra-ethnic and this simply involved the exchange of ideas among people of the same ethnic group (i.e. Tiv, Igala). Diffusion could also be inter-ethnic meaning the exchange of ideas between two or more ethnic groups. Both varieties of diffusion were common and they promoted peaceful relations among our people. In the first variety of diffusion (that is intra-ethnic), many ideas spread within the same region in nearly all parts of the country. Changes in a particular

ustom in one area might be accepted in others. This partly explained the xchange of socio-cultural ideas (i.e. dress, social life, musical nstruments, notably drums and pipes, food and palace life) between the yo, the Ekiti, and the Ijesa.

he second variety (inter-ethnic) was common. Neighbouring states nfluenced one another just as the Kanuri and Hausa did. The Edo, oruba, Benin, Igbo, Igala, and Nupe also maintained contacts which ermitted exchange of ideas. Using the latter ethnic groups as an lustration, the masquerade cult probably spread from the Nupe to the oruba, Ebira, and Igala, the Ifa divination system orobably spread from gala to Igbo while the Benin omo bronze bell and Nupe ndako gboya nasquerade spread to Yoruba land. In the same way borrowed words and hrases from the language of their neighbours or people with whom trong contacts were established. For instance, the Yoruba borrowed everal words from Hausa.

Relations promoted by migration

Different factors cause people to migrate from one area to another. Factors such as wars and environmental hazards like drought make people to migrate from one area to another. Hence as people migrate relations among various groups are fostered and cultural exchanges as well take place in the process

Nigeria's history is full of examples of migrations from one area to another for political, economic and security reasons. Even within the same region or ethnic groups there were continuous and profuse migrations caused by disputes over succession to thrones, quarrels over chieftaincy titles, escape from threats of, or actual invasions and flights to avoid being punished for a criminal offence. Other forms and patterns of migrations include the movement of Islamic teachers, the forced migration of slaves and captives in war and attempts to find new dynasties by princes and other leaders in already established kingdoms. The migrations produced pockets of heterogeneous communities in different parts of the country, (Falola, et al, 2006).

Relations promoted by Diplomacy and the use of Envoys

Envoys are diplomatic agents representing the interest of their community in another, either as messengers or negotiators of peace during war. Before the British conquest of Nigeria these envoys move from place to place in carrying out their diplomatic duties and in the process created linkages that fostered relations across groups.

In order to maintain the links existing among states and to derive the benefits of peaceful coexistence, many Nigerian states deliberately maintain diplomatic ties with one another and were also conversant with the intricate art of diplomacy. Like their contemporary European nations Nigerian states regarded diplomacy as the art of conducting relations with other states so as to further the national interest. The goals of diplomacy were to promote peace or cause war, conclude treaties, maintain and break alliances, establish boundaries, develop and protect trade, and pay tribute.

Relations promoted by war

As strange as it sounds, war also played a part in fostering relations among groups. People do not fight war forever, at some point they have to end the war to negotiate peace and cordial relations are restored. Meanwhile war could also be seen as a form of relation by other means.

All the aforementioned attempts to sustain peaceful inter-group relations often break down and wars had to be fought among the states. When states could not convince one another through diplomacy, war became inevitable. War was an integral part of a state's relation with other states and can thus be rightly characterized as an evidence of inter-group relations. War has also been described as diplomacy by another means. The cause of wars was many, but the major one was the ambition of imperial states to extend their political control over other societies. Also many states went to war in order for its ruling class to obtain wealth by capturing slaves, extending their farmlands, exacting tributes from conquered territories, having access to trade and controlling trade routes.

Reasons For Ethnic Rivalry In Present Day Nigeria

It is arguably perplexing that the various ethnic groups that related with among themselves when they were independent and sovereign entities

now finding it difficult to cohabit as one country. There are reasons for this and they are:

The British style of Administration- the indirect rule system used by the British in administering Nigeria was more favorable in the north, partially favorable in the west and not favorable in the east. This situation therefore made the British to be friendlier with the areas where its system of administration was fully accepted, thereby sowing the seeds of suspicion and mistrust among the various groups leading to ethnic rivalry currently being experienced in Nigeria long after colonial rule.

The Unhealthy Amalgamation- the British economic enterprise was suffering deficit in the north and was enjoying surplus in the south, hence they opted to amalgamate the northern and southern protectorate in 1914 to form a single country known as Nigeria. This arrangement ensured that the surplus in the south was used to offset the deficit in the north. This same arrangement has continued till today, whereby the resources used in running the country are mainly generated in the southern part of the country. This situation has created so much disharmony and rivalry between the north and the south even till today.

Finding Solutions To Nigeria's Problem Of Ethnic Rivalry

National Dialogue

The various stake holders and regions in the country need to have sincere conversations on the terms of the union called Nigeria and whatever resolutions that arise from it must be taken seriously and implemented.

Dialogue is easily the most effective way to build consensus and resolve conflicts in any society. In Nigeria today, where we are faced with many challenges, the need to engage one another in purposeful dialogue has become more urgent. We must, therefore, continue to embrace the culture of dialogue as a civilized way to settle our differences in Nigeria. Democracy thrives on dialogue and it functions to build consensus, create understanding and enhance national cohesion, (Anyim, 2021).

Restructuring/Devolution of Powers

So much powers both economic and political powers are vested on the federal government, making it excessively powerful and overbearing,

hence the ... drive by various regions to grab the power at the centre is causing so much tension in the polity.

Nigeria is a country made up of so many ethnic nationalities with different historical antecedents, culture, language and even religion. Therefore if nation-building would be achieved in Nigeria, the principles of true federalism must be strictly adhered to. In a federal system of government, the tiers of government ought to share political powers as expressly spelt out in the constitution. But it is quite unfortunate that the foundation on which Nigeria constitution is operated especially since the current democratic dispensation has not reflected a true federal structure at all. The fact is that the structure of Nigeria as it is now is not working. And the way to fix it is to restructure our federation. According to Momodu (2016), the structural defects in Nigeria have become the single most important inhibition of its growth and development. Currently Nigeria has a strong center and weak states. The states are now more like administrative units of the federal government. The relationship between the centre and the state still reflects the military command structure which is a carryover from the military administration.

According to Ukoima (2016), it is a fundamental reality that Nigeria cannot have a strong and united federation unless and until the constituent parts are sufficiently empowered by enabling practices that conform to the principles of federalism.

Thus, restructuring Nigeria is our chance to rebirth a new Nigeria. The country as it is now needs to immediately implement the long-standing demand for a true federal structure both fiscally and structurally and the way to begin is to review the current revenue allocation formula which is lopsided and ensure a total devolution of powers. Indeed, if Nigeria would remain one and indivisible then restructuring our federation into a true federal state is a must.

Good Governance

Good governance will go a long way to calm nerves and ease the tension in the system. Bad governance creates an enabling environment for the political class to manipulate the citizens using ethnic and religious sentiments.

Bad leadership has remained the greatest problem besetting Nigeria since her independence. While some other countries in Europe and Asia have had strong and viable leadership which has led to their growth and development, Nigeria is still in search of a trail-blazing leadership for nation building.

The first step to ensuring good leadership is to ensure that the right leaders come on board through a free and fair election (Njoku, 2008). Hence a true democratic leadership is a pre-requite for nation building. Nigeria needs leaders who have exhibited their clear cut popularity at the polls devoid of rigging. This would make the leaders know that they are responsible to the people who voted them in and that they could be voted out if they fail to bring the dividend of democracy as well as development to the people. They would endeavour to bring development to the people by providing basic amenities and necessary infrastructures for the masses. When elections are rigged, it results in democratic-autocracy, where leaders act without considering the views and opinion of the people because they know that their mandate did not come from them, they tend to take laws into their hands and violate human rights. This kind of situation has a negative effect on nation building.

An aspect of good leadership that is necessary for nation building has to do with transparency and accountability. Nigerian leaders should see themselves as stewards of the people and so endeavour to be accountable to them and transparent as well, eschewing greed, and all forms of corruption and by so doing inspire the confidence of the people. When the people are confident of their leaders it enhances their confidence in the nation and nation-building would be a lot easier as nation-building can never be achieved unless confidence in the nation is developed among the people. Again, Nigeria needs leaders who are dully educated and have undergone leadership training in theory and practice, leaders with intellectual and technocratic skills. According to Njoku (2008) such leaders would possess dully thought-out philosophical background for any action and program initiated, with contingency plans to make up for the short falls inherent in such policies and their implementation. They would have the ability to coordinate and utilize the powers vested on them to mobilize the abundant human and material resources for the

development of the nation. If Nigeria should get such caliber of leaders opposed to what we currently have which consist of former military without any leadership training nation-building would be a lot achievable. This is because this caliber of leaders based on their train would be well abreast with all the intricacies involved with nat building and development.

Next is that as confidence is built among the people through leadership it motivates them to be willing to contribute their own towards national development and nation building.

Good leadership also involves good governance which according to United Nations Economic and Social Commission for Asia and Pacific includes participation of the led which could be either direct through legitimate intermediate institutions or representatives. It include accountability, transparency, responsiveness, effectiveness efficiency, equity and inclusiveness. It is important to note that equity inclusiveness in governance would reduce ethnic sentiment and cleav to the dearest minimum. Good governance ensures consensus is reac among the several actors and viewpoints in a given society. It as follows the rules of law. Good governance in Nigeria would ensure corruption is minimized, the views of minorities are taken into acco and that the voices of the most vulnerable in society are heard in deci making. It is also responsive to the present and future needs of soci Thus in the atmosphere of good governance Nigeria can indeed tow path of nation-building.

Conclusion

Inter-group relation in Nigeria before the British conquest was robust and vigorous. The various ethnic nationalities that make Nigeria were engaging with one another through the different discuss in this paper, hence it was not the European colonizers that facilit relations among them as they were not strangers before then. It was the style of activities and the manner of operation of the British in Nig that sowed the seed of rivalry among the various the ethnic nationali Nevertheless post independence, Nigerians as a people has responsibility of building a cohesive nation out of the pieces left be by the British colonizers. Thus through national dialogue, devolution

powers and good governance Nigeria can emerge as a strong and formidable country that it ought to be.

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CHAPTER FOUR

COLONIAL AND POST-COLONIAL NIGERIA: ROAD TO INDEPENDENCE AND CHALLENGE OF NATIONHOOD

Chinwe Alazor, PhD

Introduction:

The history of Nigeria is rather an interesting narrative with numer external interferences that shaped the trajectory of Nigeria as a nat Before the coming of the Europeans for the purpose of colonization regions that make up Nigeria today had existed independently diverse history, language, culture, religion and political formations.

In the mid-19th century, European invasion of African regions was in swing, involving European nations like Portugal, France, Bri Belgium, Germany, Italy and Spain, who were all interested in abundant natural resources in Africa. The struggle among these nat to occupy and control various African regions led to political m among them which they sought to settle at the Berlin conference of 1 1885 to ensure free trade and peaceful co-existence among Euro nations. The resolution of the Berlin conference among other th emphasized on the Principle of Effective Occupation and Sphe influence. This implies that for any European country to lay claim on African land, they must conquer the area and occupy effectively signing treaties with the local leaders, mount their flag and establi form of governance in the area. It was also required that other Europ nations must be notified of such occupation in order to avoid clashe interest. This period of African invasion, division and occupation however known as the Scramble and partition of Africa.

The British effective occupation was made possible by few major fact bombardment with the use of sophisticated weapons which were superior to the locally made ones, in the case of Niger Delta and par

Igboland; threat to use force as well as political sabotage in the case of Lagos; and dubious signing of treaty of protection in the case of Sokoto.

The end of slave trade gave rise to further exploration of Nigeria and penetration of the hinterland. The British started involving themselves with the political and military affairs of the people having resumed trade in commodities in the areas. With the help of their superior weapons, the British succeeded in coercively manipulating traditional rulers to do their bidding with the promise of protecting them against oppositions; Lagos and Niger Delta were cases in point. In other areas like Benin and Bonny, gun boat diplomacy was used to bring them to surrender their territory to the British[2]

The British first conquered Lagos in 1861, the Niger Delta area and Igboland in the late 19th and early 20th Century and named them the Southern Protectorate. The Northern Nigerian region also witnessed British bombardment, and between 1900 and 1906, the entire Northern Nigeria was brought under British rule and was named the Northern Protectorate. Meanwhile, the Northern protectorate, governed by Lugard, was said to lack economic sustainability because they had no access to the sea and thus required annual grant in aid from the British treasury (Ojiako and unachukwu), unlike the Southern protectorate (governed by Ralph Moore) which had abundant resources. In the bid to prevent the use of British resources to administer the Northern region, but to sustain the North with the wealth from the South, a merger of the diverse territories of the Southern and Northern protectorates was considered by the British, without credence to the peoples' heterogeneous and conflicting culture, tradition, religion and political system but for the sole purpose of serving the British economic interest. January 1, 1914 saw the complete amalgamation of the Northern and Southern protectorate to form one entity called Nigeria, with Fredrick Lugard as the first Governor General, the beginning of the challenges of ethnicity in Nigeria.

Notwithstanding the heterogeneous nature of Nigeria, freedom from colonial rule became a desire of virtually all regions later in the 20th Century, igniting a sense of nationalism and unity to fight for independence. Inasmuch as these efforts paid off through the achievement of Nigerian independence in 1960, the effect of colonial rule

and persistent British interferences has not been erased from Nigeria system. The first decade of Nigerian independence witnessed gruesome challenges which has continued to reflect on the Nigerian socio-politica and economic system today.

This chapter aims to acquaint the students with the rudimentary history o Nigeria, tracing the colonial policies and administration, the quest f national independence and the subsequent challenges of nationhood a sustainable national development.

Colonial Policies and Administration in Nigeria

The major aim of British colonization of Nigeria was to exert fu political and economic control of the area for maximum exploitation their natural resources. To achieve this, an effective administration w needed, especially as the British had shortage of officers and fund to ru the vast area. To bridge this gap, Lugard initiated the system of **Indire Rule** which is the use of traditional/local administration to administer t people under the supervision of the British colonial officers. Lugard initiative or decision to introduce indirect rule (a system which he used India) in Nigeria was as a result of his experience in the Northern part Nigeria. Northern Nigeria operated a centralized system of governme which provided the base for easy channel of British authority to the loc people. The British by this means transferred their policies a instructions through the traditional rulers to the local people.

Indirect Rule System

Although the introduction of indirect rule in Nigeria may have been a result of its success in other parts of the world like India as has be pointed out by scholars; the system was fundamentally adopted for economic benefits to the British. The British encountered administrati difficulty in the forms of shortage of fund and personnel as well language barriers and perhaps prevent possible confrontation by the lo people which was likely to erupt as resistance to alien administration. traditional rulers thus acted as tools for countering of possible obsta and for easy achievement of British colonial agenda. Considering authority of the traditional rulers on the local people, Lugard retained position of the northern native authority and placed them in charge

emirates and the local courts to serve the interest of British colonial policies.

Meanwhile, British colonial Nigeria was ruled by a Governor General with the help of appointed members of executive and legislative councils who played advisory roles to the governor general. It is germane to note that the executive body did not consist of any African while the legislative body consisted of only 4 Nigeria out of the 23 members of the council.[4] Nigeria was further divided into Provinces, Districts, and the Native Authority, administered by Residents, district officers and Native heads respectively. However, the native heads were made up of chiefs appointed by the British or existing traditional rulers retained because of their loyalty to the British administration. In the Northern region, the native heads were referred to as Emirs, Shehu, or Caliph as the case may be; while the warrant chiefs were appointed as native heads in the non-centralized areas of south eastern Nigeria.[5] Indirect rule system in Nigeria was a system of exploitation, subjugation and discrimination which was resisted in various degrees by different territories in Nigeria, especially from the Southern region. The system was however quite successful in the Northern region due to the existence of centralized institutions and taxation system which were already in place before British colonial incursion. The existing system in the Northern region was thus not different from what the British colonial system introduced, unlike what obtained in the South Eastern part of Nigeria. Again, the Emirs who wield great influence on the people were still left in charge of Emirates during colonial period. This enabled continued local administration but under the supervision and direction of the British officers.

The system recorded partial failure in the South. Although the Yoruba had traditional rulers, but did not have absolute centralized system of government as the Oba was not the sole authority but had traditional chiefs who ruled with him; also the Oba was not allowed by tradition to appear publicly. Absence of organized system of taxation was also of negative impact.[6] Indirect rule system was considered a complete failure in Igbo land; the Igbo non centralized political structure was the basis of this failure. There were no existence of any form of traditional rulers who

held absolute authority like the Emirs in the North or the Obas in Yoruba land. On the other hand, taxation system was not in existence in Igbo land. This means that all forms of British administration was alien to the Igbo people. The Igbo however practiced what Effiong Isaac Uba described as semi-democratic system of government . In the absence of absolute traditional authority in Igbo land, the British opted for the appointment of indigenous persons as 'Warrant Chiefs' to serve as British representative in the communities. This system thus extended to the south, the northern native authority system which was an alien system to the south.

The Warrant Chief System in Igbo Land

Warrant Chief System was the British colonial system of appointing ordinary native people as chiefs to take over the native authority of areas in Southern Nigeria where there were no existence of traditional rulers. Traditional rulers perceived to be disloyal to the British administration were deposed and replaced in the cases of Kosoko of Lagos and Overweren of Benin[8]. According to Afigbo, in many parts of Igbo communities, ordinary people of no traditional pedigree were appointed Warrant chiefs to serve as native officers[9]

The Warrant Chiefs served as British puppets used to exert colonial authority for easy control of the areas. They were issued certificate of 'Warrant' in the native court, as authority to sit in court, try court cases, collect taxes and carry out forced labour; this earned them the title 'Warrant Chief'; each local territory had warrant chiefs placed in charge of the native court. As a result of the power given to the warrant Chiefs they became notoriously powerful and malicious.[10]

In the second decade of the 20th Century, the British government on receiving complaint on the perceived failure of indirect rule in Eastern Nigeria, it was conceived that the problem was as a result of the fact that the appointed native chiefs were not traditional chiefs in the real sense of it and thus did not control any native treasury that would provide funds for local development. As a result of this, the Native Revenue ordinance which was enacted in the Northern provinces was suggested for the Eastern provinces. This ordinance entailed taking stock of the people and their wealth including cattle, goats, sheep and even economic trees, etc

placing taxes on them which were to be collected by the appointed chiefs. People of the Eastern Provinces protested against the introduction of taxation as well as the idea of conducting census on them. Afigbo projected that the people saw no sense in taxing indigenous people of the currency which could easily be minted by the British at their own convenience and need.[11] In addition to this, the period was saddled with hike in the price of imported manufactured goods which had already become basic needs of the people and the subsequent decrease in the price of palm produce – the main cash crop of Eastern Provinces.

By the later part of the 1920s, it was rumoured within the Eastern Provinces that the women would be included in tax payment. The effects of the dwindling economy and the newly introduced taxation, caused the rumour to ignite serious resistance from women in various part of the Eastern provinces, which was termed 'Women Riot of 1929. Although this riot was erroneously called the 'Aba Women Riot', it is pertinent to note that many women from various territories in the Eastern provinces organized themselves and conducted riots in different localities within the same period. It was there a riot conducted by women in parts of Eastern provinces against British colonial taxation and subjugation. The women vested their acrimony on the Warrant Chiefs who were used for the collection of the taxes; they were regarded as nefarious and exploitative with no positive representation. The women's reaction to taxation was not predicted by the colonial authorities and thus was a huge shock to them. It made glaring the hatred and lack of acceptance of the warrant chief system. The riot therefore brought the Warrant Chief System to an end.

The Warrant Chief system in the Eastern provinces of colonial Nigeria was short lived because of the peculiarities of the Igbo political system which differed from what obtained in other parts of Nigeria crumbled the system not too long after its introduction. The British inability to observe and give credence to existing indigenous political system in Eastern provinces seem to be the major reason for the failure of the system. It was thus an alien system which could not be accepted by the people. Even after the failure of the Warrant Chief System, efforts to remodel the native authority in the Eastern provinces seemed unproductive; it experienced continued remodeling and reformation because of lack of

central authority, existence of diverse culture, history and tradition within the Eastern provinces.

Constitutional Development

The colonial government administered Nigeria under different constitutions, each introduced by different colonial governor. After the amalgamation of 1914, Lugard who became the first Governor General of Nigeria enacted the Nigerian Council of 1914. Although it was believed that the purpose of the Nigerian Council was to give room for public opinion, it only served advisory role and performed no legislative roles. The Nigerian Council consisted of 36 members including six Nigerians in the non-official member category who were rarely present at the meetings.[12] The formational pattern of the Nigerian Council did not meet administrative needs of the people since they were excluded from partaking in making decisions that pertained to their development and wellbeing. Each constitutional change was however a result of nationalistic quest and agitation for better representation in the legislative council and inclusive governance. The Nigerian Council was revoked in 1922 and ushered in the Hugh Clifford Constitution, followed by the Richards constitution of 1946, the Macpherson Constitution of 1951 and the Lyttleton Constitution of 1954. The Clifford constitution introduced the election principles in the Nigerian system but only allowed four elected Africans out of the 27 unofficial members of the legislative council; three represented Lagos and one represented Calabar. There was therefore no provision for proper representation of other parts of Nigeria in the constitution.[13] Richard Constitution established constitutional unification of Nigeria. It created regional council for the North, the east and west and accommodated more Africans in the unofficial council including traditional chiefs. According to Olusanya, Richard constitution promoted Nigerian unity.[14] Macpherson constitution allowed even more indigenous representation. It provided a centralized legislature in the form House of Representatives, consisting 148 members. Although the representatives were denied powers over passage of certain Bills especially in respect to revenue, it was an improvement from the previous constitution which was achieved by constant Nationalist agitations and consultations. The 1951 constitution according to Ojiakor marked the beginning of power transfer to Nigerians.[15]

Constitutional changes established policies that rather separated the people along ethnic lines. It created reasons for the formation of ethnic based political parties – National Council for Nigerian Citizens (NCNC) dominated by the Eastern region, Northern People's Congress (NPC) by the Northern region and the Action Group by the Yoruba in the west. The constitution was rather divide and rule tactics which presented situations that created fallible socio-political unity and established ethnic politics. This was perhaps done to create disunity and prevent proper coordination and trust among the people of Nigeria so as to maintain continued domination of the area.

Nationalism

Nationalism refers to national consciousness, loyalty and commitment to one's nation against factors that oppose national interest or existence. Although nationalism began immediately after the British conquest of Nigeria in the form of territorial resistance against British incursion, its structural formation as organized movement became established in the 1920s. The main factor for the rise of Nationalist movement in Nigeria was the rise of educated elites who began to form associations, unions and organisations for the purpose of raising political consciousness in Africans. Notable Nigerian nationalists includes Herbert Macaulay, Nnamdi Azikiwe, Obafemi Awolowo, Tafawa Balewa, Ahmadu Bello, among others.

It is appropriate to note that Nationalist movement in Nigeria and other parts of Africa was an idea of pan Africanism which was an early 20th Century advocacy for African unity against colonial domination and discrimination. Most prominent African nationalists were influenced by pan African ideology carried out through numerous conferences held around the globe from the early 20th Century. The pan African conference of 1945 held in Manchester was where the idea of independence for African territories was first discussed. It was indeed from this conference that notable African Nationalists including Kwame Nkrumah of Ghana and Nnamdi Azikiwe of Nigeria gathered momentum to pursue and advocate for total independence of African nations. Azikiwe, who studied abroad with a renewed ideology and philosophy embarked on the purpose to freedom for Nigeria. He approached nationalism in the real sense of it,

advocating for freedom and independence through newspaper publications, rallies and public speaking; all of which brought about the rise of political parties.[16] The fact that major parties were formed along ethnic lines delayed independence of Nigeria which the British were already willing to relinquish by the middle of 20th Century. The unwillingness of the northern region to cooperate with the South on political issues contributed in no little measure to the delay of independence.[17] Coupled with the regional legislature established by the1951 constitution and maintained by the 1954 constitution, regional loyalty superseded national loyalty. Although Nigeria eventually attained independence on October 1, 1960, with a coalition government of the NPC and the NCNC, the political disunity among the regions persisted.

Challenges of Post-Colonial Nigeria

The attainment of independence in Nigeria came with feelings of high expectations and hope on the new independent nation. Nigeria was given a chance to prove her capacity in maintaining a sustainable and progressive economy without the British. Faced with the burdens of long term effect of political and economic domination of colonial rule, the new independent Nigeria witnessed political, economic, social and cultural challenges which created internal crisis and further divided the people along ethnic lines. Some of the major challenges of Nigeria at independence includes:

- **Dependency Syndrome**: Economy of Nigeria at independence was grossly agrarian, with raw materials as major base for export revenue. Existing industries established by the British were semi-processing industries which did not serve the needs for industrialization in Nigeria. Nigeria was dependent on foreign manufactured goods for survival and as such was saturated with persistent economic deficit.
- **Colonial alignment**: Early Nigerian leaders maintained friendship with the British, seeking advice and making national decisions that protects the interest of the British. Major personalities that found their way to leadership positions in Nigeria lacked advance knowledge and education on global politics and issues of neo colonialism. They were perhaps ex-

aligned to the pan African ideology which would have shaped their minds and availed them with the knowledge of British imperialism and the need for strong unity against it, rather than against the regions of Nigeria.

- **Ethnic and Political Crisis:** following existing regional disunity in the country, other issues aggravated it and established greater political instability in Nigeria. In 1962, a population census was carried out to aid proper structuring and allocation. The result of the population census was vehemently contested with complaints on issues of high irregularities. This called for the cancellation of the 1962 census with another census to be carried in 1963. The 1963 population census also recorded uncertainties on irregularities and number inflation but was accepted by the North and the South west but was rejected by Eastern Nigeria and the Midwest.

Northern region	=	29,777,968
Eastern region	=	12,388,646
Western region	=	10,278,500
Mid-west region	=	2,533,337
Lagos	=	675,352
Total Population	=	**55,653,821**[18]

The census result thus became the "status quo used as the basis for developmental projection, allocation of parliamentary seats, state creation, and so on".[19]

As the population crisis was barely contained, the federal election crisis ensued in 1964-65. The election was characterized by thuggery and intimidation; the Western region election crisis in October, 1965 with advanced electoral maneuvering and killing. It was indeed a period of political unrest in Nigeria.

Political instability persisted which also affected economic wellbeing of the nation; perhaps Nigerian leaders were preoccupies with the challenges of political uncertainties. In January 1966, some young army officers

CHAPTER FIVE

SACRIFICE OF THE EARLY MISSIONARIES CONTRADISTINCTION TO COLONIALISTS AMONG THE IGBO OF NIGERIA

Martin Orah, PhD

luction

onaries are those who travel far and wide to foreign countries to h the gospel of Christ, perform charitable work and mostly convert e to their faith. Missionaries spread the gospel in collaboration with ost communities to meet a need. They work to evangelize in a most ult areas and mostly among those who have not heard the gospel or ng the developing communities. Their work may include the olishment of schools and medical care. Their tasks depend on where are sent to and their specific apostolate.

ne of the Congregations have a missionary ideology which animated apostolate in mission lands. The Anglican and Spiritan counterpart e among the very first missionaries to arrive in Igboland on ngelization mission. The insistence of the founders of these groups on need for a mission base, and creation of "small missions" within the ssion structure i.e. (outstations, schools, boarding, elementary, central) s a necessity which could be considered as forum for effective angelizing activities. There was also an insistence on the adaptability to e culture of the people and in particular the training and use of local and digenous hands for the apostolate. Such hands as teachers, catechists, iests etc. as resource persons that would assist to ensure a mission olidly rooted on the ground (Ogudo, 1987).

Missionary Ideologies

In general, the missionary activities in Igboland were carried out between 1857 (Anglicans), 1885 (Catholic) and 1967 shortly before the civil war.

carried out a successful coup and succeeded in killing prominent personalities like Sir Abubaka Tafawa Balewa, Ahmadu Bello, Chief Okotie Eboh, among others. Meanwhile Major-General Aguinyi Ironsi took over the government. Since the January coup was led by an Igbo officer and recorded the death of some prominent northern leaders, they organized a counter coup in July of the same year, killing Aguinyi Ironsi among others and installed Lieutenant Colonel Yakubu Gowon as Nigeria Head of State. It was recorded that between the January coup and the aftermath of the July 1966 coup, the Igbo in the Northern part of Nigeria were subjected to gruesome killings. Riots and insecurity continued and left surviving Igbo people in the North to find their way back to Igboland.

Several efforts by the eastern stakeholders to quell the situation and bring back peace among the regions proved abortive with Gowon accused of not doing enough to preserve the lives of the Igbo people in the North in the bid to suppress the crisis and preserve the lives of the Eastern people. the Eastern military governor Odumegu Ojukwu in January 1967 called for a meeting of the military leaders at Aburi in Ghana to discuss on the way forward. However, Gowon on his return to Nigeria from the concluded meeting decided to disregard the terms of the agreement. Coupled with this action, was Gowon's announced of the creation twelve states on the 27th May, 1967. Gowon's action was viewed as a means to seperate the eastern region to minimize its popularity and population. The Eastern stakeholders who could not accept Gowon's inconsistency in the agreement advised Ojukwu to announce the secession of the eastern region as independent state of Biafra, which was done on the 30th of May 1967.[20]

Nigeria-Biafra War (1967-1970)

Biafra has been in existence hundreds of years before the coming of the Europeans to the areas called Nigeria today. Biafra land covered the colonial Eastern region and part of the Western region and was the closest neighbour to Benin Kingdom.[21]

At the declaration of Ojukwu of the secession of Biafra, the next day being 31st May, 1967, there was massive exodus of Biafrans living in the northern region of Nigeria back to Eastern region. Many volunteered to join the armed forces if the Nigerian government declares war on Biafra

3. **Healthcare Provision**:

- **Missionaries**: The missionaries established healthcare facilities and provided medical care to the people in Igbo land, focusing on improving the health and well-being of the local population.

- **Colonialists**: Colonialists often provided healthcare services primarily for the benefit of their own officials and settlers, with limited access or consideration for the health needs of the local population.

4. **Economic Impact**:

- **Missionaries**: The missionaries focused on promoting economic development in Igbo land through initiatives such as vocational training, agriculture, and small-scale industries to improve the livelihoods of the local population.

- **Colonialists**: Colonialists tended to exploit the resources of Igbo land for their own economic gain, often leading to the siphoning of resources and wealth away from the local population.

While the actions of missionaries and colonialists had some overlapping impacts in Igbo land, such as introducing new ideas, institutions, and technologies, their motivations and primary objectives were fundamentally different. Missionaries sought to spread their faith and improve the lives of the local population, while colonialists often prioritized economic exploitation and resource extraction.

The Roles and Intervention of the Missionaries during the Civil War in Igboland in early 1970 and their Subsequent Ejection in Nigeria after the War.

The invaluable contribution of the missionaries to life and development in Igboland before 1970, not withstanding, their civil war-time activities in the region, especially their humanitarian support to Biafrans in the course of the war attracted the rage of the Federal Military Government of Nigeria which felt that the missionaries contributed to Biafra's long lasting in a war that could have ended in a matter of weeks with the "Police Action" of May 1967.

1. **Humanitarian Assistance**: Missionaries, along with var international humanitarian organizations, played a crucial role providing food, medical aid, and other forms of assistance to the civ population in the Biafran region. They were instrumental in effort alleviate the widespread starvation and suffering caused by the war.

2. **Relief Efforts**: Missionaries set up relief camps, distributed f supplies, and provided medical care to the people affected by the confl Their efforts were essential in saving lives and mitigating the impact the humanitarian crisis in Biafra.

3. **Political Implications**: The Nigerian government viewed t missionaries' involvement in providing humanitarian aid to th breakaway Biafran region as a form of support for the secessionist movement. The government saw the relief efforts as undermining t efforts to defeat the secessionists and maintain the unity of the country.

4. **Accusations of Partisanship**: The Nigerian government accused some missionaries and international organizations of showing bias towards the Biafran side and supporting the secessionist cause through their humanitarian activities. This led to tensions between the government and the missionaries involved in relief efforts.

5. **Expulsion**: As a result of the perceived support for the breakaway Biafran region and accusations of partisanship, the Nigerian government eventually expelled several missionaries and international organizations from the country. This expulsion was a consequence of the political tensions surrounding the Biafran War and the government's suspicions regarding the motives of the relief efforts.

The missionaries' intervention during the Biafran War was motivated by humanitarian concerns and a desire to alleviate the suffering of the civilian population caught in the conflict. However, their involvement became entangled in the political complexities of the war, leading to their expulsion from Nigeria due to the government's suspicions and accusations of supporting the secessionist cause.

An account of the expelled missionaries given in a "CSSP Newsletter

CHAPTER SIX

COMMUNAL LIVING AMONGST THE IGBO OF SOUTH-EASTERN NIGERIA

Chinedu Samuel Okoro, PhD

Colonial anthropologists and early European observers who studied Igbo history and culture created a notion that the Igbo were stagnant. Ijoma (2010:12) They adopted concepts like 'acephalous' and 'stateless' words which had no real analytical relevance to describe the non-centralised political system of the Igbo. These early scholars' position was prejudiced against the Igbo for two reasons: one, they viewed Igbo history through the lens of European history; and two, the Igbo political system differed from the centralised political trends found elsewhere in West Africa. Hence, they concluded that, as one historian of Africa put it, the existence of centralised states was 'a mark of political achievement, the bigger the state, the bigger the achievement'. In their thinking of these early observers, therefore, progress must have been encumbered by the absence of centralised political institutions in Igboland. Many historians of the Igbo such as Kenneth Dike, Adiele Afigbo, G. I. Jones, C. C. Ifemesia, V. C. Uchendu, Okoro Ijoma, J. C. Anene, and J. N. Oriji have since argued against this Eurocentric position of stagnation in pre-colonial Igboland. This paper, based on a synthesis of available literature on these historians' arguments, maintains that despite the absence of centralised political system, the Igbo did not lapse into anarchy. The Igbo were able to evolve a system of institutions of governance and develop a specialised and diversified economy.

Political System: Non-Centralised, But Not Stagnant

As noted above, the absence of centralised system of government did not hinder the political, social and economic growth and development of the Igbo. Pursuing this line of argument, G. I. Jones noted that:

> All Ibo...societies that have been studied can be said to possess the requirement of a state in that they have some centralized administrative and judicial institution and cleavages of wealth and status corresponding to the distribution of power and authority Jones (1963:5)

In essence the Igbo developed a number of socio-political arrangements and institutions which performed the administrative, legislative and judicial functions of government. Though these institutional arrangements had some commonalities, they varied in some specific details from one Igbo community to another.

As extremes in the variations in the Igbo political arrangements, there existed and still exist monarchical institutions in Onicha, Arochukwu, Ogwuta, Abo, Nri and the West Niger Igbo communities before the British invasion in Igboland. In his study of the West Niger Igbo communities, Okoro Ijoma had suggested possible explanations for the existence of kingship in those communities. He pointed out that the control of trade routes and the wealth the trade generated could have provided the stimulus for the development of monarchy, and that monarchy could have also developed in reaction to external aggression and conquest. Ijoma (2012:31) He went further to note that 'leaders of western Igbo communities...may also have sought to gain prestige by linking themselves' to the Benin monarchy. Ijoma (2012:31) He also conceded that 'there may also be some historical truth in the tradition that offshoots of the Benin royal house established kingship in some of the chiefdoms'. Ijoma (2012:31) It has even been pointed out that kingship may have been more widespread in Igboland in an ancient period but that the institution broke down due to either the absence of a candidate to assume the office or the people's decision to dispense with an oppressive and tyrannical monarch. Ijoma (2012:31) But the situation at the time of British intervention was that these monarchies were exceptions to the general pattern of non-monarchical systems organised in villages.

These villages consisted of smaller exogamous units called *umunna, ogbe, idumu, ezi*. This unit of political organisation was headed by an *okpara*, who usually was the oldest member of the lineage. He had numerous ritual, social and legal rights and obligations. As an obligation,

for instance, he mediated in disputes between members of his lineage also represented the lineage in all its external dealings with lineages. Lacking mechanisms to enforce his decisions, he relied curses or threats of them to extract obedience. His curses were feared because he was seen as the earthly representative of the ancestors. The belief that obedience to the dictates of the *okpara* long life and prosperity and that violation of ancestral taboos incurred protracted sickness, sudden death and other calamities helped harmony. Oriji (1983:8) Moreover, as the oldest man in his lineage therefore a 'reservoir of knowledge,' to do without his services grope about in the dark. Ibodimma (1973:47) In return for the service provided to his lineage, he received 'respect, obedience and tokens of goodwill'. Uchendu (1965:40) Issues that defied resolu the lineage level were usually taken to the village level for settlement

Village was the next level of political organisation. 'The size and of the village communities varied considerably from one traditional community to another.' Nwosu (2002:34) Attendance to the council was open to all male members of the village. The meetings held in the *obi* or compound of the oldest lineage in the village or village square. The village council was presided over by the oldest the village who held the village *ofo*. But decisions were taken consensus. According to V. C. Uchendu, 'matters within the leg competence of the villages formerly ranged from the comm regulation of economic affairs to questions of war, peace, and (sic). The economic control exercised by the villages may take the of boycotting an enemy market, regulating the firing of bush, sett price of palm liquor demanded in the village, or levying taxes to the welfare schemes initiated by the village.' Uchendu (19 However, the village assembly is not only concerned with deli and legislatives functions. It also performed judicial, administra executive functions, as shall be shown later.

In some places, a number of villages agglomerated into a village-g town. At this level of political arrangement, participation shifted being direct to being representative. Individuals representing the villages at the village-group council were seen more as 'delegates

as 'representatives,' for the political relationship between the various villages constituting the village-group was basically 'tenuous' and 'minimal'. Uchendu (1965:44) The delegates to the council varied from one village-group to another. Among the Igbo of Adazi-Ani, the council comprised of nine individuals, mostly members of *Nzeselummanya* title society, drawn from the nine villages making up what is today Adazi-Ani. The village-group council met only to settle inter-village quarrels, warfare, and epidemics; or to arrange dates of religious ceremonies and observances and to share communal expenses or revenues.

These three levels of political organisation helped in ordering the Igbo society before the British intervention. However, in the absence of a standing army or police, the Igbo relied on a number of institutions to enforce decisions. Some of those institutions were the age-grade, title society and secret societies—such as the masquerade societies. An age grade usually comprised persons born within a certain age bracket usually three or four years. 'There was a logical basis for this division. The age grades and sets of between 18 and 45 years were the real working group that tackled arduous tasks. Their assistance was sought by creditors to recover debts, at times using *mmanwu* masquerade. They also formed a sort of constabulary to enforce the orders of the elders. Occasionally, they constituted themselves into pressure groups and demanded the passing of new laws to help in guarding and guiding public morality. They organized music and dance and other forms of recreational activities. In this way, the activities of the age-grade organization transcended village and clan boundaries.' Ijoma (2010:28)

The title association constituted one of the most important political and administrative bodies in Igboland. The names assigned to the title society followed certain geographical patterns. While *Ozo* title was common in Anambra and parts of Imo and Enugu states, the West Niger Igbo communities had a number of ranked titles, the highest of which was the *Eze* title, with its holders referred to as *Obi*. The *Ekpe* society, which was prevalent in Abia State, particularly among the Cross River Igbo and parts of Ebonyi States, played a vital role in maintenance of law and order in the society. Membership of the title society was in some places conferred on individuals for their distinguished service or achievement

while in others the titles were bought from the existing title holders. Th title society managed societal conflicts, mediated in conflicts arising fro the activities of the various institutional and occupational groups in th community, and reconciled one group with another. Nwosu (2002:38)

The *mmanwu* or masquerade societies were occasionally invoked to car out certain political or social functions. These masquerades were believ to be the representatives of the spirits of the ancestors and therefore wer form of link between the living and the dead. Ibodimma (197 Membership of *mmanwu* society was opened to all male of free birth w had attained certain age. There were varieties of masquerade Igboland, but the concern here is on the ones that performed politi administrative, and judicial function. Such masquerades, usually call *mmuo abani* because they operated mostly at night, could be invoked visit individuals or lineages that had flouted societal laws or the wi the gods, and inflict severe punishments—like death, enslavement ostracism. Some of them known as gossipers could reveal certain sec activities of named persons. In these ways, they also helped to effectiv ensure conducive environment for the people. These institutions helped ensure conducive environment for the varied and dynamic econom pursuits of the Igbo to thrive.

Economy: Specialised And Diversified

The Igbo economy before the imposition of British colonial rule w varied and dynamic. One of these numerous economic pursuits was t working. Archaeological finds from the Igboukwu excavations reveal antiquity of the iron industry and skill in metal working among the Igb This knowledge of metallurgy helped them to overcome the difficulties their forest environment. Ijoma (2012:12) Many Igbo smiths of Aguleri Agulu Amokwe, Agulu Umana, Awka, and Nkwere extraction trave the length and breadth of Igboland and beyond plying their craft. W (1991:59) The smiths supplied the household and agricultural sect iron products. It was only from the 19th Century, with expan importation of iron bars from Europe and with the imposition of colo rule, that the iron industry in the Igbo country declined. Njoku (1985

Pottery was another gainful industry that engaged the Igbo. Like working, this industry was also of great antiquity, as archaeol

evidence from Igboukwu, Afikpo and Nsuka has revealed. The industry was dominated by women. Pottery products served numerous purposes ranging from domestic (pitchers, containers, cooking pots and dishes) and ritual to musical (*ushi*). But among its practitioners it was a major source of sustenance. In fact in some of the pottery centres, the industry occupied an important place in the traditional economy. For instance, John Ekeledo reported of the Ishiagu people as referring to the industry as '*omechara umu ughuomye*,' translated 'redeemer of the poor and the destitute'. Ekeledo (1972:5)

Carving and weaving were two other important occupations in Igboland. Igbo wood carvers made skilfully carved wooden figures representing household gods and deities. They also carved *ofo* (staff of office and justice), doors, wooden stools, musical instruments (like wooden drums, flutes and gongs), wooden spoons, wooden wares of different sizes, mortars and pestles. But while carving was dominated by men, weaving was an exclusively women trade. Olaudah Equiano wrote of this gendered industry among the Igbo:

> When our women are not employed with men in tillage, their usual occupation is spinning and weaving of cotton, which they afterwards dye and make into garments. Equiano (1967:4)

In communities were cloth weaving thrived, learning to weave was essential to a girl's upbringing, and her ability to attract a suitor was based on whether or not she had mastered the skill of cloth weaving. Notable places of textile manufacture in Igboland included Akwaete, Anioma, Nsuka, Udi, and Abakiliki. Njoku (1991) The importance of this industry can be gauged from the prominence of textile materials in settling of brides wealth, in funerals and in honouring of warriors after a successful campaign. Europeans who visited the Igbo country in 19th century left notes about the industry. I. Spencer, for instance, who visited Ubulu-Ukwu, in Anioma, in the 19th century, noted the industry and dexterity of the people in cloth weaving, remarking that '...they weave cloth of every description, some of which is nearly equal to civilized making in texture' Ayena (2012) The Igbo did achieve considerable measure of proficiency in textile making.

Making of mats, baskets and fan were also popular among the Igbo. These crafts illustrate 'how the indigenous population were able to exploit their material environment to improve their living condition'. Njoku (1991) The raw materials came from various parts and products of plants. The products included:

> For mats, there were two types the thick and course fabric made from fronds of raphia palm and the soft tender and glossy mat made from rushes....Ordinary fans were produced by mat makers from rushes. Baskets were also widely produced from palm fronds and canes. The products included fishing and farm wicker baskets and trays and shallow baskets made of thinly split cane, while the strong ones were woven from *ofo*, spear grass. Bags, ropes and twine were equally produced. Ijoma (2012)

Agriculture was by far the most widespread economic pursuit among the Igbo. Archaeology and oral tradition provide advanced knowledge of the origins of agriculture in Igboland. D. D. Hartle and other archaeologists noted that man shifted from foraging to cultivation in the northern part of Igboland between 2555BC and 1460BC. Nri and Amaigbo axis, which constitute the primary areas of Igbo dispersion, have complex traditions which are connected with the domestication of yams and other crops. Some scholars believe that there is some connection between yam cultivation and the high population density in Igboland. In their thinking, the domestication of root crops like yams which have a higher yield per acre than cereals as well as the use of iron tools must have helped the Igbo produce more food to sustain a large population'. Oriji (1985) Aside the yam, the Igbo cultivated other crops as well, namely: crops of African origin—pumpkin, melon, okra, garden egg, pepper, guinea corn, winged bean—and exotic crops—banana, plantain, sugarcane, cocoyam and cassava. Ijoma (2012:17)

Animal husbandry was another aspect of the Igbo agricultural practice. Animals domesticated included dwarf hump-less cow, goats, sheep, pigs and poultry. Livestock constituted one of the major sources of protein in the Igbo diet. The Igbo developed considerable skill in this aspect of agriculture. Small poultry huts had ash dumped in them to provide warmth and sanitation for the births. Goats were kept in a corner of the

compounds and fed on fodders. A colonial anthropologist noted of animal husbandry among the Agu-Inyi Igbo of Anambra:

> Livestock is maintained, apart from grazing on scanty grass of compounds, by fodder provided by the 'ogbu' tree which has heavy moist foliage, and other...foliage which is collected from the forest. (NAE 1385 ONDIST 21/1/410: 1.)

Igbo agricultural and industrial productions beyond sustenance needs and the fact that no single individual can produce everything he or she needs necessitated trade. The Igbo engaged in exchange of goods both within and outside of their area. The Igbo operated a four-day market cycle, namely: *Peke, orie, afo, and nkwo*. The markets were styled into big and small markets, with the big holding usually at 8-day interval. Ijoma (2012:35) The arrangement of markets in Igboland ensured that markets in two neighbouring communities do not clash. The Igbo also traded with other Igbo and non-Igbo neighbours. The presence of Aro settlements across Igboland testifies to the extent of Igbo trading activities. The Igbo of Nsuka traded with their non-Igbo neighbours, such as the Igala and Akpoto. Other trade linkages existed.

Conclusion

In conclusion, it has been demonstrated that though the Igbo had no centralised political system of the type seen in Hausa or Yorubaland, the Igbo evolved a number of institutions and administrative arrangements that helped ensure conducive environment for their numerous economic pursuits to thrive. The three levels of political organisation and the other institutional arrangements—such as the age-grade, title societies and secret societies—demonstrate that the Igbo were in no way stateless or acephalous. The Igbo remain an eloquent refutation to the Eurocentric posture of stagnation early European observers assumed of not just the Igbo but also of other societies without centralised political institutions.

CHAPTER SEVEN

CULTURAL ENGAGEMENTS IN NIGERIAN COMMUNITIES THROUGH DRAMA

Chukwudi Michael Okoye, PhD

Abstract

Suffice it to say that the engagement of Drama through avenues such as Theatre for Development (TfD) projects have continued to contribute to ongoing discourses on the socio-economic fabric of human vis a vis communal existence. Indeed, as an ideological construct within the performing arts, TfD possesses qualitative potentials through diverse methodological approaches to engage members of society directly in the development agenda. This, amongst others provides a spectrum for various stakeholders to engage in an intellectual as well as practical "reversal of roles" which could propel a process of concientization and mobilization of needed action in addressing shared realities. The part thus, played by development agents becomes imperative in bridging certain gaps before, during and after Applied theatre projects as well as in providing balanced thematic material so as to stimulate development- driven responses from the host communities. The study adopts the qualitative research method: two TfD projects provide primary sources of data. The researcher also relied on textbooks, journals and other library sources. The study also involves participant observation of the subjects of research for objective interpretation and analysis. The study evaluates two TfD projects carried out by 300 level students of the Department of Theatre and Film studies; namely "Anye metara Oburu" and "Ugwo Oru". The study finds that the indispensability of adequatecommunity-based research to the success of TfD workshops in Nigeria cannot be overemphasized and as such should form a crucial component to the theory and practice of TfD in Nigeria and beyond.

Introduction

The need to better the living standards of its citizens, it is safe to say, is a major preoccupation of every society. Communities across Nigeria, Africa and indeed the world appear to grapple with seemingly typical issues ranging from poor governance and governing policies, to unpredictable global trends and changes in weather, health and the economy. Scholars have overtime attempted to evaluate these changes with a view to concientize and motivate members of community to take needed actions in addressing these issues as it concerns them. Augusto Boal's *Theatre for the Oppressed*, for instance draws its trajectory from the revolutionary stance of the masses against the oppressive system orchestrated by the Elite or Bourgeois in society. This concept establishes members of the audience as co-participants in the theatrical experience where social interactions are engendered to stimulate participatory activities geared towards addressing given issues affecting the community or group. Boal, cited by John Sullivan *et 'al*, describes the notion of the Theatre for the Oppressed as "a dramaturgical system of games and special techniques that aims at developing in oppressed citizens, the language of Theatre , which is essential in human language "(167). Boal's position expresses the need for the mobilization of communal action and target groups in discussing and confronting the issues that affect them. Obadiegwufurther observes that:

> This Boalian concept underscores the ethics and aesthetics of Community Theatre for integrated human development. It aims at stimulating a process of community awareness, problem solving and action-taking, bringing the people together, building communal cohesion, raising important issues as they affect the people, creating forums for discussion s of those enabling problems and stimulating collective action. (5)

The instrumentality of the Theatre, thus allows for a creative process that is participatory so as to engender communal input in the change effort. This effort culminates in a workshop or project, laced with physical games, Character creation and image-making exercises, improvisation and even scene construction. Theatre scholars also seem to agree that for Community-driven Theatre projects to have the needed

impact, there should be a proper application and engagement of community based methodology in engendering investigative and collaborative intervention where the facilitators work in *tandem* with the community to understand given challenges, profer solutions and also democratize this participatory process so as to adequately empower members of the community.

Theatre for Development (TfD): Methods and engagement techniques.

It is important to note that Theatre for Development as an approach emanates from a rich research pool called Applied Theatre; which engages theatre practices in the exploration of issues of relevance in any given community. Other approaches under Applied Theatre include Theatre in Education (TiE), Playback Theatre, Psychodrama, Forum Theatre, RehabDramatics and so on. Theatre for Development (TfD) can be deployed through certain research methods and engagement techniques. These methods if properly engaged, provide an appreciable level of objectivity in the intended applied theatre project and should be observed by applied theatre practitioners and development agents in gathering adequate data for the intended intervention. These methods include:

1. Flooding technique: this method proposes that facilitators literally "flood" the community from all entry points. In this setting, facilitators divide themselves into smaller groups and elicit information from different segments of the community within the same time frame.

2. Hierachical technique: this method proposes that facilitators solicit information from the heads of communites downwards. Information here is gathered from one section of the host community to another following a chain of hierarchy.

3. Homestead technique: this method proposes that facilitators collect data as members of the community. Applied theatre practitioners here work from within the community having adequately studied the customs, traditions and general way of life of the people they intend to engage with.

Okere

4. Official Eye technique: this method proposes that information is solicited from official political or institutional representatives of the host communities. This method provides facilitators with varied perspectives of matters of relevance and concern being experienced by the community.

Community Based Research and adaptation of Social learning in UD Projects

The Community-Based Participatory Research (CBPR) advocates the critical importance of proper and wide spread knowledge acquisition in the developmentprocess. Knowledge is viewed as an instrument of power and control and this strengthens the need for a leveraging and channeling of this factor in order to decentralize the power dynamic to foster inclusiveness and a sense of justice. Sullivan*et 'al* informs that

> as a collaborative approach to research that equitably involves all partners in the research process and recognizes the unique strength that each brings. Community-based participatory Research widens the angle of regards for public health activities, acknowledging that community networks and leaders, local knowledge of adverse social and economic consequences of environmental degradations and community beliefs and attitudes are all vital factors that directly impact the efficacy of research and community outreach . CBPR carries with it a necessary mandate to restructure the undemocratic expert-client relationship because hypothesis. Analysis and interpretation directly affect the social power dynamic. (173)

Research concepts such as the CBPR, also provide for a broader approach to the appreciation and integration of social learning systems as well as the structuralinclusion of communal practices in achieving set goals. A social learning system thus, is typified by the expression of shared experiences in order to gain higher knowledge about a social phenomenon and the mobilization of concerted effort while observing historical, cultural and social factors that can increase competence and aid the learningprocess Wenger, Etienne. avers that:

> In a social system, competence is historically and socially

> ...ed. How to understand the position of the earth for ... is something that scientific communities have estab... overtime. Knowing therefore is a matter of ... competencies defined in social communities. The picture is ... complex and dynamic than that however, our experiences of ... and the Social standards of competence of our communities, ... not necessarily, or even usually congruent. We each experi... knowing in our own ways. Socially defined, competence ... always in interplay with our experiences. It is this interplay ... learning takes place. (226)

Scholars like Albert Bandura, and Etienne Wenger among ... propose that in most communities, the individual experiences of ... within these communities, present as a major factor in determi... progress levels in the acquisition of knowledge about certain phenom... as well as the interrelationship between the individual and the soci... cultural and economic factors prevalent in that community. The rol... the community to development, thus, appear crucial such that ... provide the enabling structures that should engender social actio... needed for the change process to thrive; Wenger affirms this a... "Community of Practice" concept where learning becomes a proces... active social engagement which enables new participants to unders... the underlining meanings behind the actions of more experie... members of society and thus, gain needed experience themselves. ... participation is achieved by learning crucial skills, beliefs and so... cultural practices prevalent within the given society. Cobb and ... Korthagen observes that "learning" is both a process of self-organiza... and a process of enculturation that occurs while participating in cultu... practices and frequently interacting with others "(103). Wenger in ... same vein states that:

> Being alive as human beings means that we are constan... engaged in the pursuit of enterprises of all kinds, from establ... our physical survival to seeking the loftiest pleasures. We ... define these enterprises and engage in their pursuit together. ... interact with each other and with the world and we form ... relations with each other and with the world accordingly. In ...

words, we learn. (45)

The concept holds that by the observance of the culture of practice within a community, adequate knowledge is acquired and participation is greatly enhanced; thereby the role of the observer/facilitator becomes fully functional. Thus, engagement in activity through practice immerses the facilitator deeper into the development process, ensures that there is a level of fidelity in tackling themes raised and promotes a requisite understanding and knowledge of social learning systems within the community Wenger submits that learning within the construct of community engagement:

> is an interplay between social competence and personal experience. Itis a dynamic, two way relationship between people and the social learning systems in which they participate. It combines personal transformation with the evolution of social structures. (227)

The role of the community appear crucial to the overall notion of development in that they provide the enabling structures that should engender social activities needed for transformative agendas to thrive. The engagement of the host community within

developmental projects allows for a proper evaluation of given perspective and as such utilize same as instructive mechanisms in underscoring the relationship between the individual and society as well as its potential in promoting participatory socio-culturalactivities.

It therefore behooves of facilitators and development agents to carry out proper research in the execution of TfD projects. Communication channels should be established and strengthened through the observation of the indigenous and traditional systems that are inherent within the host communities. This further implies that the unifying structures of norms, practices and language should be activated in evaluating communal issues. Mbachaga agrees when he says that:

> Participatory performance on the one hand places priority on working with the people and using their own modes of communication to enable small communities look at their own

lems with the aim ofarousing and stimulating ta
take desired steps to improvetheir well being. (87)

The Unizik Projects

The 300 level students (2016/2017) of the Department of
Films studies, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka, carried
Projects in partial fulfillment of the course: Community
Department TFS 341. The students were grouped into two
groups 'A' and 'B'. Leaders were chosen for each groupand
were asked to select randomly the names of prospective
where each group will carry out its project. The names of
were written on small pieces of paper by the lecturer,
placed before the group. Two names emerged as follows:

Group A: *Amudo* Village, Amaenyi Awka

Group B: Awka South Local Govt. Amawbia Awka.

The student/facilitators made preliminary visits to these
They adopted various methods of information gathering,
'Official Eye' and 'Flooding' techniques. They also
production meetings within and outside their host
contact periods lasted for 8 weeks. A story was eventually
for each group; casting and rehearsals were carried out and
productions held on Thursday the 6th and Friday the 7th
Group A produced a play titled "*Nke onye metara Oburu*"
produced a play titled "*Ugwo Oru*".

Story Development of *Nke onye metara Oburu*

The students/facilitators in Group A created a story which
throw some light on the various issues affecting people of
Village, Awka. The story explored anumber of themes and
in the following sequence and scenes;

Scene 1. We see a man who comes out early in the
village square and places some 'fetish' items along the
then makes some incantations and invokes curses on some
the community. As he continues his activities, he is

members of the community and chased off stage.

Scene 2. We observe a group of young men who visit their gang leader to discuss more drastic ways of holding the community to ransom. While smoking wraps of 'cannabis', each one vows to sell off parts of the communal land so that they can all travel to Malaysia like their mates in other villages. They also lament the high handedness and selfishness of the elders in the land as well as the rising incidences of Lesbianism and Homosexuality and resolve to disrupt the peace in the village until these vices are curbed.

Scene 3. In this scene, we observe a man who comes back home from his farm only todiscover his brother sleeping with his wife. He lets out a cry to attract the neighbours and laments how his good-for-nothing brother, who would never do an honest job in his life, had the effrontery to sleep with his wife. The culprit runs away as neighbours intervene to prevent the man from beating up the apparently defiant wife.

Scene 4. In this scene, some well-meaning elders gather at the home of the 'Otochalu Amudo' to discuss the spate of Land grabbing incidents among other vices playing thecommunity. As they deliberate, the scene is overrun with angry youths who demand that the Elders look into the issues plaguing the land. They accuse the elders of greed and vow to make life unbearable for the members of the community.

Scene 5. On their way to the market, three middle aged women come across two maidens in a compromising state along the foot path. The women raise alarm and beatup the girls accusing them of lesbianism.

Scene 6. We observe a young man who comes home to his mother crying. His motherdiscovers that he has just been raped by a fellow boy as evidenced by blood stains on the rear end of his boxer shorts. She laments, attracting other women to the scene.

Scene 7. In this last scene, the community gathers at the palace of the *Igwe* to registertheir complaints on the various horrible trends plaguing the community. As each grouppresent their case, a small band of youths drag in a battered man who happens to be the "fetish" man, we saw in the first scene. Eventually, the Igwe calms the situation and lays down

new rules to the admiration of all present. The scene ends with a cleansing ritual performed by the priestess of the community on behalf of the people of the land.

Story Development of *Ugwo Oru*

The Group B students developed a story from their interactions with officials at the Awka South Local Govt. Area Office. The story was woven around themes extracted from the interviews and discussions held with key officers of the Local Government. The production was enacted in the following scenes;

Scene 1. The scene opens with the activities of the Local government office where we observe two secretaries to the office of the Chairman 'Uloma' and 'Nkechinyere' coming late to work. The scene portrays them as habitual late comers who constantly berate their boss and colleague, 'Ada' for being two "overzealous" for civil service. Uloma and Nkechinyere not only display a sense of incompetence at work but every opportunity to engage in sharp practices. The scene ends with episodes of gossip

peddling, make-up rubbing and other less than professional acts from the two secretaries. At an instance where their boss steps out for meeting, Uloma and Nkechinyere quickly abandon their post for nail-fixing and salon appointments. Even when secretary 'Ada' attempts to inform that their boss had come back, they further insult her by not telling them early enough. Another dimension of this scene exposes total disregard for the 'Due process' rule in public offices. For instance when a corrupt community leader, Mr. Josiah comes in to see the chairman, Uloma and Nkechinyere allow him to 'jump the queue' and before other people who were there before him. Their actions are clearly understood when the corrupt man gives them some cash before leaving.

Scene 2. In this scene, the youths in the community storm the house of the corrupt community leader that was introduced in the first scene. They are accosted by his wife who insults them for having the effrontery to come to their house uninvited. Infuriated, the youths seize her daughters and make away with them to the chagrin of their mother

(Above

Scene 3. Well meaning Elders gather to discuss the many issues plaguing the community. Central to the discussion, is the activities of Mr. Josiah, who has been using the money meant for the community to enrich himself. They lament on how government projects in the area such as roads, water and electrification have been shabbily done by Josiah, plunging the community to a greater state of chaos. As they deliberate, Josiah's wife runs in to plead for the safe return of her daughters that have been kidnapped by the youths. The youths themselves storm the scene to demand the incarceration of Josiah so that the right things would be done in the land. The Elders eventually calm the situation and retrieve the kidnapped girls with a promise to look into the issue.

Scene 4. In this final scene we return to the Local Government office where the State Government has decided to reward hard working local government staff and also punish erring officers in the system. Secretaries Uloma and Nkechinyere, expectedly are served suspension letters while Ada is given a double promotion letter and cash reward for her good conduct. The scene hits its climax when Elders along with other community members drag in a half-beaten Josiah into the scene. The Chairman of the local government scolds him for diverting public funds before handing him over to the police. He however advices the members of community against the menace of Jungle justice and enjoins everyone to join hands in making the state a better place.

Community-based indices explored in *Nke Onyemetara Oburu* and *Ugwo Oru* The practice of TfD in Africa appear to be quite suitable in addressing community-related issues and as such many scholars have continued to insist that for CommunityTheatre projects to succeed, the people for whom the project is designed must playimportant roles in the process. Iorapuu maintains that:

> Considering all these inputs, TfD is hereby defined as a theatre approach that seeks to make possible development education and action from the perspective of the 'people' (the dominated and the brutalized majority in this context) through the use of familiar cultural and democratic forms. Development education and action here refer

to an ideological process from within that
aspirations of the people. It is not imposed from
could be facilitated or negotiated subject to the
(107).

It then follows that development agents should put into
the host community; their way of life, their philosophies, their
and values. These observations provide the thematic
which the development agents work with in achieving a
approach to TfD projects. The 300 level students of the Department
Theatre and Film studies, Awka developed certain themes
themes in the pre-production stages of their projects. The
students developeda story that projected a number of subject

The eventual production, "*Nke Onye metara Oburu*" highlights
issues of Fetish practices, Adultery, Lesbianism, Homosexuality
Juvenile delinquency. However, observations indicate that some
issues raised would have benefitted from a broader depth in
Scholars propose that Theatre for Development projects
empower the people rather weaken them. Facilitators should
balance certain concepts rather than take a purely academic
community research. Okam avers that; "(TfD) seeks to strengthen
empower people outside of the confines of the academia so that
can use the different approaches to discuss their concerns and
their themes. The process starts from the period of meeting with
people, to research, action and evaluation".(134) The development
agents must thus engage communication methods designed to
qualitative participation from the host community thereby
the spectrum for needed action to be taken on key issues affecting
Indeed as Okwori, cited by Okam observes, "Indigenous knowledge
systems are easily handled by the people, they engender discussion
communication among them and make them retain control over
media, ideas, decisions and solutions arrived at in the process of
own development". (135)

The Group B production, *Ugwo Oru* was set in a more formal
that is the Awka South local government office. The production
highlighted issues of poor attitude to work, absenteeism, shabby

and issues. Thus, the themes appeared woven closely together in an attempt to evaluate the predominant practices in civil service establishments in relation with the community. The character development of the two 'corrupt' secretaries Uhoma and Nkechinyere who come late to work and abandon theirstations at the slightest instance appeared to resonate with the audience.

PLATE 1



Secretary Uhoma signs her name against the time7:45am who she actually comes to work by 10:30.



Secretary Nkechinyere berates the diligent Ada foralways coming to work early thereby making her look bad

The twin phenomenon of "tips for favour" and poor public relations are also identifiedas key components of alleged sharp practices in the local government systems in Nigeria. The Group B students highlighted this trend by including scenes of the abuseof the observation of due process where appointments are not kept on "first come, firstserve" basis. The audience are introduced to issues from the opening of the play.

PLATE 2



Secretary Nkechinyere allows a visitor to jump the queue to the dismay of another guest with an earlier appointment.



Secretary Ada receives commendation and promotion letters from the Governor who is represented by the LGA Chairman

The dishonest politician is humiliated beforethe community



Secretary Nkechinyere receives her suspension letter



Secretary Uloma receives her query

Theatre for Development projects should be geared towards bringing social change tothe community concerned. The concept and practice of TfD provides a drama-based medium that seeks to utilize the indigenous communication and cultural forms of the people to drive development-driven information and education. This invariably ensures that communities especially at the grassroots level are adequately empoweredand motivated to confront issues affecting them. The development of scenes and well as the thematic preoccupation of the workshop thus provides a critical platform for positive or negative reviews and response. In a post-production interview of "*Onyemetara Ohuru*", a chief of the Amudo village, Ogbuefi Peter Adunchezor



Secretary Nkechinyere
for allowing local
LGA Chairman before

There is however an attempt by the group B production to
narrative. The students injected "theme songs" through the
scene-changing mechanism and also to continually remind
audience of the need for shared responsibility in the actualiz
ideal society. One of these songs read thus,

If our land becomes goodWe are all to gain

If our land become badWe are all to loose

Let us all join hands

And make our Community great.

The production also reiterates that the government of the
responsive in rewarding good behavior within its ranks
punish bad eggs so as to maintainthe confidence of the
crucial to peaceful co-existence and development.

PLATE 3

ATE 4



Hon. Austin Nwafor representing the Awka SouthLGA Chairman commenting after the production



Cross section of lecturers and students of the department of Theatre and film studies, NAU during the production.

onclusion

heatre for Development projects indeed should engage methods and pproaches that are people-centered and development-driven such that he process provides a learning experience that is balanced and nterrelated from the perspective of the development agents and the ost communities. The engagement of scenario development strategies hat are horizontal and culture friendly decentralizes the development rocess and empowers the communities to assume more control in ddressing their needs. Chambers cited by Onogu Williams observes hat:

> Knowledgeable rural people are disregarded, despised and demoralized by urban commercial and professional values, interests and power. For them to be better able to participate control and benefit requires reversals among these; one first step is for outsider professionals, the bearers of modern scientific knowledge, to step down off their pedestals and sit down, listen and learn. (70)

Facilitators should however endeavour not to sacrifice content at the altar of theatricalentertainment. There should be an attempt at in-depth research into the subject of the project so as to engender outcomes that would add value to the community. Okam insists that "TfD transcends the traditional domains of a mere dramatic act for entertainment

CHAPTER EIGHT

IGBO TRADITIONAL MUSIC: A CARRIER OF IGBO CULTURAL IDENTITY

Raphael I. Umeugochukwu, PhD & Ifeanyi O. Okafor, PhD

Introduction

Culture is defined as a people's way of life, which is passed down from one generation to another through a learning process known as socialization. It comprises their language, belief, symbols, values, norms. It entails arrays of practices which sum up their daily activities. It also entails a long-lived practice and belief associated with a people hence their tradition. Culture, however, is not static but dynamic, change is the only constant phenomenon in life. The change could be triggered by contacts between one culture and another through trade, inter-marriage, cultural imposition, migration and so forth. Conversely, culture gives identity to a people. Through different media like fashion and language, people have continually shown their identity intentionally or unintentionally. In a special way also, music, being an integral part of culture has been a vital symbol of identity; be it for nations, ethnic groups, states, organizations and so forth. Music has always had the ability to express better what mere words may not be able to do.

The Igbo People of Nigeria

According to Chibuife, (2022), the Igbo people are vibrant and diverse ethnic group with a rich and fascinating culture. Located in the South-eastern region of Nigeria which comprises the following States: Anambra, Imo, Enugu, Abia and Ebonyi, the Igbo have a population of over 30 million people, making them one of the largest ethnic groups in the country. They are also found in the neighbouring States such as Akwa Ibom, Cross River, Delta and Rivers. The Igbo homeland, however, is in the forest region of South-eastern Nigeria with outcropping to the West lying between longitudes 6° and 8° East and latitudes 5° and 7° North

They live mainly to the east of the lower Niger with a small extension on the West Bank (Okafor, 2013).

Known for their strong sense of community, their artistic and musical traditions, and their spiritual beliefs, the Igbo have a long fascinating history. This means that amongst their unique ways of communing, either through spiritual beliefs, social or economic activities, music has got a role of a unifying factor rooted in the people's tradition. In conformation to this, Okpala (2016) states that Igbo people are endowed with numerous dance music performances which portray the culture of the people. She went ahead to note that traditional music is so much a part of Igbo culture that majority of the people who live in big cities and other places outside their home town organize traditional music ensembles as a mark of identity to preserve their culture and as a unifying factor that binds them together. This also goes a long way to affirm that music in various forms is at the heart of Igbo tradition.

Concept of Music

Music is said to be a universal language, in the sense that it forms part of virtually all the cultures of the world. It is commonly defined as organized sounds that please the ear. Ekwueme (2008) defines music as "a phenomenon using the medium of sound which is organized and manipulated into socially accepted patterns that communicate intelligibly and meaningfully, verbally or non-verbally, ideas, feelings, emotions and events to people" (p. 1). Every culture has different ways of organizing music to suit their environment, occupation and experiences. According to Okafor (2005):

> It is essentially a human activity denoting or expressing human emotions and the relationship of the emotions to the environment... In its truest sense, it cannot exist without man...Since each culture has its own collective or individual experiences, ideas, outlook and environment, the organization of sounds into music does vary from culture to culture. (pp. 383 & 384)

Okafor (2019) further explains that this, by implication, is that what seem to be organized sounds that please the ear in one culture might be

regarded as [illegible]ganized sounds by another culture. In other words, [illegible] is music in one culture might not be regarded as music in another [illegible]. On this premise, one can say that no music is superior to the [illegible] because appreciation of music varies from one culture to another, [illegible] group to another and one individual to another. The music characteristic of a culture is known as folk, traditional, indigenous music of the [illegible] Onuora-Oguno (2006) adds thus, "the traditional music of a people is, to a great extent, a mirror of their culture" (p. 90). Okimade (2013) [illegible] explains that if these indigenous music are not serving, but [illegible] talking about history, events, and about the subjects in the present [illegible] educational system. Because they are rendered in indigenous [illegible] when they are use as instructional materials to teach the child, it makes them understand, appreciate and promote their cultural heritage.

Igbo Traditional Music

Music and dance accompany virtually all the events and activities [illegible] culture. The music that associate various events or activities are not merely for entertainment but are functional, that is, they are [illegible] with the particular event(s) they are meant for. That is why there are songs peculiarly meant for birth, works, funerals, marriage, [illegible] periodic and non-periodic festivals and so forth. The texts, [illegible] rhythms combine to depict the mood of the event (Okafor, [illegible]). According to Nzewi in Ibekwe (2019), "the themes of songs [illegible] centre on events and matters of common interest and concern [illegible] members of a community or social groups within it, they are [illegible] everyday life or with the traditions, beliefs and customs of the [illegible] (p. 1). Echezona in Okafor (2019) notes that life, to every [illegible] melodic and rhythmic orientation, and again, no event happens [illegible] associated with music.

Therefore, Igbo indigenous music is a vital aspect of the [illegible] heritage of the Igbo people of southeastern Nigeria. It serves as a [illegible] of communication, storytelling, entertainment, and preserving [illegible] traditions and customs. The music is deeply embedded in the [illegible] beliefs, and way of life of the Igbo people. Igbo music is diverse [illegible] encompasses various musical genres, styles, and instruments. [illegible] Igbo music often features a combination of voice and [illegible]

instruments such as the ekwe, ogene, udu, and ichaka. These instruments are used to create rhythmic patterns and melodies that evoke different emotions and convey messages. In Igbo culture, music plays a significant role in various aspects of life, including ceremonies, festivals, rituals, and social gatherings. For example, during traditional ceremonies like weddings, funerals, and initiations, specific musical performances are carried out to mark important milestones and events in the community.

The Synergy of Igbo Tradition, Custom, and Music

Music in the context of Igbo culture is beyond sound but encompasses oral poetry, artistic design, drama, dance and song. Musical knowledge and skills extends to knowing vastly about the individual's society, which includes culture, history, moral instruction and so forth. The synergy of Igbo tradition, custom, and music creates a vibrant and dynamic cultural tapestry that reflects the deep-rooted heritage of the Igbo people. The union of the three is inseparable as music finds its way into the rubrics of everyday activity of an Igbo person. To buttress this, Okafor in Udechukwu (2021) interchanges the use of indigenous with traditional as they are very synonymous; he maintains that "traditional music is a term for the indigenous music of the indigenous people of the world...it is an expression or art that is most accessible to people of certain tribe or locality which portrays their culture and arts, works and worship, play or war, recreation or reflection..." Here are some ways in which these elements come together to form a cohesive and distinctive cultural identity:

Cultural Celebrations and Festival

Igbo cultural celebrations and festivals often combine traditional customs, music, and rituals to create immersive experiences that showcase the richness of Igbo heritage. During festivals such as the *Iri Ji Ọfụụ* (New Yam) festival and the *Ọfala* festival, traditional music and dance are integral parts of the festivities, enhancing the celebratory atmosphere and connecting participants to their cultural roots. Ibekwe & Umeojiaka (2023) enumerated the roles of the IgbaEze music group of Achina in reminding the people of the yearly ritual – killing of ram to commemorate an important *ofala* festival as well as exhilarating the king as a warrior. They do this by singing the following song:

Call: *Nyel 'Oba amyi ji egbu ebini*
Resp: *Imawo?*
Call: *Nye mgb 'onye ji egbu ebini*
Resp: *Imawo? Ez 'oba e, Ae-e Ez 'oba dike*
Ae-e Ez 'oba dike ...

Translation
Call: The year our king normally kills a ram,
Resp: Do you know?
Call: The year Mgb'onye normally kills a ram
Resp: Do you know? Ae-e Ez'oba is a warrior,
Ae-e Ez'oba is a warrior....

The song continues to resound among the people even after the
music lives longer than the event itself because it stays with
wherever they go.

2. Rites of Passage

Customary rites of passage, such as marriage ceremonies,
ceremonies, and initiation rites, are accompanied by
dances that add meaning and symbolism to these
Traditional Igbo music played during these rites often
stories, and moral teachings that reinforce the values
community. For instance, marriage ceremony is one of the
passage with an important music culture which
around the women. According to Okafor (2017), "women
entire musical accompaniment to marriage ceremonies. The
sing her away to her husband's place, where her co-wives
install in her new home." The woman's musical culture
continues in her new environment as she will identify with
practices among her co-wives and will join them eventually
some of the songs that serve this purpose as culled from

E jighi ego ego nwa.	A child is not bought with money.
I luo be di gi.	When you get to your husband's home,
Makwara biri-o.	Learn to live in peace.
E megbube gi-o, kwaramu nata o	If you are maltreated, return home.
I luo be di gi, chupu ndi oyi gi-o.	When you live with your husband, drive away your friends.
Afọ ruba gi-o, juba ajuju.	When you have bellyache, ask questions
I mutanwa, makwara kuru.	When you deliver a baby, nurse it well.

It should be noted that this song is performed by young maidens from Enugu-Ukwu while escorting their mate to her matrimonial home.

3. Masquerades and Cultural Performances

Masquerades, a prominent feature of Igbo cultural expression, combine intricate costumes, music, and dance to embody spirits, ancestors, or deities during ceremonies and festivals. The music accompanying masquerade performances serves to enhance the mystical and spiritual aspects of the tradition, transporting participants into a realm where the physical and the metaphysical intertwine. These masquerades perform different cultural functions as it concerns social, spiritual, even economic life of the people. The same way, there are special music to accompany these activities accordingly.

4. Storytelling and Oral Tradition

Music serves as a vehicle for storytelling in Igbo culture, preserving myths, legends, history, and wisdom through songs and chants passed down through generations. Customary practices, beliefs, and moral lessons are often embedded in the lyrics and melodies of traditional Igbo music, serving as a means of cultural transmission and preservation. Children learn through folk tales and the accompanying songs, the dos and don'ts of their communities. They also learn about the character of people and animals …proverbs, codes and maxims. Okafor (2017). An example of such song is presented below.

Nne, Nne, Udu M Alaputa M	***My Mother, My Pot Has Shown me***
Nne, nne,	My mother, my mother
Udu m alaputa m, udu	My pot has shown me up, udu
Udu m ji chu iyi na m amaro	The pot I took to the stream was
Udu awari, udu	inadvertently broken pot, udu,
O bu m solu udu k'omu ghalu	Shall I go with the pot, or shall let
Udu naa, udu ?	the matter stand? udu
Aga m ato n'akwa? Ewo!	Oh, should I continue crying?
Anyi ga-agbanaba? Ewo! Etc.	Oh, shall we escape? Etc

(As culled from Okafor; 2017)

This depicts the need for a child who has erred in one way or the other show remorse for the offense committed irrespective of the pressure which the offence was committed. This child in this situation was not remorseful but when further to be open and vocal about it. In some the neighbor could come in to intercede on his/her behalf. There always series of lesson to draw from the folk songs.

5. Community Bonding and Identity

Group responsibility is emphasized in Igbo society over individual activities. This Igbo philosophy of existing as a group or community expressed in some Igbo idiomatic and figurative statements like *ọhụ bụ ike* (kindred is strength); *ofu osisi adighị eme ọfịa* (a tree does not make a forest); *igwe bụ ike* (unity is strength); and so forth. The communal lifestyle of the Igbo is also evident in their music making performances. Indigenous music is bélière to be owned by the community and not by individuals, although there are individual musicians who are known for their mastery of either specialised instruments or voice.

The collective participation in traditional customs, music, and dance fosters a sense of community cohesion and shared identity among the Igbo people, strengthening social bonds and fostering cultural

Through music and cultural practices, the Igbo community reinforces its values, norms, and worldview, creating a sense of belonging and continuity across generations. By weaving together tradition, custom, and music, the Igbo people create a holistic cultural experience that embodies their history, beliefs, and aspirations, ensuring the preservation and celebration of their unique heritage. Importance of group activity is expressed in the song below, which stresses collective achievement over victory.

Na-Alụnụ Ọrụ (Keep Working)

Na-alunu olu ,	Keep working,
Anyi ga-emwe nmeri	Victory is ours,
Na-alunu olu ,	Keep working,
Anyi ga-emwe nmeri	Victory is ours,
Jinike n'olu	Be courageous
Anyi ga-emwe nmeri	Victory is ours,

6. Children Upbringing/Education

In Igbo traditional society, high premium is placed on children, which is evident on some of the names given to them. Examples of such names include:

Nwakego – a child is greater than money
Nwabuaku – a child is wealth
Nwaboeze - a child is king
Nwamaka – a child is beautiful/endearing
Nwabundo – A child is shelter
Nwadinma – A child is good and so forth.

The so much importance attached to children in Igbo society calls for their proper upbringing/moral education so that they will be active participants in their various societies. Fafunwa in Akumah (2013) outlines the goals of traditional education as follows:

To develop the child's latent physical skills.

ii. To develop character.

iii. To inculcate respect for elders and those in position of authority.

iv. To develop intellectual skills.

v. To acquire specific vocational training and to develop a healthy attitude towards honest labour.

vi. To develop a sense of belonging and to participate actively in community affairs.

vii. To understand, appreciate and promote the cultural heritage of the community at large. (p. 258)

Onuora-Oguno in Esimone and Ojukwu (2014) states that, "education has been portrayed by many sociologists and educationists to be the experience which bothers on people's culture, and which therefore learning prepares an individual for adult life in his particular society (p. 40). However, adult life in a particular society includes their occupation and conformity to the norms and values of that society, with many practices of that society inclusive. Geographical location of an area has great influence on the life activities of the people who dwell in it. The occupation and content of education of a child born into that society is, to a great extent, determined by its environment. A fulfilled life of an adult in the society depends on his upbringing as a child, in conformation with societal demands.

However, Igbo traditional music and musical practices play significant roles in instilling the societal norms and value in children during their formative years. The children learn the folk songs which are based on different themes such as honesty, loves, diligence, obedience, humility and so forth. Furthermore, according to Umeugochukwu & Ajaegbu (2021), the child's training is a communal business which explains why every child could bear the name 'Nwaorah' which means child of the community. These always come to play in scenario like moonlight activities where children learn and sing series of folk songs. They also learn how to produce some of the musical instruments common in the community.

An example of such educative songs is *Mgbe nne gi na-abara gi mba* (When your mother rebukes you)

Mgbe nne gi na-abara gi mba,	When your mother rebukes you,
Ewelaiwe.	Do not be angry.
Mgbe nna gi na-abara gi mba,	When your father rebukes you,
Ewelaiwe.	Do not be angry.
Rube isi, di nwayon'obiocha,	Be obedient, be calm in good heart,
Onye aburu n'anya ka a na-abaramba.	One who is loved is rebuked

In conclusion, we cannot overemphasize how inseparable music and tradition is in Igbo society. The tradition would literally be dead without music, music per say, extends the lifespan of every tradition. This can go further to mean that the possibility of extinction of a tradition can only be feared when their musical culture is totally lost. One should also note that music is such an encompassing word in Igbo when translated. So when we talk about music in Igbo, we talk about "Egwu" which unites all musical activity of the Igbo people be it vocal music, instrumental music or dance music; they are all integrated. In the same vein, music finds its place in the holistic life activities of typical Igbo person.

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CHAPTER NINE

DRUG ABUSE: AN EVOLVING CULTURE AMONG NIGERIAN YOUTHS

Umeozor, Uzonna Juliana Ph.D.

Introduction

Drug abuse is emerging as a global public health issue. The world drug report-2019 of the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC) estimated that 271 million (5.5%) of the global population (aged between 15 and 64 years), had used drugs in the previous year. Also, it has been projected that 35 million individuals will be experiencing drug use disorders. Further, the Global Burden of disease Study 2017 estimated that, in 2017, there were 585,000 deaths due to drug use, globally. The burden of drug abuse (usage, abuse, and trafficking) has also been related to the four areas of international concern, viz organized crime, illicit financial flows, corruption, and terrorism/insurgency. Therefore, global interventions for preventing drug abuse including its impact on health, governance, and security, requires a widespread understanding of the prevalence, frequently implicated drugs, commonly involved population, sources of the drugs, causes, effects and risk factors associated with the drug abuse.

In Nigeria, the burden of drug abuse is on the rise and becoming a public health concern. Nigeria, which is the most populous country in Africa, has developed a reputation as a center for drug trafficking and usage mostly among the youth population. According to the 2018 UNODC report "Drug use in Nigeria"—The first large-scale, nationwide national drug use survey in Nigeria, one in seven persons (aged 15–64 years) had used a drug in the past year. Also, one in five individuals who had used drug in the past year is suffering from drug-related disorders. Drug abuse has been a cause of many criminal offences such as theft, burglary, sex work, and shoplifting. In 2012, Nigeria ranked among the highest users of

erous drugs such as alcohol, tobacco, cannabis, benzodiaz
ine and opioids when compared with other developing co
o *et al.*, 2012).

commonly abused drugs in Nigeria include cannabis, tobac
hetamine/dexamphetamine, diazepam, Cocaine, diazepam, sin
and tramadol. The most commonly abused drugs in the country
adol and codeine. Tramadol is a synthetic opioid analgesic used
moderate to severe pain and is the most abused medicine amo
cts. It has no effects on the respiratory system but overdose can
thmias, cramps, coma and death. In Nigeria, it is regulated as the
100mg dosage strengths but very high dosage forms of 200 m
ng have infiltrated the market. There is also noticeable increase
ggling of Tramadol capsules. Tramadol use disorder is associa
physical withdrawal symptoms and compulsive behaviour. Co
be obtained as an over-the-counter painkiller and cough medicine
eria but consumers often become addicted. The risk of addiction
t, and in many countries including Nigeria, consumers are require
e prescriptions for all opioid-based medications. The misuse
eine products contributes to severe health outcomes including liv
age, stomach ulceration, respiratory depression, coma and death
eria, despite the fact that all codeine-containing products are lice
ufactured and are prescription-only-medicines (POM) since 20
e products are smuggled into the country as unregistered
ducts. The reclassification as POM did not stem the trend of abu
dly due to non-adherence to the provisions made for prescription.

ntifying the sources where drug abusers obtained drugs is essential
venting drug abuse in Nigeria. Interventions to block the supply
se drugs from identified sources could reduce the incidence
evalence of drug abuse. The common sources include
armacies/patent medicine shops (23–33%), open markets (17%), st
wkers, hawkers of traditional herbal preparations, fellow drug abu
%), underground agents (57%), family members (1.6–33%), friends
61%), teachers (3%), physician (8.3%), other health practitioners
.0%).

In Nigeria, the South-West zone had a prevalence of 22.4% drug users in 2017, followed by the South-South (16.4%), South-East (13.4%), North-East (13.4%), North-West (12%) and North-Central (10%) (UNODC, 2017). The lifetime consumption of cannabis as well as psychotropic substances like benzodiazepines and amphetamine-type stimulants, was about 11%, while heroin (1.6%), and cocaine (1.4%) were reported the least consumed in both urban and rural areas (UNODC, 2017). That same year, drug abuse appeared to be more common among males (25.2%) than females (approximately 8%), and the age range of first use was 18-39 years.

Definitions Of Drug Abuse

Substance abuse, also known as **drug abuse**, is the use of a drug in amounts or by methods which are harmful to the individual or others. It is a form of substance-related disorder. Differing definitions of drug abuse are used in public health, medical and criminal justice contexts. There is no universal definition of the term "Drug abuse". Benjamin and Chidi (2014) defined drug abuse as "the use of a drug that is not generally accepted on medical ground, i.e. continuous or occasional use of drugs that would cause overt behavioral change by the individual either of his own choice or under a feeling of compulsion, to achieve his wellbeing or what he conceives as of his own wellbeing" Onah (1982:2). Sees it as "the excessive or inappropriate use of a drug by a person; such use being considered or judged to be illegal (immoral) by the culture and also resulting in harm to the person or society". From Aka and Akanyili (2005:60), drug abuse refers to drug use mainly by self-medication in a manner that deviates from approved medical or social patterns.

Causes Of Drug Abuse

A study on perception of drug abuse amongst Nigerian undergraduates identified dependence and addiction as some of the major consequences of drug abuse, characterized by compulsive drug craving seeking behaviors that persist even in the face of negative consequences (Adelaja and Alli, 2006;Oshodi, Aina, Onajole, 2010). These changes are maladaptive and inappropriate to the social or environmental setting, and may place the individual at risk of harm.

Studies have revealed that most drug addicts started smoking at [illegible] youth. As they grow older they seek new thrills and gradually [illegible] hard drug abuse (Oshodi, Aina & Onajole, 2016; Igwe, et al, 2009). [illegible] nationwide survey of high school students in 2008, reported that [illegible] used drugs to have a "good time" with their friends, 54% [illegible] experiment to see what it is like, and 20-40% used it to alter their [illegible] to feel good, to relax, to relieve tension and to overcome [illegible] Abudu, 2008). Some other reasons include:

1. **Curiosity And Desire To Find Out The Effectiveness Of A Particular Drug:** Curiosity to experiment the unknown [illegible] about drugs thus motivates youth into drug use. The [illegible] experience in drug abuse produces a state of arousal and [illegible] happiness and pleasure which in turn motivates them to continue

2. **Influence Of Peer Group:** Peer pressure plays a major role [illegible] influencing many youths into drug use and abuse.

3. **Environmental Conditions:** Many young people live [illegible] communities or slums which suffer from multiple deprivation with high unemployment, low quality housing, lack of [illegible] sanitation and hygiene, increased violence and crime rate, and where the surrounding infra-structure of local services is splintered and poorly resourced. In such communities drug supply and use often thrive as an alternative source of [illegible] money often controlled by powerful criminal groups.

4. **Promotion and Availability:** Alcohol and pain relief drugs are regularly advertised on television especially at peak hours. The advertising of tobacco products is now banned, but research by Strathclyde University (published by the Cancer Research institute) concluded that advertising did encourage young people to start smoking and reinforced the habit among existing smokers. Despite legislation, children and adolescents have no problems obtaining alcohol and tobacco from any number of retail outlets. A variety of products are openly hawked in [illegible] at parks and on the roadside. It is not uncommon to see people

openly advertising sexual enhancing drugs to pedestrians all over major cities in the country.

5. **Enjoyment**: Despite all the concerns about illicit drug use and the attendant lifestyle by young people, it is probably still the case that the lives of most young people are centred on school, home and employment and that most drug use is restricted to the use of tobacco and alcohol. They may adopt the demeanour, fashion and slang of a particular subculture including the occasional or experimental use of illegal drugs without necessarily adopting the lifestyle.

6. **Lack of Parental Supervision and the Socio-economic Status of the Parents:** Socio-economic status of the parents entails direct costs which are very important to families

7. Self – medication of primary psychological disorders.

Effects Of Drug Abuse

Young people who persistently abuse substances often experience an array of problems, including academic difficulties, health-related problems (including mental health), poor peer relationships, and involvement with the juvenile justice system. Additionally, there are consequences for family members, the community, and the entire society.

1. **Academics**: Declining grades, absenteeism from school and other activities, and increased potential for dropping out of school are problems associated with adolescent substance abuse. Hawkins, Catalano, and Miller (1992) cite research indicating that a low level of commitment to education and higher truancy rates appear to be related to substance use among adolescents. Cognitive and behavioral problems experienced by alcohol- and drug-using youth may interfere with their academic performance and also present obstacles to learning for their classmates (Bureau of Justice Statistics, 1992).
2. **Physical health**: Injuries due to accidents (such as car accidents) physical disabilities and diseases, and the effects of possibl overdoses are among the health-related consequences of teenag

substance abuse. Disproportionate numbers of youth involved with alcohol and other drugs face an increased risk of death through suicide, homicide, accident, and illness.

3. **Mental health**: Mental health problems such as depression, developmental lags, apathy, withdrawal, and other psychosocial dysfunctions frequently are linked to substance abuse among adolescents. Substance-abusing youth are at higher risk than nonusers for mental health problems, including depression, conduct problems, personality disorders, suicidal thoughts, attempted suicide, and suicide. Marijuana use, which is prevalent among youth, has been shown to interfere with short-term memory, learning, and psychomotor skills. Motivation and psychosexual/emotional development also may be influenced (Bureau of Justice Statistics, 1992).
4. **Peers**: Substance-abusing youth often are alienated from and stigmatized by their peers. Adolescents using alcohol and other drugs also often disengage from school and community activities, depriving their peers and communities of the positive contributions they might otherwise have made.
5. **Families**: In addition to personal adversities, the abuse of alcohol and other drugs by youth may result in family crises that jeopardize many aspects of family life, sometimes resulting in family dysfunction. Both siblings and parents are profoundly affected by alcohol- and drug-involved youth (Nowinski, 1990). Substance abuse can drain a family's financial and emotional resources (Bureau of Justice Statistics, 1992).
6. **Social and economic consequences**: The social and economic costs related to youth substance abuse are high. They result from the financial losses and distress suffered by alcohol- and drug-related crime victims, increased burdens for the support of adolescents and young adults who are not able to become self-supporting, and greater demands for medical and other treatment services for these youth (Gropper, 1985).

Delinquency: There is an undeniable link between substance abuse and delinquency. Arrest, adjudication, and interaction with the juvenile justice system are eventual consequences for many youth engaged in alcohol and other drug use. It cannot be

claimed that substance abuse causes delinquent behavior or delinquency causes alcohol and other drug use. However, the two behaviors are strongly correlated and often bring about school and family problems, involvement with negative peer groups, a lack of neighborhood social controls, and physical or sexual abuse (Hawkins et al., 1987; Wilson and Howell, 1993). Possession and use of alcohol and other drugs are illegal for all youth. Beyond that, however, there is strong evidence of an association between alcohol and other drug use and delinquent behavior of juveniles. Substance abuse is associated with both violent and income-generating crimes by youth. This increases fear among community residents and the demand for juvenile and criminal justice services, thus increasing the burden on these resources. Gangs, drug trafficking, prostitution, and growing numbers of youth homicides are among the social and criminal justice problems often linked to adolescent substance abuse.

8. **Isolation**: Addiction quickly becomes a lifestyle. An addicted person dedicates more and more of their attention to getting drugs, finding ways to use and concealing their use from others. All of these behaviors separate us from anyone not participating in our addiction, enabling it or at least in denial or willing to look the other way. Stagnation
9. **Depression and Anxiety**: Using drugs or alcohol frequently brings about depression and anxiety. There are two main reasons for this. First, the biochemical effects of drugs of abuse themselves often trigger depression and anxiety either when using the drug or as its effects begin to subside and withdrawal sets in. Secondly, the choices that drug abuse entails also lead to depression and anxiety. No one can live a dishonest, duplicitous life for long without becoming depressed and fearful. We aren't built to live that way.
10. **Death**: Finally, there is the grim reality of death. Whether we like it or not, drug abuse increases our chances of dying, whether it's the risk of a fatal overdose, a car accident, or being shot and killed trying to score, using increases your risk of imminent death. Period. There is no sense in trying to sugarcoat it. Buying and using drugs nearly always means taking unnecessary risks. It

also c ans being around other people who take risks. No matter how safe and sensible you think you are in your drug use, you can't control what others do around you. You may just get caught in the crossfire, figuratively or literally.

sk Factors Of Drug Abuse

ople of any age, sex or economic status can become addicted to a drug, rtain factors can affect the likelihood and speed of developing an diction. These factors include;

1. **Family history of addiction:** Drug addiction is more common in some families and likely involves an increased risk based on genes. If you have a blood relative, such as a parent or sibling, with alcohol or drug addiction, you're at greater risk of developing a drug addiction.
2. **Genetics and family history**: According to the National Institute on Drug Abuse (NIDA), "the genes that people are born with account for about half of a person's risk for addiction." In other words, some people are genetically predisposed. If you have a family history of addiction, your child may be at greater risk than his or her peers.
3. **Mental health disorder:** If you have a mental health disorder such as depression, attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD) or post-traumatic stress disorder, you're more likely to become addicted to drugs. Using drugs can become a way of coping with painful feelings, such as anxiety, depression and loneliness, and can make these problems even worse.
4. **Peer pressure:** Peer pressure is a strong factor in starting to use and misuse drugs, particularly for young people.
5. **Lack of family involvement:** Difficult family situations or lack of a bond with your parents or siblings may increase the risk of addiction, as can a lack of parental supervision.
6. **Early use:** Using drugs at an early age can cause changes in the developing brain and increase the likelihood of progressing to drug addiction.
7. **Taking a highly addictive drug:** Some drugs, such as stimulants, cocaine or opioid painkillers, may result in addiction

development of addiction than other drugs. Smoking or injecting drugs can increase the potential for addiction. Taking drugs considered less addicting — so-called "light drugs" — can start you on a pathway of drug use and addiction.

8. **Adverse childhood experiences (ACE):** Adverse childhood experiences such as emotional, physical, or sexual abuse increase your risk for drug addiction.
9. **Behavior or impulse control problems:** Teenagers have a natural, greater propensity to act on impulse, without thinking about the consequences. This is because the part of their brain dedicated to rational decision-making has not fully developed. However, if your teen is experiencing any excessive behavioral or impulse control issues, it is important to understand this can lead to a greater risk for drug abuse and addiction.
10. **History of trauma**: Similar to stress, trauma is also a significant risk factor for drug abuse and addiction. About 70 percent of adolescents in drug treatment today have a history of trauma exposure. Traumatic events such as natural disasters, injury or death, and abuse or neglect can make a person more likely to use drugs.
11. **Environmental risk factors**: A teen's home environment can also play a role in his or her likelihood to abuse drugs. For example, a lack of parental supervision can put a teen at greater risk of using drugs more regularly. In addition, the presence of a caregiver who drinks or abuses drugs can also contribute to a child's propensity to use.
12. **Anxiety:** People who are prone to anxiety and are looking for a chemical way out of it are at increased risk of abusing alcohol and some other drugs. These individuals may discover that alcohol or some other drugs relieve their anxiety or distress. The drug of choice for these self-medicating people is usually some type of **depressant** , such as alcohol, heroin, or a prescription **analgesic** or **tranquilizer** .

As you can see, there are many types of risk factors for addiction, from environmental to biological. The more risks that a person is exposed to, the more likely he or she is abuse drugs longer-term. As noted by the

NIDA, certain risk factors are more prominent at different stages of lives. Peer pressure and lack of impulse control, for example, are risk factors for teen addiction. Earlier risk factors might include the of a parental figure at home, academic stress, or difficulty in disorder

Nigerian Legislation To Address Drug Abuse
Some of the Laws regulating the use of Drugs in Nigeria include:

1. **National Drug Law Enforcement Agency (NDLEA)** Act 1989 (as amended) which established the NDLEA to be responsible preventing illicit cultivation, production, manufacture, trafficking abuse of drugs.

2. **National Agency for Food and Drug Administration and Control (NAFDAC)** Act No. 15 of 1993 which set-up the NAFDAC, under the Federal Ministry of Health, to authorize (control) importation and exportation of narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances controlled substances, to ensure that their uses are limited to medical scientific purposes. NAFDAC is also mandated to collaborate NDLEA in measures to control drug abuse in the country.

3. **Money Laundering (Prohibition) Act, 2011** (as amended), the problem of drug money laundering.

4. **Other relevant legislation include the Dangerous Drugs Act**, Indian Hemp Decree, 1966 (as amended); Food and Drugs Act (as amended); and the Counterfeit and Fake Drugs and Unwholesome Processed Foods (miscellaneous provisions) Act, 1999.

Challenges And Control Of Drug Abuse Among Youths In Nigeria
The British Broadcasting Corporation's documentary titled 'Sweet Codeine' in 2018 brought to the Nigerian socio-political light the scourge of substance abuse in the country. Soon after, the problem continues in the background despite the coordinated efforts of the law enforcement agencies in the country. In Nigerian households highest rate of substance use is in the age group of 25–39 years. 2.9 million are substance dependent. Substance use is understood because it has benefits for the individual, community, nation and

world at large. This reality is the beginning and, at times, the end of the story; often, however, the result is the progression to a pattern of use that reverses all the gains and causes deficits in every sphere of human life. The difficulties in curtailing substance abuse among the youths in Nigeria are related ultimately to the forces seeking to promote substance use for its desirable effects on the parts of both the user and the supplier, and the limitations of prevention and treatment strategies in the country.

A force that makes controlling substance abuse difficult is the sense of well-being, a fundamental human need and ultimate lure for substance use. Every initiation and maintenance of substance use, as is the case with all adaptive and maladaptive human behaviours, starts with the goal of attaining an acceptable sense of well-being, which is largely subjective and based on the individual's interpretation of internal and external experiences. Emotions, such as anxiety, depression, boredom, despair and dejection are internal states that an individual seeks to eliminate and replace with positive ones. Physical pains, discomfort or disease, interpersonal conflict or rejection, loss, failure, marriage and divorce are some of the numerous life events which may be transformed into distressing internal states depending on the personal meaning given to them. The use of substance will not address the life events; rather it overrides their emotional impact with a sense of well-being and of self-efficacy by altering the brain activities in certain ways. As for illicit substance suppliers at any level, their well-being is promoted with improvement in economic, social and political status which comes from the lucrative job of producing, distributing or selling substances, not minding the potentially destructive effects on the user.

Another challenging factor in the control equation is the paradox that surrounds the willingness and the ability to stop substance use. At the onset, the use of a small dose is enough to produce the desired effect and gives little or no untoward experience. The ability to stop the use is the highest, while the willingness to do so is understandably near zero. With time, an increasing amount is required to produce the same 'good' experience. Unfortunately, the higher the dose, the higher the risk or the more the experience of negative mental, physical, social, occupational, family and legal consequences. Now, the user is highly willing to stop but is less able to do so because the experienced damages disrupt their sense

of well-being, calling for more substance intake to 'restore' it, and because the repeated use changes the brain function and structure in such a way that reduces self-efficacy, thus maintaining the vicious cycle.

A prevention strategy can tilt the balance of control positively by preventing or delaying the initiation of use or by preventing the progression of use to abuse. However, Nigeria has the challenge of non-availability of effective strategies to do this among the youths. In 2015, funded by the European Union, the Federal Government of Nigeria piloted and tested the impact of 'Unplugged,' a Social-influence substance abuse prevention program among 2685 secondary school pupils. It was effective in reducing the prevalence rate of recent alcohol but not those of cigarette and marijuana use. Therefore, there is a need to further adapt the program and test it on a larger scale. However, it is not certain that either the European Union or the Nigerian government will fund such a project. In addition to unplugged, some universities in Nigeria practice no-drug-use-policy-based prevention strategy which consists essentially of information giving, counselling, routine urine drug screening and suspension to obtain treatment or outright rustication for those who screen positive. This may have the effect of reducing the rate of positive screen on the long run, but not necessarily due to a decrease in the rate of substance use among the students.

Treatment for persons with substance abuse as a means of controlling the problem is another area of challenge with an inadequate number of treatment programs (TPs) and the non-existence of an integrated treatment system (ITS) in Nigeria. On one hand, TPs focus on primary outcomes of treatment, namely reduction or cessation of substance use. There are only eleven model treatment centres for an estimated 3 million people living with substance abuse in the country. On the other hand, ITS addresses intermediary outcomes of treatment which are the multi-domain problems associated with the causes or the consequences of substance abuse, such as medical, mental, family, education, occupational, housing and legal problems. ITS is a working partnership of professionals in a group of interrelated, or interdependent treatment and rehabilitative 'elements' (such as general medical, housing, employment and legal services) that form a combined response to

substance abuse problems in a defined region or country. Although the services are available in the Nigerian communities, there is no recognized collaboration among them for the purpose of holistic substance abuse treatment. During and after treatment, patients with substance abuse and their relatives are practically left to negotiate many of these related agencies on their own to obtain the needed complementary services.

In conclusion, though the ravaging effects of substance abuse may be regarded as a challenge to the youths in Nigeria, the real challenge is in finding the overall strategy to promote a sense of well-being and self-efficacy among the youths without recourse to substance abuse; to promote the socio-economic welfare of the populace as a whole thereby reducing the risk for drug peddling; to promote the idea and skill of self-rescue among those living with substance abuse in an ITS.

How To Reduce Addiction Risk Factors For Your Teen

Just as risk factors for addiction can vary in effect, depending on the person and their age, protective factors can also have a greater impact at certain life stages. Below are some protective factors against addiction, that are especially effective for teenagers and young adults.

1. Parental monitoring
2. Strong child-parent bond
3. Anti-drug use policies and regulations
4. Strong neighborhood attachment
5. Safe and supportive community
6. Safe and supportive relationships
7. Self-care and taking care of one's mental health
8. Teaching positive coping skills, to deal with stress and pressure
9. Family, school, and community interventions to promote positive behaviors in teens
10. Open and caring conversations with caregivers

Way Out

Substance Use Disorder or Drug abuse is a complex but treatable disease that affects a person's cognitive function and behavior. No single treatment is right for everyone. However, effective treatment for SUD

atment aims to help individuals develop a healthier relationship with
gs, helping them live productive lives in relationships with their
ily, work, and society.

eatment may involve some of the following components:

1. **Medications:** Can help minimize withdrawal symptoms and prevent the return to unsafe use.
2. **Behavioral counseling:** Helps individuals modify their attitudes and behaviors related to substance use, increase healthy life skills, develop problem-solving skills, and stick to treatment plans.
3. **Group therapy:** Gives people the chance to acknowledge, share, and work through the psychological aspects of recovery with a group of peers under professional guidance.
4. **Additional support:** May include vocational training and other resources that address problems associated with SUD, such as mental health conditions, unemployment, and medical conditions.

In order to address the public health, and social problems resulting from abuse of drugs, the three arms of government – the executive, the legislature and the judiciary, Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs) of Health, health, educational and religious institutions, parents must address the issues with vigour and holistically through these approaches:

1. Collaboration among strategic agencies (Nigeria Custom Services, National Drug Law Enforcement Agency and NAFDAC) responsible for importation and regulation of controlled medicines and/or prevent the importation, distribution and use of illicit drugs .
2. Heightened regulatory alertness, diligence and control of importation of drugs and food, now that NAFDAC has been returned back to our ports and borders
3. The Federal Ministry of Health should develop National Prescription Policy

4. Enforcement of the prescription policy by the Federal Ministry of Health
5. Advocacy, and public awareness campaign through the print, social and electronic media should be carried out. Ministry of information and agencies directly responsible for the end users and consumers such as the Pharmacists Council of Nigeria (PCN), Pharmaceutical Society of Nigeria (PSN), NAFDAC, Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN), etc should play active role in these. Additional funding of these should be provided by the government
6. Stricter issuance of permits and registration of controlled medicines by NAFDAC
7. Greater collaboration through use of task forces among regulatory bodies responsible for drugs and controlled substances – NDLEA,NAFDAC and PCN
8. Extra-territorial enforcement to identify, disrupt and dismantle organised criminal groups operating across borders.
9. Review of the drug laws to enable the judiciary apply penalties that are commensurate to the offences.
10. Provision of more rehabilitation centres and workers to assist those that are addicted to controlled drugs
11. Provision of educational and employment opportunities to the youth
12. Greater involvement of parents in the guidance of their children and strengthening of the marriage institutions for effective upbringing of children.
13. Greater involvement of educational institutions through emphasis in the curriculum about dangers of drug abuse, and of religious institutions in laying more emphasis on the protection of the body from substances that can damage and destroy it.

As a result of this crisis, the government is actively and currently working with various MDAs to mitigate the abuse of drugs in the country. If all the stated approaches are implemented, the nation and its youth can be spared from the current nightmare.

Conclusion

Findings from the epidemiological studies, reports and drug laws in Nigeria have shown that the burden of drug abuse is growing despite several drug laws, policies and strategic plans to prevent it. The prevalence is higher among the younger population, males, undergraduate and secondary school students, and commercial vehicle drivers. The most abused drugs included cannabis, amphetamine, codeine, cocaine and heroin. The major sources for the drugs were pharmacies/patent medicine stores, drug hawkers, friends who are abusers and drug pushers. The frequent reasons for indulging into drug abuse were to improve physical performance, to drive pleasure, desire to sleep, to experiment/curiosity motives, and to keep awake. Factors such as poor socioeconomic status, peer-group pressure, family problems and poor academic performance were commonly associated with drug abuse in Nigeria. Drug abuse has been a cause of many debilitating conditions such as schizophrenia and psychosis, leading to psychiatric admissions. Therefore, stringent measures and sustainable interventions are urgently needed to curb the increasing burden of drug abuse in Nigeria.

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CHAPTER TEN

PARTY SYSTEM AND CORRUPTION IN NIGERIAN LEADERSHIP

James N. Nnoruga, PhD

Introduction

The problem of Nigeria as a nation according to Achebe (1983) has been the problem of leadership. When Nigeria got her independence, the Nigerian elites or politicians found themself legitimizing and protecting what the colonial masters had left illegitimately. Hence the struggle for independence gave Nigerian peoples a togetherness but not unity, it gave Nigeria confidence but not strength. Nigeria being a country that is made of different languages, cultures, religions, and ethnicities, randomly put together and handed over to nationally inept politicians at independence, it gave rise to bad leadership. This led to many things like the rapid dilution of traditional institutions, it led to hanging on to power at all costs, corruption, coup upon coup, and the display of conspicuous affluence by the politicians as a status symbol. These actions, perceptions, and behaviors according to Ojukwu (2011) caused a fulcrum of social disequilibrium and corruption in the Nigerian political system. In the wake of all this confusion, the military intervened through coup d'etat several times in the democratic government of Nigeria.

To understand fully, the failure of leadership that overtook Nigeria after independence, one has to understand the personalities of the Nigerian post-independence leaders, for they are products of a destructive system according to some scholars. That destructive system was colonialists from whom the early Nigerian politicians gained their strengths and weaknesses directly from, when they left the shores of the country. The colonialists to install a colonialist government in Nigeria's political system, dismantled the indigenous structures and imposed a new structure that would be more responsive to the colonialists' interests. The result

this condition up till today is endemic corruption in the democratic leadership, which no elected democratic government in Nigeria has been able to solve. Again, the respect for the rule of law became mere propaganda while in truth Nigerian politicians respect only the rule of the outlaw (Ojukwu, 2011).

On the formation of the polity or party system in Nigeria, the pattern of the Nigerian polity has always been that of imposition by the powerful elites or politicians. Nigerians have never truly exercised their sovereign rights in deciding what pattern they desired, it has been a sort of power imposition by the body in charge of elections, or bigwigs in the political parties. Even the amalgamation was the brainchild of Lord Frederick Lugard, the federation with a weak center was the brainchild of Sir Arthur Richards and later Lord Milverton, the federation with a strong center was the imposition of the military, the present 1999 constitution was the brainchild of the Military regime, hence, the clamor for a new constitution is going on today in Nigeria. The same imposition was seen in the formation of the political parties in Nigeria which dates back to the Clifford Constitution of 1922. Sequel to this, the parties that were formed before independence in 1960 were all regionally and ethnically based and were as the result of the provisions of the parliamentary constitution of 1951 (Agbu, 2016).

Having seen the bad background of the Nigerian democratic system that breeds corruption and failed leadership in Nigeria's political system, it is expected that at the end of this session, the student should be able to know the dates of the formation of political parties and their ideologies, the role of political parties in the Nigerian leadership, to identify different forms and manifestations of corruption in the Nigerian politics, the challenges of corruption and consequences of bad leadership in Nigeria.

The Historical Formation of Political Party System in Nigeria

In general, a political party can be defined as a group of people or individuals that is publicly organized to gain control of the government to raise certain aims or objectives for the good of the people (Nnamuo, 1990). However, the Independent Electoral Commission (INEC) (2003) defines a political party as an organized group of individuals with shared

political objectives, principles, and ideologies. These parties are officially registered with INEC by the provisions of the Nigerian Constitution and the Electoral Act. INEC's definition of a political party encompasses several key elements and roles:

Being an Organized Group: A political party is structured and organized, typically with formal leadership positions, party structures, and decision-making processes. It operates as a cohesive entity with a defined membership base.

Shared Political Objectives, Principles, and Ideologies: Political parties are characterized by a common set of goals, beliefs, and values. These objectives, principles, and ideologies guide the party's policies, programs, and actions. They provide a basis for party cohesion and differentiation from other political groups.

Official Registration with INEC: To be recognized as a political party in Nigeria, an organization must undergo a registration process with INEC. This process involves meeting certain criteria, such as submitting a constitution, holding congresses, and having a national spread as prescribed by the Electoral Act.

Compliance with Constitutional and Legal Provisions: Political parties are expected to operate within the framework of the Nigerian Constitution and relevant electoral laws. This includes adhering to regulations regarding party registration, conduct of primaries, campaign finance, and participation in elections.

Overall, INEC's definition of a political party underscores the importance of organization, shared ideology, and compliance with legal requirements in the functioning of political parties within the Nigerian democratic system. The political party seeks to control the state power and government of the day. A political party is differentiated from other groups of people because it seeks to take over the business of government through constitutionally accepted means. For many years Nigeria has

...rating a multi-party system of democratic government except for ...e brief period of the two-party system in 1992 which consisted of the Social Democratic Party (SDP) and the National Republican Convention (NRC).

Several political parties were formed before Nigeria's independence in 1960, to advocate for various interests and aspirations within the colonial framework. The political parties at this time were formed by some nationalist agitators like Herbert Macaulay, Ernest Okafi, Nnamdi Azikiwe, Obafemi Awolowo, and others to take a stand against colonial misrule. They were precursors of political parties in Nigeria and they were at the forefront of the political activities and party formation in the 1920s and thereafter.

The pre-independence political parties in Nigeria were formed due to some factors like the constitutional development of 1922, to achieve complete autonomy within the British Empire, to seek total independence for Nigeria, the creation of the Middle Belt region, and so on. Some of the pre-independence political parties include: the Nigerian National Democratic Party (NNDP) which was founded in 1923 by Herbert Macaulay, the NNDP was one of the earliest political parties in Nigeria during the colonial era. It represented the interests of the Lagos elites and played a role in the legislative council elections under colonial rule. The National Council of Nigeria and the Cameroons (NCNC) was established in 1944 by Herbert Macaulay and Nnamdi Azikiwe, the NCNC was one of the major political parties advocating for independence from British colonial rule. It drew support from various ethnic groups in Nigeria, particularly in the Eastern and Midwestern regions. Action Group (AG) was formed in 1951 by Obafemi Awolowo, the Action Group was a major political party in Western Nigeria. It promoted socialist and populist policies, focusing on education, agriculture, and social welfare. Northern People's Congress (NPC) was founded in 1949, the NPC primarily represented the interests of Northern Nigeria. It was led by prominent Northern politicians such as Ahmadu Bello, the party played a key role in the politics of the Northern region.

United Middle Belt Congress (UMBC) was established in 1957, the UMBC represented the interests of ethnic minorities in the Middle Bel

region of Nigeria. It sought to address the concerns of marginalized groups and advocated for their inclusion in the political process. Northern Elements Progressive Union (NEPU) was formed in 1950. NEPU was a political party that emerged from the radical wing of the NPC in Northern Nigeria. It was led by Aminu Kano, NEPU advocated for the rights of the common people, particularly in the Northern region. Igala Union was founded in 1946, the Igala Union was a political organization that represented the interests of the Igala people in present-day Kogi State. It advocated for greater political representation and social development for the Igala ethnic group. Niger Delta Congress (NDC) was established in the late 1940s, the Niger Delta Congress was a political party representing the interests of the people of the Niger Delta region. It advocated for resource control and equitable development for the oil-rich region. Other political parties include the National Congress of British West Africa Territories (1920), the West African Students Union (1925) and the Lagos Youth Movement (1934). These are some of the pre-independence political parties that played crucial roles in shaping the political landscape of Nigeria and laying the groundwork for the country's eventual independence from British colonial rule. They represented diverse ethnic, regional, and ideological interests, contributing to the nation-building process.

During Nigeria's First and Second Republics, several political parties participated in the democratic governance of the country. First Republic (1960-1966: During Nigeria's First Republic, which lasted from independence in 1960 until the military coup in 1966, the country operated a multi-party system. However, the key political parties were:

- Northern People's Congress (NPC)
- National Council of Nigeria and the Cameroons (NCNC)
- Action Group (AG)
- United Middle Belt Congress (UMBC)

Second Republic (1979-1983): During Nigeria's Second Republic, which followed the transition from military rule to civilian government in 1979, there was also a multi-party system. However, the notable political parties then were:

National Party of Nigeria (NPN)

Unity Party of Nigeria (UPN)

Nigerian People's Party (NPP)

Great Nigeria People's Party (GNPP)

People's Redemption Party (PRP)

Nigeria Advance Party (NAP)

National Party of Nigeria (NPN) was formed in 1978, it was a major political party during Nigeria's Second Republic (1979-1983). It advocated for conservative social values, grassroots mobilization, and populist economic policies aimed at alleviating poverty and improving living standards. Under this platform or party Alhaji Shehu Shagari emerged as the president of Nigeria in 1979.

Unity Party of Nigeria (UPN) was formed in 1978 by Obafemi Awolowo, it championed progressive and socialist policies, similar to the Action Group, with an emphasis on education, healthcare, and regional autonomy.

Nigerian People's Party (NPP) was formed in1978, NPP advocated for progressive and social democratic policies, and focused on social justice, equitable distribution of resources, and empowerment of the masses.

Great Nigeria People's Party (GNPP) was formed in 1978, it primarily represented the interests of Northern Nigeria and advocated for conservative social values, regional autonomy, and the protection of traditional institutions.

People's Redemption Party (PRP) was also formed in1978 by Aminu Kano. PRP advocated for socialist policies, grassroots mobilization, and empowerment of the working class, with an emphasis on social justice, equitable development, and participatory democracy.

Nigeria Alliance Party (NAP) was formed in 1978, it represented a moderate and centrist political platform, advocating for pragmatic policies aimed at addressing the country's socio-economic challenges while maintaining stability and national unity.

These political parties played significant roles in shaping Nigeria's political landscape during their respective periods, representing diverse ideological orientations and regional interests.

In the last 2023 general election, the Independent Electoral Commission (INEC) deregistered about 74 political parties vying for different posts in different positions in Nigeria's political space, and 19 political parties were later registered (Sanni, 2020). Some political parties that have been registered and have at least participated in the last two elections (2019-2023) in Nigeria include:

All Progressives Congress (APC) was formed in 2013 through a merger of several opposition parties, including the Action Congress of Nigeria (ACN) and the Congress for Progressive Change (CPC). APC won the presidential election in 2015, 2019 and 2023, becoming the ruling party at the federal level. People's Democratic Party (PDP) was established in 1998, PDP has been one of the dominant parties in Nigeria's Fourth Republic. PDP held the presidency for 16 years from 1999 to 2015 before losing to the APC. All Progressives Grand Alliance (APGA) was founded in 2002, APGA is a political party primarily based in the southeastern region of Nigeria. It has won several gubernatorial elections in Anambra State and has representation in other states as well. Social Democratic Party (SDP) was revived in 2017, the SDP is a reincarnation of the historical party that participated in Nigeria's aborted Third Republic. SDP contested in the 2019 and 2023 general elections and has been active in promoting its agenda.

Labour Party (LP) was established in 2002, LP is a political party with a focus on workers' rights and social justice. LP participated in the 2015, 2019 and 2023 general elections, fielding candidates for various positions. Young Progressive Party (YPP) was formed in 2017, YPP is another relatively new party that aims to engage young Nigerians in politics. YPP participated in the 2019 and 2023 general elections and has

been active in promoting youth empowerment, social justice, economic reforms. Zenith Labour Party (ZLP) was established in 2018. ZLP is a party that emerged from internal conflicts within other political parties. ZLP contested in the 2019 and 2023 general elections and has been positioning itself as an alternative political platform for possible merger with other political parties. African Democratic Congress (ADC) was founded in 2017. ADC is a party that emphasizes democratic principles and good governance. ADC participated in the 2019 and 2023 general elections and has been active in grassroots mobilization. These political parties and others represent a diverse range of ideologies and interests within Nigeria's political landscape, offering voters various choices during elections.

Definition and Forms of Corruption in Nigerian Leadership

There are many definitions of corruption depending from the angle one wants to view it from, and it has infiltrated virtually every aspect of human life, in different countries of the world, in different human transactions and endeavors. Corruption generally can be seen as abuse of public power for personal gain by individual institutions in the public or private sectors (Anowai, 2011). In conventional development strategy, it is identified as a major obstacle to the promotion of effective and sustained economic growth, in the political arena, corruption undermines the capacity of the state and its institutions to function efficiently, it compromises the electoral process while eroding trust and legitimacy in a polity. In the sector of the economy, corruption encourages waste, fake products, distorting markets and competition, inflation, and high exchange rates. In the religious sphere, corruption breeds fake pastors and immorality, high rate of crimes, religious wars/crises and disobedience to the rule of law. While on the social sphere, it generates intergroup tensions and conflicts among the people. In overall, corruption has corrosive effects on national development.

In the Nigerian leadership context, corruption refers to the abuse of entrusted power for personal gain or the diversion of public resources for private interests. It encompasses a wide range of unethical and illegal activities that undermine the integrity, transparency, and accountability of governance processes. Understanding corruption in the Nigeria

ership context involves recognizing its pervasive nature, its imental effects on society, and the complex factors that contribute to persistence. Corruption among the ruling class or politicians has been bane of Nigerian leadership, which is being perpetuated knowingly unknowingly through all the sectors of government parastatals. This in fore-stalls the development and progress of the nation in all sectors her life. Corruption in Nigeria historic composition which composed he Hausa, the Igbo, the Yoruba and other ethnic nationalities, has its ts and roles which they played in Nigeria historic amalgamation. rruption as a common existential phenomenon in Nigeria has a link h these ethnic nationalities which resulted in one or two ethnic groups nationalities with their religious affiliations seeing themselves as the ing class whether qualified or not. Hence, corruption in Nigeria kept eeding social, economic, and political distrust and anarchy in the ciety.

rms or Kinds of Corruption

here is no agreed types or forms of corruption because it is found in fferent forms and in many ways, and it relates to human endeavor. orruption can take many forms which are linked to different behaviors, ch as bribery, embezzlement, nepotism, extortion, money laundering, aud, and so on. Forms of corruption include among others:

inancial Corruption: This includes embezzlement, bribery, kickbacks, nd misappropriation of public funds.

olitical Corruption: Involves the manipulation of political processes, uch as electoral fraud, vote-buying, and abuse of power for partisan ain.

Administrative Corruption: Refers to nepotism, favoritism, and abuse f office for personal or family interests.

Transactional Corruption: Occurs in day-to-day interactions with government officials, such as extortion, facilitation payments, and 'ghost worker' schemes.

Grand Corruption: Involves high-level corruption among top government officials and political elites, often leading to massive looting of public resources.

Educational Corruption: This consists of examination malpractices, admission fraud, degree purchasing certificate forgery, sexual harassment and exploitations, mismanagement education fund. Educational corruption in Nigeria undermines the quality and integrity of the education system, perpetuates inequality and injustice, and ultimately hinders national development. Addressing this form of corruption requires concerted efforts to promote transparency and accountability in educational institutions, enforce anti-corruption laws and regulations, strengthen oversight mechanisms, and promote ethical standards among educators and students. Additionally, investing in education infrastructure, enhancing teacher training and welfare, and fostering a culture of integrity and meritocracy are essential for combating educational corruption and ensuring access to quality education for all.

Political corruption within the context of the party system and Nigerian leadership refers to the misuse of political power, influence, and resources by political parties and their members for personal gain, partisan interests, or the perpetuation of their hold on political power. This form of corruption undermines the integrity of the political process, distorts democratic governance, and erodes public trust in political institutions. Political corruption in the Nigerian context, specifically focusing on its connection to the party system and leadership can be seen in these forms:

Vote Buying and Electoral Fraud: Political parties may engage in vote buying, where they offer cash, gifts, or other inducements to voters in exchange for their votes. Electoral fraud, including ballot stuffing, rigging, and manipulation of election results from polling units and on the INEC result viewing portal (IREV) which are perpetrated by political parties to secure victory in elections. This was seen in the last presidential election of 2023 in Nigeria.

Capture of State Institutions: Political parties in power may seek to capture key state institutions, such as the judiciary, electoral commission,

and security agencies, to manipulate the electoral process in their favour. By exerting control over these institutions, ruling parties can stifle opposition, silence the opposition, and perpetuate their hold on political power through unfair electoral practices or processes.

Patronage and Nepotism: Political parties often engage in patronage politics, where party leaders distribute favors, appointments, and government contracts to loyal supporters and cronies, regardless of merit or competence. Nepotism, favoritism towards family members and close associates, is prevalent within political parties and can lead to appointing unqualified individuals to key government positions. This is not good for good democratic governance.

Money Politics and Campaign Finance Abuse: Political parties may rely on illicit funds, including proceeds from corruption, to finance their election campaigns, circumventing legal limits on campaign spending. Wealthy individuals and special interest groups may also influence political parties through large donations and contributions, potentially compromising the parties' independence and integrity. This explains the issue of godfather in Nigerian politics.

Internal Party Corruption and Factionalism: Corruption can manifest within political parties through internal power struggles, factionalism, and the manipulation of party structures and processes. This also explains two party chairmen in one political party and each with its own factions. Party officials may engage in corrupt practices such as embezzlement of party funds, sale of party tickets, and rigging of internal party elections to consolidate their power and influence within the party.

Capture of Public Resources for Partisan Ends: Parties in power may use state resources, including government funds, infrastructure, and personnel, for partisan purposes such as financing party activities, mobilizing supporters, and rewarding political allies. This misuse of public resources not only undermines public trust in government but also distorts the level playing field in the political arena, disadvantaging opposition parties and candidates.

Corruption in Legislative Processes: Corruption can infiltrate legislative processes, including the passage of laws, budget allocations, and oversight functions, through bribery, extortion, and other illicit means. Politicians may trade legislative favors, influence votes, and engage in backroom deals to advance their interests or those of their political parties, often at the expense of the public good. The case of budget padding in the 2024 budget in the national assembly was a good example of the infiltration of corruption among the legislative members.

Challenges and Implications of Corruption in the Nigerian Democratic Leadership

Corruption poses significant challenges and has far-reaching implications for democratic governance in Nigeria. Due to level of corruption in the Nigeria as a country, Chukwu and Madubuko (2009) remarked that Nigeria is one of the most disorderly nations in the world, and it is one of the most corrupt, insensitive, inefficient places under the sun. As of today, there are many challenges and implications of corruption in the governance of Nigeria. Some of the challenges include:

Undermining Democratic Institutions: Many scholars believe strongly that corruption weakens the effectiveness and legitimacy of democratic institutions such as the judiciary, legislature, and electoral commission by eroding public trust and confidence in their impartiality and integrity. It compromises the separation of powers and undermines the rule of law, leading to the concentration of power in the hands of corrupt elites and political cronies. And to perpetuate power within themselves, they keep giving palliatives to citizens and workers as a measure to forestall riots or revolutions.

Erosion of Public Trust and Confidence: Widespread corruption erodes public trust and confidence in Nigerian government institutions, political leaders, and the democratic process itself, leading to disillusionment and apathy among citizens. Lack of confidence in the government's ability to deliver essential services and uphold the rule of law undermines the social contract between the state and its citizens, this weakens the foundation of democracy on daily basis.

Impeding Development and Economic Growth: Corruption diverts public resources away from essential services such as healthcare, education, and infrastructure development, hindering socioeconomic development thereby perpetuating poverty and inequality among its citizens. It distorts markets, deters foreign investment, and undermines investor confidence to invest in Nigeria.

Undermining Electoral Integrity: Electoral corruption, including vote buying, rigging, and manipulation of electoral processes, undermines the integrity and credibility of elections, rendering them less free, fair, and transparent. It twists electoral outcomes, stifles political competition, and diminishes the legitimacy of elected officials, undermining the democratic principles of accountability and representation. This accounts for the high number of election tribunal cases in the Nigerian tribunals after each election.

Perpetuating Social Injustice and Inequality: Corruption increases social injustice and inequality by favoring the interests of corrupt elites and political cronies at the expense of the general population, particularly marginalized and vulnerable groups. It perpetuates a culture of impunity, where the wealthy and well-connected politicians and elites can evade accountability for their actions, further entrenching disparities in wealth and power.

Some of the implications include:

Political Instability and Conflict: Pervasive corruption fuels political instability, social unrest, and communal tensions, as grievances over resource allocation, political exclusion, and economic inequality escalate into conflicts and violence. It undermines the social cohesion and stability necessary for democratic governance, increasing ethnic, religious, and regional divisions. This also accounts for the high rate of kidnappings in the different parts of the world.

Weakened Democratic Institutions: Corruption weakens the capacity and effectiveness of democratic institutions to deliver public goods and services, enforce the rule of law, and protect citizens' rights and freedoms. It undermines the checks and balances essential for holding

government officials accountable and promoting transparency and accountability in governance. This is the greatest problem Nigeria as a nation is undergoing as of now.

Stunted Economic Development: Corruption impedes economic development and undermines efforts to alleviate poverty, improve healthcare, education, and infrastructure, and achieve sustainable development goals. It hampers private sector growth, stifles innovation and entrepreneurship, and reduces foreign direct investment, perpetuating a cycle of underdevelopment and dependency. Hence, Nigeria goes borrowing each year to finance their yearly budget.

Loss of Human Capital and Talent: Corruption drives away talented and skilled individuals from public service and discourages investment in education, research, and innovation, depriving the country of critical human capital necessary for development. Brain drain and talent flight increase the skills gap and hinder efforts to build a competent and professional civil service and political leadership.

Diminished International Reputation and Relations: Nigeria's reputation as a corrupt nation undermines its standing in the international community, damaging diplomatic relations, foreign investment, and access to international aid and assistance. As of today, Nigeria ranks as one of the highest corrupt countries of the world. It undermines Nigeria's credibility as a reliable partner for bilateral and multilateral cooperation, hindering efforts to address global challenges such as climate change, security threats, and pandemics.

Conclusion

To curb political corruption within the party system and Nigerian leadership requires comprehensive reforms to strengthen democratic institutions, promote transparency and accountability, and foster a culture of integrity and ethical leadership. This includes enacting and enforcing anti-corruption laws, enhancing electoral integrity and campaign finance regulations, promoting citizen engagement, and empowering independent anti-corruption agencies to investigate and prosecute corrupt practices. Additionally, building strong democratic institutions, promoting internal party democracy, and nurturing a vibrant civil society are essential for

combating political corruption and ensuring the accountability of political parties and leaders to the Nigerian people. Again, to address corruption in Nigeria's democratic governance requires concerted efforts to strengthen democratic institutions, promote transparency and accountability, and foster a culture of integrity and ethical leadership. This includes enacting and enforcing anti-corruption laws, strengthening judicial independence, enhancing electoral integrity, and empowering civil society and the media to hold government officials accountable. Additionally, promoting inclusive economic growth, reducing poverty and inequality, and investing in education and healthcare are essential for building a more resilient and sustainable democracy in Nigeria. These measures should serve as means and ways to curtail the systemic corruption found in the party system and leadership corruption in the Nigerian democratic system.

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CHAPTER ELEVEN

CHALLENGES OF NEO-COLONIALISM IN NIGERIA

Stella Chimezie Agbanyim, PhD

Introduction

The concept of neo-colonialism is simply the furtherance of colonialism in other ways other than direct subjugation of a people. The trend of colonialism in international relations began to speedily wane with increased emphasis on rights to self-determination in the post-World War II era. However, in a world of power politics where suzerainty is a reality, the former colonial overlords of Europe continue to devise means through which they can maintain influence – albeit indirectly – on their former colonies. It is from this attempt that the trend of neo-colonialism emanated and it has since been fostered by other global developments such as the spread of the idea of western democracy – which is imbedded on capitalism – and globalisation.

Indeed, colonialism has been present in the global power politics over the years as it was an effective tool of empire building. However, the emergence of European colonialism in Africa is traceable to the scramble of Africa by the emergent European powers at the wake of Age of Enlightenment in Europe and the Berlin Conference that followed. It is a common knowledge that the political competition among European powers played out in Africa as countries such as France, Germany, Britain, Belgium, Portugal, the Netherlands among others, engaged in power tussle and they sought to outgrow each other in the race of modern day empire-building.

While the European powers scrambled for Africa, the area which later became known as Nigeria came to fall within the sphere of active British contact and influence in West Africa. In essence, Nigeria came to be because of British colonialism. As KBC Onwubiko (1972) puts it:

> It is an indisputable fact of history that Nigeria is a British creation; that the various peoples of Nigeria were brought together politically by the efforts of British officials and traders with the support of the British government.

From the foregoing, one can adduce that the making of Nigeria is a significant milestone in the history of British imperialism. The imperia activities of the British in Nigeria came in stages The first stage was the British annexation of Lagos in 1961; the second stage was the establishment of British protectorate over the Oil River in 1885, then going by the agreement of Berlin Conference of 1884-1885, where the principle effective occupation was established, the British launched the third stage which was the creation of Protectorate of Southern Nigeria in January 1900. Thenceforth, amalgamation process and effective administration of Nigeria as a single entity commenced, hence Nigeria was formally colonised.

Colonialism in Nigeria featured various developments which included far-reaching changes in the primordial societies that came to be amalgamated to become the single entity, Nigeria. Until, 1914, the entity known and called Nigeria today, was a geographical enclave that composed of many independent ethnic groups which had little in common except in trade and commerce. Prior to the coming of the Europeans, these autonomous groups cherished their diverse identities and ways of life which included a well formed structure of ascendency to power cum system of governance, socio-economic and cultural way of life. These groups include Hausa/ Fulani, Igbo, Yoruba, Tiv, Nupe, Itsekiri, Ijaw, Efik, Ibibio among others.

Another feature of colonialism in Nigeria is the British style of administration, which was the Indirect Rule system that was alien to the people. The system had varied results considering the existing traditional political system. (Johnson, 2010) While it achieves some successes in the centralised and semi-centralised societies of northern and western Nigeria respectively, it proved a total failure in the decentralised eastern Nigeria. There were also other features which included economic exploitation that could be seen from the colonial policies (Obiakor & Agajelu, 2016).

cultural assimilation that could be seen in the emphasis on the acquisition of western education (Anderson, 2014), urbanisation, demonetisation of local currencies and nationalism among others.

Being a principal feature of colonialism in Nigeria, Nationalism came in various stages. There was the early resistance put up by different peoples of Nigeria before colonialism, the elite nationalism that came with exposure of Nigerian nationals to western education, and then the nationalist mobilisation of the 1940s following the World War II. The nationalist struggles resulted to incremental moves towards independence which manifested in constitutional changes that gradually gave more governmental responsibilities to Nigerians. By October 1 1960, Nigeria had fully gained independence from the British. However, there has been the question of complete independence of Nigeria considering the obvious continued and sustained influence of the former colonial overlord on the country. This brings us to the issue of neo-colonialism in the country. Indeed, over the years Nigeria's foreign policies, stances and approaches in the international system show a country that is still under the suzerainty of another. The study discusses some of the challenges neo-colonialism poses on Nigeria.

Agents of Neo-Colonialism

The introductory section of the study has provided a valuable insight into the nature of neo-colonialism. However, before we delve into interrogating the agents of neo-colonialism, it would be proper to have a quick glance at some definitions of the concept. According to Ghanaian foremost nationalist and pan-Africanist, Nkrumah (1965), "Neo-colonialism is the practice of using capitalism, globalization, and cultural imperialism to influence a developing country instead of the previous colonial methods of direct military control or indirect political control". Young (2001), see Neo-colonialism as the control exercised by former colonial powers over former colonies and other developing countries through economic, political, and cultural pressures. To Chomsky (1993) "Neo-colonialism can be understood as the continuation of the economic model of colonialism after a colonized territory has achieved formal political independence". Furthermore, the term neo-colonialism denotes a situation in which the major economic and political power continues to

influence the economies and politics of formally independent countries (Galtung, 1971).

Multinational and Transnational Corporations

Multinational corporations (MNCs) and transnational corporations (TNCs) have played pivotal roles in shaping the economic landscape of Nigeria, often being viewed as agents of neo-colonialism due to their significant influence and impact on the country's socio-economic dynamics. Neo-colonialism refers to the indirect, subtle form of control and dominance exercised by powerful foreign entities over developing nations, perpetuating dependency and exploitation despite political independence.

Nigeria, endowed with vast natural resources including oil, has attracted numerous MNCs and TNCs seeking to exploit these resources for profit. The extraction and export of oil, primarily controlled by foreign corporations, have generated immense revenues but have also led to issues such as environmental degradation, social inequality, and economic instability. These corporations, often from Western countries, establish operations in Nigeria under agreements that heavily favor their interests, leading to what some critics label as a continuation of colonial economic exploitation.

One critical aspect of neo-colonialism in Nigeria is the asymmetrical power relations between multinational corporations and the Nigerian government. MNCs/TNCs wield significant economic influence, often negotiating terms that prioritize profit maximization over local development or environmental sustainability. For instance, agreements regarding tax incentives, profit repatriation, and environmental regulations are frequently skewed in favor of these corporations, limiting the government's ability to assert sovereignty and regulate in the national interest (Ikelegbe, 2017).

Moreover, the presence of multinational corporations has been linked to the exacerbation of socio-economic inequalities within Nigeria. Despite the influx of revenue from oil and other resources, much of the wealth remains concentrated among a small elite, while vast segments of the population struggle with poverty, inadequate infrastructure, and limited

access to basic services. This disparity is partly attributed to the extraction-oriented practices of MNCs/TNCs, which prioritize capital accumulation over broader social development (Obi, 2019).

Critics argue that multinational corporations perpetuate a cycle of dependency whereby Nigeria remains reliant on foreign expertise, technology, and capital, stifling the growth of indigenous industries and hindering sustainable development. The dominance of foreign corporations in key sectors of the economy also limits diversification efforts, leaving Nigeria vulnerable to fluctuations in global commodity prices and economic shocks.

Efforts to mitigate the neo-colonial impact of multinational corporations in Nigeria have been sporadic and often ineffectual. Calls for renegotiating contracts, strengthening regulatory frameworks, and promoting local content policies have met with mixed success due to entrenched interests and complex geopolitical dynamics. Civil society organizations and grassroots movements have increasingly called for greater transparency, accountability, and community participation in decision-making processes involving multinational corporations (Akpan, 2020).

Bretton Woods Institutions

The Bretton Woods institutions, primarily the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank, were established in 1944 with the aim of promoting international monetary cooperation, facilitating trade, and fostering economic development. While these institutions have played significant roles in global economic stability, their influence in Nigeria has sparked intense debate regarding their roles as agents of neo-colonialism.

It must be mentioned that Nigeria virtually invited the meddling of the Bretton Woods Institutions into its affairs through government policies that were inimical to the country's quest for all-encompassing growth and development. As succinctly observed by Agajelu, Obiakor & Nnoli (2016):

> In the 1970s, Nigeria enjoyed economic prosperity and the average citizen was quite oblivious of the activities

of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) elsewhere in the globe. The country in fact found itself as a donor especially to her sister countries of the West African subregion. A Nigerian head of states in the 1970s General Yakubu Gowon reportedly made a rather naïve statement that Nigeria had so much money which it did not know how to spend.1 It was on the premise of this "father Christmas" attitude of Nigeria's that the country was bestowed with the term "giant of Africa".

However, the mismanagement of the Nigeria's economy led to the economic crisis that came with the oil glut of the early 1980s and the subsequent intervention by the Bretton Woods institutions. The IMF and World Bank introduced Structural Adjustment Programs (SAPs) to stabilise the economy. These programs mandated stringent economic reforms, including currency devaluation, reduction in public expenditure, and trade liberalization (Ekpo, 2014). While these measures were intended to spur economic growth and attract foreign investment, they often resulted in increased poverty, unemployment, and reduced access to essential services like healthcare and education (Olukoshi, 2019).

Critics argue that the conditionalities imposed by the Bretton Woods institutions undermine Nigeria's sovereignty and economic independence, a hallmark of neo-colonialism. These conditions often require recipient countries to adopt policies that align with the interests of Western economies, perpetuating a dependency relationship. For instance, Nigeria's agricultural policies have been influenced by the need to meet loan conditions, which has sometimes led to the neglect of local agricultural development in favor of cash crops for export (Ake, 1981). This shift prioritizes the economic interests of developed countries over the sustainable development needs of Nigeria, reinforcing patterns of economic dependency reminiscent of colonial exploitation.

The socio-economic consequences of the Bretton Woods institutions' policies in Nigeria are significant. The implementation of SAPs led to widespread socio-economic challenges, including a decline in real wages, deterioration of public infrastructure, and increased cost of living. According to Adesina (2004), these outcomes have exacerbated poverty

levels and widened the inequality gap within the country. The reduction in public sector spending, particularly in health and education, has had long-term detrimental effects on human capital development, which is critical for sustainable economic growth.

The perception of Bretton Woods institutions as agents of neo-colonialism has spurred resistance and calls for alternative development strategies. Nigerian policymakers and scholars have advocated for more self-reliant economic policies that emphasize local industry development, diversification of the economy, and reduced dependency on external financial institutions. For instance, the adoption of the Economic Recovery and Growth Plan (ERGP) in 2017 marked a shift towards addressing domestic economic challenges through home-grown solutions rather than relying on external prescriptions (Ogunyemi, 2018).

Religious Organisations

In Nigeria, as in many post-colonial societies, religion plays a pivotal role in shaping socio-political dynamics. However, beneath the surface of spiritual guidance and community cohesion, religious organisations often serve as instruments of neo-colonialism, perpetuating foreign influences and agendas in the country's affairs. This section explores how religious organisations in Nigeria function as vehicles for neo-colonial interests, impacting various aspects of society from culture to governance.

Many religious organisations in Nigeria are affiliated with foreign entities, primarily Western or Middle-Eastern countries, which often have their own political and economic interests in the region (Falola, 2008). These affiliations can manifest in various forms, such as funding for religious activities, missionary work, or the promotion of specific ideological agendas that align with the interests of their home countries (Smith, 2015). Christianity particularly partnered with European powers to introduce the far-reaching changes which the contact between Europe and Africa resulted to. It has been established as a fact of history that the Christianisation of African peoples was one of the objectives of European incursion in the continent. The foregoing is buttressed by Nwadialor & Obiakor (2016) when they point out that by the time the British was penetrating into the interiors of Nigeria through trading activities, missionaries were also penetrating the psych of the local people

Christian religion. In essence, one could aver that the missionaries were actively involved in the process of colonisation of Nigeria.

Furthermore, the organisational structure and leadership of religious bodies in Nigeria sometimes mirror hierarchical systems inherited from colonial powers. For instance, hierarchical leadership within Christian denominations or Islamic sects may replicate power structures reminiscent of colonial administrations, where authority is centralised and often distant from the grassroots level (Falola, 2008).

Moreover, religious organisations frequently influence socio-political discourse and policymaking in Nigeria. They wield significant influence over their adherents, often mobilising them to support or oppose political candidates or policies that align with their religious doctrines or foreign backers' interests (Omotola, 2010). This influence extends to issues such as gender rights, education policy, and healthcare, where religious doctrines may clash with secular principles or local customs.

Also, the cultural impact of religion in Nigeria reflects a complex interplay between indigenous traditions and foreign influences. Religious practices introduced during colonialism have persisted and evolved, sometimes at the expense of indigenous belief systems or cultural practices (Smith, 2015). This cultural imposition can be seen as a form of neo-colonialism, where foreign religious values and norms supplant or marginalise local traditions.

Combating Neocolonialism: De-Westernisation

For Nigeria to embark on the path of sustainable development, it needs to disentangle itself from the stranglehold of neo-colonialism. To achieve this there is the need to ensure the de-westernisation of Nigeria. Of course there are strategies that could be employed to ensure the proposed de-Westernisation. These strategies are discussed in the following part of this section of the study.

Encouragement of African Cultures

In the wake of colonialism and ongoing globalisation, Nigeria, like many African nations, faces the challenge of preserving and promoting its indigenous cultures amidst neo-colonialism that could be seen in the pervasive Western influences. Here we explore the significance of

encouraging African culture as a strategic approach to counteract the processes of Westernisation in Nigeria, emphasising the importance of cultural identity, social cohesion, and sustainable development.

Africa's encounter with Western colonial powers profoundly impacted its cultural landscape, often leading to the marginalisation and suppression of indigenous traditions (Achebe, 1958). The legacy of colonialism persists through the dominance of Western languages, education systems, and socio-economic structures, which continue to shape Nigeria's societal norms and values (Nwagbara, 2019).

Encouraging African culture represents a multifaceted strategy to reclaim cultural sovereignty and foster national unity. By revitalising traditional languages, arts, music, and oral histories, Nigeria can reaffirm its distinct cultural identity (Anyanwu, 2017). This cultural resurgence not only preserves heritage but also empowers communities economically through tourism and artisanal industries rooted in indigenous practices (Okpewho, 1998).

Moreover, promoting African culture serves as a catalyst for social cohesion and inclusivity. Embracing diverse cultural expressions enhances respect for pluralism and mutual understanding among Nigeria's ethnically and religiously diverse population (Anyanwu, 2017). Cultural celebrations and festivals become platforms for dialogue and reconciliation, bridging divides exacerbated by historical injustices and contemporary socio-political tensions (Nwagbara, 2019).

Furthermore, the integration of African cultural values into governance and development policies fosters sustainable practices that align with local ecological knowledge and community needs. For instance, indigenous farming techniques and medicinal practices offer sustainable alternatives to Western agricultural methods and pharmaceuticals, promoting environmental conservation and public health (Anyanwu, 2017; Okpewho, 1998).

Promotion of Pan-Africanism

Pan-Africanism, a political and cultural movement advocating for the solidarity of African nations and peoples, has been instrumental in shaping the identity and socio-political landscape of the African

...ment. In Nigeria, Pan-Africanism can serve as a powerful strategy for de-westernization, aiming to restore indigenous cultural values, promote economic independence, and foster political unity. This essay explores how Pan-Africanism can be effectively utilized to counteract the pervasive influence of Western culture and ideologies in Nigeria.

Pan-Africanism emerged in the late 19th and early 20th centuries as a response to the racial discrimination and colonial exploitation experienced by Africans and the African diaspora. Prominent figures such as W.E.B. Du Bois, Marcus Garvey, and Kwame Nkrumah championed the cause, advocating for the unification and liberation of African peoples. The movement gained significant momentum during the decolonization period of the 1950s and 1960s, leading to the independence of many African nations, including Nigeria in 1960 (Adi, 2002).

One of the primary ways Pan-Africanism can aid in the de-westernization of Nigeria is through the revival and promotion of indigenous cultures. Western colonialism imposed foreign languages, religions, and social norms on Nigerian society, often at the expense of local traditions. Pan-Africanism encourages the re-embracement of African languages, art forms, and cultural practices. For instance, promoting the use of indigenous languages in education and media can help preserve Nigeria's rich linguistic heritage and foster a sense of national pride (Mazrui, 1986).

Furthermore, the revaluation of traditional African religions and customs can counteract the dominance of Western religious and cultural norms. Festivals, music, and dance rooted in African traditions can serve as a means of cultural expression and identity reinforcement. By celebrating and institutionalizing these cultural elements, Nigeria can cultivate a stronger national identity that resists Western cultural hegemony.

Economic Independence and Development

Economic de-westernisation involves reducing dependency on Western economies and fostering self-sustained growth. Pan-Africanism advocates for economic cooperation among African nations, encouraging trade and investment within the continent. For Nigeria, this means leveraging its

vast natural and human resources to build a diversified and self-reliant economy. Initiatives such as the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) align with Pan-African ideals by promoting intra-African trade and reducing reliance on Western markets (UNECA, 2020).

Investing in local industries and agriculture is crucial for economic de-westernisation. By supporting homegrown businesses and implementing policies that favor local production over imports, Nigeria can create jobs, stimulate economic growth, and reduce the outflow of wealth to Western countries. Additionally, fostering technological innovation and knowledge transfer within Africa can enhance Nigeria's competitiveness on the global stage.

Political Unity and Sovereignty

Pan-Africanism also emphasizes political unity and sovereignty as essential components of de-westernization. Nigeria, as a leading nation in Africa, can play a pivotal role in advocating for greater political integration and cooperation among African states. Organisations such as the African Union (AU) provide platforms for collective decision-making and conflict resolution, reducing the influence of Western powers in African affairs.

Strengthening regional organisations and alliances can enhance Nigeria's political autonomy and influence. By working collaboratively with other African nations, Nigeria can address common challenges such as security threats, climate change, and economic instability without over-reliance on Western intervention. This collective approach not only fortifies Nigeria's sovereignty but also reinforces the principles of Pan-African solidarity and self-determination (Nkrumah, 1963).

Conclusion

In conclusion, while multinational corporations bring investment, technology, and employment opportunities to Nigeria, their operations also raise significant concerns about neo-colonialism. The asymmetrical power relations, economic dependency, and social inequalities exacerbated by their presence underscore the need for robust regulatory frameworks, equitable partnerships, and sustainable development practices. Addressing these challenges requires a concerted effort from

the Nigerian government, civil society, and international stakeholders to ensure that economic growth benefits all segments of society and contributes to genuine development rather than perpetuating neo-colonial dynamics.

The influence of the Bretton Woods institutions in Nigeria presents a complex narrative of development assistance intertwined with neo-colonial dynamics. While these institutions have contributed to certain aspects of economic stabilization and growth, their policies often come at the cost of national sovereignty and socio-economic wellbeing. The experience of Nigeria underscores the need for a critical reassessment of the role of international financial institutions in developing countries and the pursuit of development models that prioritize indigenous economic strengths and socio-economic justice.

Religion organisations in Nigeria serve as potent instruments of neo-colonialism, perpetuating foreign influences and interests long after formal colonial rule ended. Through affiliations with foreign entities, hierarchical structures reminiscent of colonial administrations, and significant socio-political influence, these organisations shape Nigeria's cultural, political, and economic landscapes in ways that often prioritize external agendas over local needs and aspirations. Addressing the impacts of neo-colonialism through religious organizations requires a nuanced approach that balances spiritual freedom with national sovereignty and cultural autonomy.

The encouragement of African culture in Nigeria represents a proactive strategy for de-westernization, affirming cultural resilience, social harmony, and sustainable development. By reclaiming and revitalizing indigenous traditions, Nigeria can counterbalance the pervasive influence of Westernization, fostering a society that values its cultural diversity and heritage. Embracing African culture not only strengthens national identity but also positions Nigeria at the forefront of global cultural dialogue, celebrating the richness of its traditions while forging a path towards a more inclusive and sustainable future.

Pan-Africanism presents a viable strategy for the de-westernization of Nigeria by promoting cultural revival, economic independence, and